Between Assistance and Control

An Empirical Study of Informal Governance Practices among Creative Professionals

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Abstract

Introduction The rapid integration of generative AI into creative professional work has raised questions about how responsibility, oversight, and acceptable use are governed when formal organizational guidance is limited or absent. Understanding how practitioners manage these challenges is increasingly important as AI becomes embedded in everyday creative workflows.

Research Question The research questions are following:
RQ1: How do creative professionals develop informal governance practices for responsible AI use?
RQ2: How do they decide which tasks to delegate to GenAI?

Method Semi-structured interviews were conducted with 16 creative professionals across roles including content designers, UX/product designers, visual designers, and game developers. Data were analyzed using thematic analysis following an abductive reasoning approach.

Results The findings show that informal governance develops through personal judgment rather than institutional guidance, with practitioners creating their own boundaries around data confidentiality, using structured routines for verification and refinement, and adapting disclosure practices depending on the context. Delegation decisions also follow a consistent accountability-based approach, where tasks are given to AI only when practitioners feel able to evaluate the output and take responsibility for it, while tasks closely connected to creative identity are intentionally kept under human control.

Discussion These findings suggest that informal governance is necessary but fragile, as it is weakened by the same efficiency pressures that

drive AI adoption and may be difficult to sustain without institutional support. The study is limited by its small purposive sample and reliance on self-reported data. Future research should examine how these practices develop over time and whether organizational support can help stabilize informal governance.

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Abbreviations

Abbreviation	Description
AI	Artificial Intelligence
GenAI	Generative Artificial Intelligence
HCAI	Human-Centered AI
LLM	Large Language Models
ML	Machine Learning
NLP	Natural Language Processing

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1

Introduction

The rapid development of generative Artificial Intelligence (GenAI), systems capable of producing text, images, and other content in response to natural language prompts, is fundamentally changing professional work practices, including how work is organized, performed, and evaluated [2, 8, 21]. As these systems become more widely available, they are increasingly embedded in everyday workflows, shaping how humans and AI systems interact in the production of work [1, 28]. This shift is particularly visible in creative domains, such as design, writing, and editorial work, where GenAI interacts directly with practices traditionally associated with human creativity [2, 8]. Through interviews with creative professionals, this thesis explores how GenAI has shaped and continues to shape their work practices. It examines how they decide which tasks to delegate to AI and how they maintain oversight and control over creative output.

Creative professionals are increasingly integrating GenAI tools into their daily work routines to support early stages of creative practices, such as developing ideas, drafting content, or refining material during editing [28, 44, 27, 49]. The integration of GenAI into creative work therefore raises questions about professional identity, authorship, and responsibility, particularly regarding how AI-generated contributions are evaluated, attributed, and overseen in everyday work [20, 1, 27, 37].

Formal policies and regulatory frameworks often develop more slowly than actual technological adoption, resulting in a gap between official rules and everyday routines [25, 38]. As a result, organizational guidance on GenAI use is frequently vague, incomplete, or absent in day-to-day work

[14, 30, 38]. In response, they develop informal governance practices to manage concerns related to ownership, accuracy, and accountability of co-created outputs [25, 38]. In this study, informal governance refers to the situated, practitioner-driven mechanisms that define responsibility, control, and acceptable AI use in the absence of detailed formal guidance, emerging from within practice rather than being imposed from above [38]. Despite their practical importance, there is limited empirical insight into how these practices are constructed and negotiated by creative professionals themselves [14, 27].

1.1 Research Problem

While GenAI is increasingly becoming an integral part of everyday professional work, empirical research on how employees and creative professionals experience and manage AI use remains limited. Existing studies have primarily examined organizational AI adoption in relation to employee attitudes, performance, and behavioral outcomes, including trust, anxiety, career behavior, and workplace engagement. For example, [31] investigate how perceived AI intelligence and trust influence employees' acceptance of AI at work, while [29] analyze how organizational AI adoption affects proactive career behavior and self-perceived employability. Although these studies show that AI can both improve productivity and create uncertainty, stress, and job insecurity, they mainly rely on surveys and focus on outcomes. This leaves little understanding of how professionals actually govern AI use in their daily workflows. The central problem addressed in this study is the absence of empirical insight into how creative professionals negotiate responsibility, oversight, and control in AI-mediated work contexts, and how informal governance practices emerge where formal organizational guidance is limited or absent.

Research indicates that employees' interactions with AI influence their perceived control and responsibility at work, as shifts in task leadership between humans and AI shape trust, motivation, and workplace behavior [26]. Simultaneously, organizational AI adoption often produces ambiguous guidance for employees, transferring responsibility for ethical judgment, oversight, and appropriate AI use to individual workers rather than formal governance structures. [25, 3]. Even though organizations have introduced AI governance frameworks emphasizing transparency, accountability, and responsible AI use, these efforts largely operate at policy levels and offer limited practical direction for everyday work [3]. As a result,

professionals are frequently required to rely on personal judgment when deciding how to use AI, how much oversight is necessary, and how to address questions of authorship, originality, and responsibility. Recent research on generative AI in creative fields highlights increasing concerns regarding consent, credit, and compensation, as well as the lack of alignment between formal and informal governance strategies. Creative professionals navigate these issues primarily on their own, developing informal practices to manage risks related to AI-generated content and ownership [25].

Moreover, although generative AI can improve individual creative output, it may also reduce originality and shape how creative decisions are made in AI-supported work [13]. This tension between efficiency and creative distinctiveness adds a further dimension to the governance challenge: professionals must not only decide when and how to use AI but also how to preserve the qualities that define their work and professional identity.

Together, these dynamics reveal a critical gap in current research: the lack of qualitative, practice-based understanding of how creative professionals apply informal governance mechanisms to GenAI.

1.2 Aim and research question

The aim of this study is to investigate how responsible AI use is constructed and maintained through informal governance practices in creative professional work. Specifically, the study focuses on how practitioners develop and apply informal practices to govern the use of GenAI in their daily work. An exploratory, qualitative approach based on interviews with creative professionals from different industries is used to investigate how governance emerges through professionals' own judgments, routines, and decisions as they integrate AI tools into their workflows. By examining participants' experiences, the study seeks to identify recurring patterns of informal practices related to oversight and control.

To address this aim, the study seeks to answer the following research questions:

How do creative professionals develop informal governance practices for responsible AI use?

How do they decide which tasks to delegate to GenAI?

By examining these practices, the study seeks to provide insights for organizations within creative industries, where expectations for responsible AI use are often present but not operationalized in concrete work practices. Specifically, the study aims to produce a set of empirically grounded themes describing how creative professionals draw personal boundaries around AI use and negotiate authorship and responsibility in their daily work. Thus, the findings are also intended to inform broader discussions on AI governance by highlighting how governance is produced and maintained through everyday professional activity, rather than through top-down regulation.

1.3 Delimitations of the study

This study has several deliberate limitations. Firstly, it does not aim to evaluate the technical performance, accuracy, or efficiency of specific generative AI tools. Instead, the focus is on how such tools are socially and ethically used in practice. Secondly, the study focuses exclusively on the perspectives of creative professionals' and does not include views of policymakers, AI developers, or organizational leadership. While this limits generalizability across stakeholder groups, it allows for an in-depth, bottom-up understanding of everyday practices. Finally, due to the qualitative and exploratory nature of the study and the relatively small sample size, the findings are not intended to be statistically generalizable. Instead, the study aims for analytical generalization by identifying patterns and practices, that may be transferable to similar creative work contexts.

1.4 Use of AI

We utilized AI as a support-tool in different stages of the research and writing process. The tools used were ChatGPT, Google Notebook LM, Perplexity AI and DeepLWrite. ChatGPT helped to refine the research problem, aim, and research questions and ensure alignment with the research criteria. Additionally, it was used for project and time management such as the creation of a project plan. Google Notebook LM was used to extract structured information from papers that had already been selected for inclusion, organizing fields such as key insights, methods, limitations, and research gaps into a comparison table. Perplexity AI was used as a support to find research papers with similar methodologies and state-of-the art research. DeepLWrite was used to enhance writing and readability.

Prompt	Benefit	Drawback
For each research paper analyze the objectives, key insights, findings, conclusions, methods used, limitations, results, research gap, future research and dataset.	Organized key information from selected papers into a comparison table.	Responses needed manual validation against academic sources for accuracy
Correct the following sentence/paragraph grammatically to enhance clarity, readability and coherence: [inserted sentence/paragraph]	Improved language and readability	Superficial language
Create a biweekly plan with balanced responsibilities	Helped with getting an overview of tasks and time management	Needed multiple iterations with additional refinements because the workload was not balanced
Evaluate whether this research question adheres to the criteria: [inserted research question]	Helped refine the research question to ensure alignment with the project criteria	Needed multiple iterations to remove assumptions or biases.

Table 1.1: Overview of prompts used for AI

Using AI tools during the research process significantly improved efficiency and organization. It was particularly helpful in task and time management, for refining the research problem and questions, and summarizing literature. However, AI-generated responses needed to be validated frequently to ensure accuracy as they produced hallucinations. Hence, all outputs were reviewed and manually verified against original sources before being incorporated into the thesis. The information extracted by Google Notebook LM were cross-checked with the full-text academic articles to prevent misinterpretation. Any references suggested by AI systems were verified or discarded to avoid hallucinated citations. AI-generated text was treated as a drafting help, and final judgments remained the responsibility of the authors.

2

Extended Background

2.1 The impact of AI on creative labor

Generative AI refers to a class of deep learning models such as large language models (LLMs) that can produce new, human-like text and visuals in response to natural language prompts [21, 27, 28]. Unlike traditional predictive AI, which primarily analyzes data to perform classifications or forecasts, GenAI participates directly in content production [21, 37, 28]. Although AI technologies have long been present in artistic experimentation, the recent LLMs and text-to-image systems now produce outputs that closely resemble human-generated creative work, intensifying debates about creative labor and future work in creative industries [8, 21]. As a result, these developments have prompted renewed concerns about authorship, labor displacement, professional identity, and governance in the creative industry[14].

Creative professionals can be defined as individuals who produce creative output as a core part of their employment, whether they are working within an organization or as freelancers [25]. These professionals usually work in domains such as journalism, content and user experience (UX) design, and editing, where they produce tangible or digital creative works that may range from highly novel to more generic artifacts [25, 14]. Hence, it has long been considered difficult to be replaced with automation. In recent years, this long-standing assumption has been increasingly challenged by the integration of AI into creative fields. Research in the creative

fields emphasizes that AI integration brings both expanded creative possibilities and structural tensions [2]. Schinello finds that AI plays a growing role across sectors such as music, advertising, journalism, and design, enhancing productivity, supporting decision-making, and reaching new markets [37]. Particularly for small firms and freelancers, where, AI can simplify workflows and decrease production costs. However, experts simultaneously emphasize concerns regarding originality, job security, and unresolved copyright issues [14]. These tensions illustrate the conflicting side of AI adoption: while it can support creative work, it also destabilizes established professional norms.

Scholars often distinguish the influence of AI on human labor in terms of replacement and displacement, yet case studies of AI-assisted creative firms suggest limited evidence of full replacement, indicating that AI adoption more commonly results in restructuring rather than substitution of human creators [14]. Creative teams continue to rely on human expertise across multiple stages of production, including data selection, prompt design, editing, and refinement; however, human labor remains central to these processes, and it often becomes less visible in products marketed as "AI-generated," thereby dimming human contributions [18]. It can be summarized that AI does not eliminate creative labor but reshapes its distribution and recognition.

Beyond changes in labor structures, AI narratives also influence how creative work is understood. Caramiaux et al. argue that media and technology view present creativity as something that can be separated from the labor involved in producing it, emphasizing automation, efficiency, and speed instead[8]. In these narratives, creativity is described as mainly about ideas, while the execution is assigned to automated systems[9]. As a result, success is often measured in terms of productivity, such as how quickly and how much content can be produced. [8, 9]. This focus on speed and scale may lead to disregarding the slower, iterative, and exploratory processes that are central to many creative practices.

In conclusion, the literature suggests that AI's impact on creative labor is neither fully substitutive nor purely supportive; instead, it broadens creative prospects while reshaping task structures, professional roles, and responsibility. Despite GenAI's immense growth and demand, there remains limited qualitative data into how creative professionals manage these transformations in everyday work. This study therefore covers how creative professionals develop and apply informal governance practices,

how they decide which tasks to delegate to GenAI, and how responsibility and oversight are maintained in AI-mediated creative work.

2.2 AI norms, governance, and informal practices

AI governance at the organizational level is defined as a system of rules, processes, and technological mechanisms designed to align the deployment of AI with institutional strategies, legal requirements, and ethical principles [24, 35]. High-level frameworks such as the EU AI Act establish important risk-based categories and accountability principles [19]. However, they provide limited procedural guidance for integrating GenAI systems into daily professional workflows [3]. As a result, the adoption of new AI technologies often outpaces organizational readiness [40]. In practice, centralized governance frameworks rarely offer concrete guidelines on how organizations should address issues such as verifying AI-generated outputs, determining appropriate task delegation, or clarifying responsibility in collaborative human–AI work [40]. Although many organizations communicate ethical AI principles, these tend to focus on abstract risk management rather than concrete practices [22]. Consequently, formal policies may become disconnected from the emergent, context-dependent routines of practitioners who often deploy systems without official alignment [38, 28].

In contexts where formal guidance is unclear or absent, 'shadow AI' practices emerge, where professionals use AI tools without formal approval, to improve and maintain efficiency [38]. At the same time, they develop their own informal rules and verification routines to address uncertainties related to authorship, accuracy, and trust [25, 20, 28]. These bottom-up practices frequently position the human as the final reviewer [1, 37, 45]. While AI increases efficiency, human oversight remains central in professional practice [38, 40]. This emphasis on human review aligns with Human-Centered AI (HCAI) perspectives, which frame human–AI collaboration as requiring human oversight, control, and accountability for AI-supported outputs [27]. According to this view, creative professionals are not replaced by AI but remain accountable for how such systems are used and integrated into daily work, stressing that human judgment remains critical [27]. While HCAI provides useful conceptual context for understanding why human oversight matters in AI-mediated work, this study examines how such oversight is enacted in practice through informal governance practices, rather than applying HCAI as an analytical framework.

A complex adaptive systems (CAS) perspective conceptualizes governance as an ongoing socio-technological process in which policies and human behaviors influence each other [22]. Practice-based approaches offer a different focus. While formal and systemic approaches prioritize top-down control and high-level strategic alignment, practice-based approaches focus on governance as enacted through situated actions and daily work routines [1, 22, 24]. This theoretical lens is particularly suited to studying how creative professionals develop governance practices when formal organizational guidance is limited. Practice-based approaches reveal the informal rules and accountability logics that practitioners develop within specific institutional contexts [23]. This lens focuses on situated action and how human judgment shapes technology use [1]. Such positioning reveals how creative professionals protect their creative integrity and manage risk when formal guidance is absent [38]. By examining how professional expertise and identity shape AI-supported workflows, this study extends practice theory into the domain of AI governance in creative work contexts [1].

Preserving client trust and professional reputation is central to creative professions as they are often held personally accountable for the quality and integrity of their work [27, 25]. As GenAI tools become routine in daily practice, they contribute to subtle shifts in how tasks are distributed and how creative processes are structured within professional practices [27].

Research often distinguishes between the automation of routine or repetitive tasks and the support of higher-level creative activities such as ideation, drafting, and revision [27]. Findings suggest that AI tools can enhance productivity and assist professionals in overcoming creative blocks, thereby accelerating iterative processes [49]. However, efficiency benefits are often accompanied by concerns regarding potential degrading of skills, shifting professional roles, and the impact of AI on creative identity [14, 35, 27]. These shifts in task distribution and role expectations create new points where professionals must determine appropriate boundaries, oversight, and accountability in AI-supported work.

In creative contexts, established professional values such as authorship, aesthetic judgment, and professional identity intersect with evolving organizational expectations related to innovation and efficiency [48, 17, 14, 6]. Managing GenAI in creative professions therefore involves continuous negotiation of agency and responsibility [1, 22]. However, little empirical research examines how creative professionals construct, justify, and stabilize these governance practices in everyday work.

2.3 Authorship

The integration of GenAI into creative production fundamentally challenges pre-determined understandings of authorship. Traditionally, authorship has been closely linked to human originality and personal expression. However, as AI systems increasingly generate text, images, music, and other creative outputs that resemble human production, the boundaries of authorship have become unclear.

[47] argue that AI is reshaping the essence of creativity by challenging the long-standing idea that creativity is uniquely human. The review shows that a significant share of studies focus on finding a new definition for creativity in the light of AI-generated outputs, sparking the debate of whether machines can be considered creative agents. While AI systems can produce outputs that meet conventional criteria of usefulness, they lack subjective experience and emotional depth [47, 43]. This creates tension between output-based definitions of creativity and human-centered conceptions of authorship.

The legal framework of authorship complicates this issue further. According to Wang, AI-generated works could satisfy minimal originality standards, where originality depends on the way elements are chosen and put together; however, AI itself cannot be recognized as an author due to the absence of legal personality [45]. Simultaneously, Mazzi states that attention should also be given to the originality of text prompts, which can reflect creative judgment and intellectual effort [33]. Nevertheless, even if prompts are considered original expressions, this does not automatically extend authorship to the resulting AI output. The uncertainty of the boundaries of human expression and machine generation highlights the need to reevaluate how authorship, creativity, and responsibility are conceptualized in AI-supported creative work.

Overall, the literature displays that even though AI systems can produce creative work that meets basic standards of originality, existing legal and philosophical frameworks still place authorship primarily with humans. At the same time, the raising cooperation between AI and the creative process complicates clearly defining who should be credited as the author and who should be responsible for the final work. As creative production becomes more collaborative between humans and machines, the traditional understanding of responsibility and professional identity is under question. Despite extensive theoretical and legal debate, there is still limited empirical

research on how creative professionals themselves understand and manage these authorship questions in everyday practice. This study addresses that gap by examining how creative professionals define authorship in AI-supported work, how they decide what can be considered as human contribution, and how responsibility and oversight are negotiated in real creative settings.

3

Method

This chapter presents the research strategy, then illustrates the data collection method, participants, and sampling strategy. Lastly, the data analysis method and research ethics for this study are outlined.

3.1 Research Strategy

This study employs an exploratory interpretative qualitative research approach to examine how creative professionals manage and regulate the use of GenAI in their everyday work. A qualitative approach is appropriate for studying work practices by capturing individuals' perspectives and lived experiences, rather than measuring predefined variables [4, 10]. Rather than aiming to generate formal theory, the focus is on exploring recurring patterns in how creative professionals negotiate GenAI use across work contexts. The study is grounded in a constructivist view, an ontological perspective that recognizes that social phenomena and their meanings are not fixed or external facts but are continuously created through social interactions [4, 12]. This perspective is appropriate for examining informal governance practices, as they do not exist as fixed, observable phenomena but are shaped by the specific professional contexts, values, and judgments of the individuals enacting them. Constructivism as an ontological position is complemented here by an interpretivist epistemology, which holds that knowledge is situated and dependent on how participants make sense of their own work contexts, thus taking on an insider perspective [10].

The study follows an abductive reasoning approach, moving iteratively between participants' accounts and existing theoretical concepts, such as informal governance and shadow AI, to develop analytically grounded interpretations [41].

Because these practices involve personal judgments, an interpretative qualitative approach is able to capture the how and why of decision-making processes [46, 11]. This directly supports the study's objectives: examining how creative professionals govern their use of generative AI, how they decide which tasks to delegate to AI systems, and how oversight and control are negotiated in daily work.

The choice of an exploratory interpretive approach is consistent with recent qualitative research on GenAI in professional contexts, which has increasingly employed interpretive methods to examine evolving work practices and human-AI collaboration [25, 27, 38]. Studies in this field frequently use semi-structured interviews to capture how practitioners navigate emerging challenges when integrating AI into established workflows [25, 23, 6]. This thesis's exploratory qualitative strategy aligns with these contemporary research practices [45, 36].

3.1.1 Alternative Research Strategies

Other strategies such as surveys, ethnography, and case studies were considered but deemed less suitable to address the focus of this study. Ethnography could have enabled an in-depth exploration of practitioners' lived experiences through close observation of how governance practices develop over time within organizational contexts [11, 16]. However, as this study focuses on cross-organizational perspectives in order to identify recurring informal governance practices, rather than an in-depth exploration of a single institution, ethnography was deemed unsuitable for addressing the research questions. Survey-based strategies were also considered, as they could have been effective for identifying general patterns of AI use across larger groups of professionals [32, 4]. However, their reliance on predefined categories limits participants' ability to explain how and why decisions are made in specific situations, which can prevent the identification of unanticipated informal norms [39, 5]. Because informal governance practices are often tacit, situational, and difficult to articulate through fixed response categories, a survey strategy risks oversimplifying how decisions around AI use are actually made.

A case study was evaluated since it excels at providing an in-depth account of complex experiences or processes in real-life settings where the

researcher has limited control over events and wishes to explain why certain outcomes occur [46, 4]. However, the aim of this study is to identify recurring patterns of informal governance across various creative sectors rather than providing an intensive, holistic account of a single organization. Lastly, think-aloud protocols were considered but not selected as a data collection method. Although they are useful for capturing participants' thoughts while performing a task, informal governance practices are often developed over time and are not easily observed in a single session. [15] As a result, this method would not have provided the reflective and experience-based insights needed for the study.

3.2 Data Collection Method

To explore the influence of AI on the creative professionals' workflow and operational guidelines, this study requires a deep understanding of participants' personal experiences and perceptions. Semi-structured interviews are well suited for capturing such insights, and interviewer bias is reduced while comparability is enhanced through the use of a pre-determined set of questions, ensuring that relevant topics are addressed systematically and that all participants respond to the same prompts [34]. This format will allow the collection of detailed practices and enables participants to describe their own judgments, and interpretations in their own words.

Interviews were selected because the research aims to understand how creative professionals utilize generative AI in their everyday work, specifically, how they decide when and how responsibly to use AI, and how informal governance practices develop. Such practices are often tacit, situational, and difficult for participants to articulate, hence that making them difficult to capture through structured questionnaires or observation [11]. Semi-structured interviews are well suited to this kind of inquiry as they allow participants to describe the decision-making processes in their own words, while the flexible format enables the interviewer to delve into the reasoning and context behind specific practices [32, 34].

An interview questionnaire was developed based on the study's research objectives and relevant background literature. Core topics included participants' experiences with gen-AI, task management, perceptions of control, and personal boundaries around AI use. While the same general themes were covered across all interviews, the semi-structured format allowed the interviewer to adapt follow-up questions depending on each participant's

responses, supporting an interpretive and participant-led data collection process.

Interviews were conducted online, and each session lasted between 25 and 48 minutes. (See Table 3.1.) With participants' consent, all interviews were audio-recorded to ensure accuracy. Prior to the interviews, participants were asked to complete a Google Form containing the informed consent and a short set of background questions (e.g., occupation, years of professional experience, and organization size), which provided contextual information and supported the analysis.

3.3 Participants and Sampling

This study employs a purposive sampling strategy [11, 39]. This non-probability approach enables the intentional selection of participants with professional expertise and lived experience relevant to the research goals [11, 4]. It is particularly suitable for qualitative research, as it prioritizes rich, experience-based accounts over statistical representativeness and supports in-depth exploration of complex practices related to GenAI use.

The target population of this study consists of creative professionals working in roles where GenAI is present or relevant, including but not limited to content design, UX design, graphic design, motion design, and creative production. A total of 16 participants were interviewed. The sample included a diverse range of creative professionals, such as content designers, UX designers, game developers, and motion designers. An overview of interview participants, including their occupations is presented in Table 3.1. To protect participant anonymity, specific job titles were grouped into broader role categories.

The selection criteria were designed to ensure that interviewees could reflect on decision-making, oversight, and responsibility in relation to generative AI, whether through direct use, selective adoption, or deliberate non-use. Participants were selected to include variation across professional roles, levels of seniority, and organizational contexts in order to explore differences in how AI-related practices are negotiated. To ensure relevance, participants were required to have at least one year of professional experience in a creative role. Individuals in purely executive or policy-making positions, as well as those without direct involvement in creative work, were excluded from the study.

The decision to use purposive sampling was based on two main considerations. First, relevance and experiential knowledge were essential, as the

Interviewee	Occupation	Interview Duration	Years of Experience	Organization Type
Interviewee01	Content Designer	42 minutes	6–10 years	Large
Interviewee02	Content Designer	40 minutes	6–10 years	Large
Interviewee03	UX/Product Designer	38 minutes	6–10 years	Large
Interviewee04	UX/Product Designer	45 minutes	6–10 years	Large
Interviewee05	Game Developer	48 minutes	6–10 years	Freelance
Interviewee06	Visual Designer	27 minutes	6–10 years	Small
Interviewee07	Visual Designer	40 minutes	6–10 years	Small
Interviewee08	Content Designer	34 minutes	6–10 years	Freelance
Interviewee09	Visual Designer	29 minutes	2–5 years	Small
Interviewee10	UX/Product Designer	26 minutes	2–5 years	Large
Interviewee11	UX/Product Designer	33 minutes	6–10 years	Large
Interviewee12	UX/Product Designer	25 minutes	6–10 years	Large
Interviewee13	Game Developer	30 minutes	2–5 years	Medium
Interviewee14	UX/Product Designer	39 minutes	6–10 years	Large
Interviewee15	Visual Designer	29 minutes	6–10 years	Medium
Interviewee16	UX/Product Designer	33 minutes	6–10 years	Large

Table 3.1: Overview of interview participants and interview duration.
(Job titles have been generalized to protect anonymity. Organization size is categorized as follows: Small = 1–50 employees; Medium = 51–200 employees; Large = 200+ employees.)

study examines how informal governance practices develop in response to generative AI. Creative professionals with direct involvement in production work are well positioned to reflect on task delegation, control, and authorship. Second, purposive sampling aligns with the qualitative research approach by ensuring that all participants could provide experience-based accounts of AI use in practice, rather than general or hypothetical perspectives.

Participants were recruited through professional networks and industry contacts. While this approach facilitated access to practitioners with relevant experience, it may introduce selection bias, as participants may share similar professional norms or industry perspectives. Due to the exploratory and qualitative nature of the study, the sample size was intentionally kept small to prioritize depth over breadth, in line with qualitative research aims. Findings derived from a purposive sample therefore lack statistical generalizability to the entire creative workforce, which is consistent with the aims of qualitative research.

3.3.1 Alternative Sampling Methods

Alternative sampling methods were considered but deemed less feasible. Snowball sampling is particularly effective for reaching hard-to-access populations as practitioners refer one another [32, 16]. However, this reliance on peer referral prevents a selection based on the professional skills needed and may introduce selection bias [11, 4]. Hence, the data might overrepresent shared norms within specific networks rather than capture differences in how individuals make decisions about responsibility, oversight, and boundaries around AI use. This lack of sampling control was therefore considered incompatible with the study's focus.

Theoretical sampling, as used in grounded theory research, was also considered. While this approach can support the development of new theoretical models, it requires data collection and analysis to take place simultaneously and for the sample to change over time [10, 4]. However, the unpredictable nature of theoretical sampling was deemed unfeasible as it would have shifted the study's focus from examining concrete practices to developing a more abstract explanatory model.

Purposive sampling was chosen as it allows participants to be selected in advance based on their relevance to the research topic and ensures the needed variation across professional roles, levels of experience, and organizational settings.

3.4 Data Analysis Method

The interview data were analyzed using thematic analysis, a flexible qualitative method for identifying and interpreting recurring patterns of meaning across textual data [7]. Thematic analysis was selected as the most appropriate method due to specific analytical objectives of the study. Grounded theory, which requires simultaneous data collection and analysis with the goal of constructing a new explanatory theory from the ground up [41], was considered as an alternative research method; however, due to the nature of the study, it was discarded. The aim of this study was not to generate formal theory but rather to identify recurring patterns in how creative professionals make sense of and regulate their use of generative AI. Similarly, discourse analysis was considered but set aside, as its primary focus on language structures and rhetorical mechanisms did not align with the study's interest in lived experiences and reported practices [11]. Thematic analysis offers the flexibility to work within an interpretive framework, engage

with abductive reasoning, and remain responsive to participants' own understandings, making it well-suited to the study's exploratory purposes.

Following transcription, the analysis began with repeated readings of the material to ensure familiarity with participants' views. The analysis followed an abductive research logic, where interpretation developed through a continuous and iterative dialog between the empirical material and relevant theoretical perspectives, drawing on existing concepts to make sense of emerging patterns while remaining open to findings that were not anticipated at the beginning [41].

Initial codes were informed by the extended background and research objectives and were refined based on the interview material, before being organized into broader themes, that reflect shared practices and interpretations. A key component of thematic analysis is coding, which involves systematically categorizing interview transcripts into meaningful levels to identify key themes through an iterative and flexible process that supports interpretation whilst allowing emerging perspectives to be recognized [11].

Our coding structure followed three hierarchical levels. Initially, broad themes were identified to provide a framework for analysis. Secondly, specific sections of the interview data were categorized under these broader themes. Finally, a detailed coding was applied to highlight finer details and sub-themes within each category.

Rather than aiming for statistical generalization, the analysis focused on developing context-sensitive insights into how creative professionals negotiate generative AI in daily work. The final themes were constructed to directly address the study's research objectives, providing an analysis of informal governance practices based on the experiences of the participants.

Given the interpretive nature of qualitative analysis, the researchers acknowledge that coding and thematic interpretations were influenced by their academic perspectives and prior understanding of AI governance debates. In order to reduce bias, coding decisions were continuously reviewed against the interview data and relevant literature throughout the analysis.

3.5 Research Ethics

Research ethics are fundamental to maintaining the integrity of the study while ensuring the protection of all participants [32, 10]. By following research ethics, the study aims to ensure trust, transparency, and accountability and provide a solid foundation for the subject matter based on earlier scientific work. Particular attention was paid to informed consent, participant welfare, confidentiality, and data protection, which are essential for safeguarding participants and supporting the credibility of the research [16].

This study acknowledges that researchers are not in any position that would justify the pursuit of knowledge at the expense of those being studied [11, 32]. A central ethical principle of this study is that participation is completely voluntary. To ensure this, participants received an informed consent form prior to data collection detailing the purpose of the study, the interview format, and how the data would be collected, processed, and stored [32]. This process fosters transparency and reduces uncertainty about the research focus.

Participants were explicitly informed of their right to withdraw from the study at any point without penalty or need for justification. To ensure participant comfort and autonomy, interviews are scheduled at times and locations (offline or online) that suit the participant [4]. Before each interview, participants were reminded of the study's objectives, the role of recording and transcription, and the intended use of the material. It was clearly stated that recordings would not be published and would only be used for research purposes. Participants were informed that they could decline to answer any question or withdraw from the study at any time without explanation, hereby minimizing potential discomfort or harm [16].

To protect the participants' identity, strict anonymization and confidentiality protocols followed [4, 32]. All personal identifiers, including participant names and organizational identifiers, were removed from transcripts and research materials. Pseudonyms were assigned to both individual participants and their respective organizations to safeguard their identities in the final report and avoid re-identification. Job titles were generalized into broader role categories to prevent identification of participants with unique or rare occupational roles. Interview data and identifying information were stored separately, with access restricted to the research team [10, 16].

This study operates in compliance with the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) and the Swedish National Data Service. Personal data, defined as information relating to identifiable individuals, were limited to what was strictly necessary for the study, and no sensitive personal data, such as health or religious beliefs, were collected [16]. No data was collected beyond what was strictly necessary for the purposes of answering the research questions. The processing of all data is guided in accordance with GDPR principles of lawfulness, fairness, and transparency [16]. All digital files are stored securely using Stockholm University's approved Microsoft OneDrive service. Access to the data is restricted to the research team to prevent unauthorized use. Once the research project is finalized, data will be disposed of securely.

In addition to ethical safeguards, the study addressed issues of research trustworthiness. Rather than focusing solely on conventional notions of reliability, which can be difficult to apply to qualitative research, the study adopted criteria of credibility, transferability, dependability, and confirmability [4].

Credibility was supported through a transparent and systematic research process. This study ensured credibility by grounding the interview design in current literature including coding iterations and analytical memos, allowing the interpretations to be traced back to the empirical material [42]. Data collection procedures were consistently applied across participants by using a semi-structure interview guide [4]. The research process was carefully documented, including interview notes, transcripts, coding iterations, and analytical memos, to provide a robust foundation for the interpretations made [10].

While qualitative results are not statistically generalizable, this study provides detailed descriptions of the research context, participant roles, and analytical procedures to enhance the transferability of the findings [11]. By clearly outlining the study's theoretical grounding and methodological choices, the findings can be evaluated in relation to other organizational or professional contexts with similar characteristics. The goal is to produce concrete, context-dependent knowledge that remains useful beyond the immediate study.

Dependability was addressed through thorough documentation of the research design and its implementation [10, 4]. Any adjustments made during the research process were recorded and reflected upon. The study explicitly described data collection procedures, analytical decisions, and

methodological limitations, following established recommendations for qualitative research transparency. Finally, to support confirmability, analytical decisions were systematically documented and grounded in the interview data, with interpretations cross-referenced against the relevant academic literature to reduce the influence of individual researcher assumptions [10]. This approach helps ensure that the conclusions are derived from the data rather than personal bias.

4

Results

This chapter presents the results of the thematic analysis organized into four sections. Section 4.1 examines how participants integrate AI into their creative workflows and describes the different modes of AI use observed across the data. After, the decisions participants make when delegating tasks to AI and the ways they maintain oversight and control over AI-generated outputs are presented. Section 4.3 explores the formal and informal governance mechanisms participants encounter and develop, including practices of concealment when organizational rules are perceived as restrictive or unclear. Finally, participants' descriptions of authorship and ownership and how AI use intersects with their professional identity will be presented. A comprehensive overview of the thematic analysis, including the full coding structure of themes, categories, and codes, is provided in Appendix 6.5.

4.1 AI Integration in Creative Work

4.1.1 Modes of AI Use

The most consistent pattern across participants was the use of AI for repetitive, technical, or low-stakes tasks such as email rephrasing, grammar correction, summarizing, and placeholder content generation. These tasks were similar in structure and execution, as they were straightforward, well-defined, and did not require creative judgment. Participants agreed that the most frequent and prominent use of AI was for these defined operations rather than an active participant role in the creative processes.

"[L]et's use AI like we use a calculator for maths. It's an assistant, a helper, but that's it." (Interviewee 8)

Beyond these routine uses, most participants described AI in a supporting role as a helper that extended their capacity. Some compared this relationship to working alongside a colleague rather than simply operating a tool. Dependent on the nature of the task and the level of back-and-forth involved between AI tool and a user, AI felt either like a tool or a companion. It can imply that these two modes of AI use exist on different levels of the same range rather than as distinct applications of AI use.

"[I]'m the architect and AI is just the worker. It just helps me to get it done, to put brick by brick as a worker." (Interviewee 13)

Using AI as an initial point of reference was particularly noteworthy especially during initiation processes or creative blocks. Participants consistently described AI's contribution here as a thought starter rather than providing finished creative products. For participants, the value of AI lay not in producing something finished but in giving them a starting point to react to, which they could then shape according to their own judgment.

"[I]t's become a habit in a sense that it makes it easier to start a project. Instead of starting there and having a one-hour thinking session, you start it with just one simple message to AI." (Interviewee 16)

Participants varied considerably in the extent to which AI had become embedded in their daily work, ranging from those for whom AI had become fully embedded in daily practice to those who described their use as deliberate. Notably, lower-intensity users were not necessarily opposed to AI but tended to describe themselves as too invested in controlling the process to delegate more of it.

"[I] am not a heavy AI user [...] I am also maybe too controlling to just take the outcome and present it somewhere." (Interviewee 11)

4.1.2 Workflow Adaptation

Practical pressure was the most frequently cited within workflow adaptation, with participants describing time and budget constraints as the main reason behind AI integration into their work. AI was adopted not out of

preference but out of practical necessity, with deadlines and resource limitations shaping how much AI was integrated into work. In this sense, AI was integrated as a response to external demands rather than as a fundamental shift in how creative work is approached.

"[T]hey give us like unrealistic deadlines that if I had to do it manually, I wouldn't be able to do it in working hours." (Interviewee 3)

A hybrid workflow surfaced as the most common structural outcome across participants, where AI-supported and manual work were combined across different stages of the process. AI was typically used in the early or more mechanical stages, while human input remained central in tasks requiring judgment, creativity, or strategic thinking. The distinction can be drawn between stages where AI could be used and stages where human judgment remained non-negotiable

"[I] let AI do the heavy grunt work just to save time, and so I keep all the parts that require thinking things through, the strategic design, all of that." (Interviewee 16)

Participants described an iterative back-and-forth process that characterized how most participants navigated AI outputs in practice. This trial-and-error approach was not described as a limitation but as a normal part of working with AI tools. When AI produced undesirable results, participants did not abandon the tool but instead adapted their approach by re-prompting or restructuring the task. A part of this process involved developing effective ways of communicating tasks to the tool, with participants mentioning that the quality of AI output was directly linked to how skillfully the task was presented to AI in the first place.

"[I] think it depends highly on your ability to prompt, which still requires skills that I think a lot of people undervalue or undermine." (Interviewee 4)

Overall, participants adapted their workflows by integrating AI where it helped with efficiency while maintaining control over the core creative parts of their work.

4.2 Delegation, Control & Human Judgment

4.2.1 Delegation Decisions

Participants consistently described approaching AI use with a clear intention of what they wanted to achieve before engaging with it. Rather than

exploring AI outputs openly, participants came to the tool with a defined outcome already in mind, using AI to reach it more efficiently rather than to discover it. This suggests that delegation was not exploratory but goal-oriented from the start.

"[I]f you want to use it, you have to just use it as a tool, come in with clear knowledge and an idea, or what you want to get out of it." (Interviewee 3)

Participants made decisions about whether a task was appropriate to delegate to AI, based on whether they felt confident taking responsibility for the final outcome. Tasks that could be reviewed, verified, and approved by the participant were more likely to be delegated to AI, while others were kept fully human. Once a task was delegated, participants evaluated whether the AI-generated output actually met project requirements such as client briefs, brand guidelines, or overall design direction. External constraints, such as a client's requirements or contractual agreements, also contributed to delegation decisions.

"[I]t's very easy for us to validate generated output and align it for our needs or clients' needs as well." (Interviewee 12)

Participants consistently draw a firm boundary around the creative core of their work, actively keeping AI out of the stages they considered most central to their professional identity and creative processes. Rather than being a simple matter of task categorization, this reflected a genuine sense of what the work was for. Participants did not just exclude AI from creative stages for practical reasons; they described a strong personal desire to do that work themselves, rooted in craft identity and the enjoyment of the process itself.

"[W]hen it comes to thinking about creative concepts and thinking about how to approach things, I find that we end up being more successful when we come up with those ideas ourselves." (Interviewee 7)

For some participants, this protection extended to personal projects entirely, where AI was excluded not because of professional standards but because doing the work by hand was the point. The enjoyment of making was itself something participants were unwilling to delegate, even when efficiency would have allowed it.

"[W]hen I have time, I always enjoy making it frame by frame again because I love what I do." (Interviewee 15)

4.2.2 Protecting the Human Core

The genuine concern regarding the displacement of human work by AI was expressed by participants in three distinctive ways. One of the ways that was mentioned was that AI had already structurally replaced certain jobs and roles at an industry level. Participants described this not as a future risk but as something already underway, with visible impacts on hiring practices and on which tasks are still handled by human professionals.

"[T]hey told me a couple of months ago that they are using AI to create the screenplay in English, and they're not using me anymore as a consultant and English translator because it's easier to do it that way." (Interviewee 8)

The second concern covered that clients were increasingly willing to accept cheaper, lower-quality AI output, which eroded both the pricing and the perceived value of skilled creative work. This was experienced not just as a threat to income but as a failure to recognize the effort, skill, and time behind it.

"[I] don't like it when they prefer something cheaper, because someone who does that puts a lot of effort in it and it cannot be cheap." (Interviewee 15)

The final concern reflected a more nuanced perspective, as participants noticed a change in how their work is carried out, shifting from hands-on execution to tasks focused on oversight and quality control. Reactions to this change were mixed, as some saw it as a natural evolution, while others viewed it as a loss of the parts of their work they valued most.

"[T]here's a new work role called content engineer. And content engineers are going to be expected to be able to work with AI on a daily basis and create rules for how the team should use AI, so that's what the job is turning into." (Interviewee 1)

On the contrary, many participants firmly believed that the creative judgment, contextual sensitivity, and craft knowledge that define their work cannot be replicated by AI. They argued that AI-produced outputs meet the surface-level criteria, lacking the underlying intent and context of what makes a piece of creative work good.

"[I] think for creative professionals it's a bit of a safe space, because the ability of the human mind to innovate, to connect things in a creative way, I think is still unmatched by the current AI tools." (Interviewee 16)

4.2.3 Oversight, Verification & Accountability

The underlying scepticism toward AI ouptuts were the main reason behind participants' oversight practices, as they did not expect AI to be reliable and therefore designed their workflows accordingly. The knowledge that AI could hallucinate, produce incorrect information, or simply miss the requirements of a task made unsupervised delegation feel irresponsible regardless of how well a specific output had turned out.

"[I] don't trust it, you know, there is still this very deep feeling that I should not trust it. And it's good, but I don't trust it fully, therefore I don't rely on it fully." (Interviewee 4)

Participants also noted that AI output was easily detectable meaning that submitting it unreviewed carried reputational risk on top of quality risk. The detectability of AI-generated content was itself a quality criterion: output that read or looked like AI had failed the standard, regardless of technical accuracy.

"[I] think they're really risking it because now it's so easy to see when something is AI-generated." (Interviewee 1)

In response to this distrust, participants described oversight as a structured practice that involved at minimum two steps: first, actively checking AI output for errors, hallucinations, or factual inaccuracies; and second, adjusting, correcting, and personalising the output until it met professional standards. For many participants, both steps were non-negotiable every time AI was used.

"[J]ust never copy paste — not only as a designer myself but all the other people in the company use it — and no one should treat its final output as it is without reviewing." (Interviewee 16)

Regardless of how much AI contributed, participants were nearly unanimous that the final word and the accountability for what was produced remained theirs.

"[I] will be the editor of the ChatGPT, for instance, or I will be the final voice and final authority on a task that I delegated." (Interviewee 8)

Additionally, participants consistently described domain expertise and professional judgment as a prerequisite for evaluating AI output, emphasizing that oversight was only possible because the human contributed something AI could not replicate, as meaningful verification depends on deep

contextual understanding and remains an expert-driven practice rather than a routine checking task.

"[A]t least for now, I think that the output that I get from AI is never a finished product, and my years of experience in this field are what really help me filter out the bad advice from the good." (Interviewee 16)

4.3 Governance: Formal Rules & Informal Practices

4.3.1 Organizational & Formal Governance

Participants' accounts of formal AI governance varied across organizations and projects. Several described explicit written policies while others mentioned a complete absence of institutional guidance. Where policies existed, they tended to be narrow in scope and focused on data protection or tool approval rather than broader guidance on how or when AI should be used in creative work. The clearest formal rules participants described concerned sensitive data handling and the use of company-approved tools. In more restricted settings, policies were strict and carried explicit consequences.

"*[Y]ou are not permitted to use AI, and if they find you out, [...] you might be released of the contract*" (Interviewee 8)

Other participants described policies that were less strict but still framed around data protection. These policies prohibited the sharing of internal documentation, screenshots or client information with AI tools. On the other side, several participants reported no institutional guidance whatsoever. In these cases, AI use was left entirely to individual interpretation. This absence was not always experienced as a gap but was sometimes described as if formal rules were simply unnecessary for the scale or nature of the work involved.

"*There are no specific rules or formal stuff in my company about it*" (Interviewee 9)

Where policies existed but were less strictly enforced or clearly communicated, participants were often aware of them without having engaged with them directly. Several participants also expressed uncertainty about whether colleagues engaged with them either.

"[I]t is highly regulated. But it's not very clearly communicated" (Interviewee 2)

Some expressed a desire for clearer institutional guidance.

"I think we are quite AI-forward, but it's also important to have clear rules" (Interviewee 10)

Regardless of whether formal policies were in place, several participants described AI use as an openly discussed topic within their organizations. In many workplaces, AI had become part of everyday conversation among colleagues or was actively encouraged by management. Participants described monthly show-and-tell sessions, active encouragement from management, and a general perception that AI competence was becoming a professional expectation.

"AI discussion is on everyone's minds every day. So, it's something like weather." (Interviewee 8)

A recurring pattern across participants was that the rules they applied to AI use shifted depending on context. Most participants distinguished clearly between professional and personal work, applying stricter standards in client-facing or organizational settings.

"[W]hen I use AI for personal use, I can be more open and less careful [...]. With work, you're more strict and pay more attention." (Interviewee 11)

Formal governance in participants' organizations or projects ranged from strict, narrowly scoped restriction to complete absence, with a middle ground of vague or unread policies. Across this range, institutional rules rarely provided concrete guidance for creative decisions, and AI was either openly discussed in daily work or left entirely to individual discretion.

4.3.2 Self-Governance & Informal Rules

In the absence of clear formal policies, most participants described governing their own AI use through personal judgment, ethics and common sense. Several participants described this as an entirely intuitive process, while others framed it as a shared but unwritten understanding among colleagues.

"[I]t's just a gut feeling or my judgment." (Interview 14)

The most consistently reported informal rule across participants concerned data confidentiality. Regardless of whether their organization or client had established formal policies, almost all participants described avoiding the input of sensitive client or personal data into AI tools as a self-evident boundary.

"I'm always wary of data protection" (Interviewee 3)

Participants described taking active precautions including anonymizing data before prompting, and restricting which tools received which information.

"[O]ne thing that's not so obvious that it doesn't need to have a rule is that you shouldn't put sensitive client information into it, and myself I never use real data." (Interviewee 7)

Distrust of large AI corporations was a driver of these precautions for some, with participants noting that free tools often extract payment in the form of user data.

"I don't write anything personally to Copilot. I really keep it separate [...] from everything, because I don't trust large corporations." (Interviewee 14)

Disclosing the use of AI to clients or colleagues was similarly treated as a personal judgment call. Whether to mention AI involvement depended on the nature of the task, the visibility of the project, and the perceived expectations. Some participants disclosed AI use selectively based on how significant its contribution had been and omitted mentioning when AI had only supported conceptualization or prompting rather than shaped the final output.

"[I]f it's a huge contribution that the AI tool made in the project, I would mention it. But it's not a rule that I need to mention it." (Interviewee 16)

Others described disclosure as simply unnecessary due to low-visibility or low-stakes work, or as something they would keep hidden when workloads were heavy and AI use was a practical shortcut.

"[I]f it's obvious information or not interesting, I avoid mentioning it because I don't think it brings any value." (Interviewee 11)

Several participants briefly mentioned broader ethical concerns about AI systems themselves. These centered primarily on the use of copyrighted material in training data and the environmental costs of large AI models.

"[S]o much of the content [...] that the AI is trained on is on copyrighted material people's work being taken out of without consent. " (Interviewee 16)

While data confidentiality emerged as a near-universal informal rule, other boundaries varied considerably across individuals and contexts.

4.3.3 Shadow AI & Concealment

A subset of participants described concealing AI use from managers, clients, or colleagues, particularly when using non-approved tools or when AI involvement was considered socially unacceptable in their field. The simplest form of concealment involved using unofficial tools without disclosing this to managers or employers.

"I never said I use ChatGPT because I know that it's not approved in my company." (Interviewee 14)

The practice was acknowledged as widespread:

"[S]ome people out there [...] maybe do the whole thing using AI, and then say that it's their own work." (Interviewee 1)

A related but distinct pattern was social discomfort around AI use, particularly in creative roles where AI was seen as undermining professional skills. Several participants described feeling guilty when using AI, or feared being perceived as not good enough at their craft if they needed AI assistance. The stigma was most strongly reported among writers and those producing work expected to showcase personal skill.

"You'd never want to make it seem as though ChatGPT is just doing all your work and that the product you are producing is just AI, you just press the button, and then it came out." (Interviewee 10)

Several participants observed that this stigma had diminished over time, explaining that an initial hesitation to acknowledge needing AI slowly shifted toward a more open attitude.

"I was very skeptical because I didn't want to admit that I needed AI in any aspects of my work." (Interviewee 9)

For some participants, concealment was complicated or made impossible when AI output was visibly detectable. In these cases, disclosure became unavoidable, and participants noted that failing to disclose detectable AI use could damage professional standing in the long term.

"[W]hen I started using AI and shareholders were like, oh my God, this picture is amazing, how did you draw it? And I was embarrassed to tell them that, no, it wasn't me, the AI did it" (Interviewee 13)

In some cases, transparency was also forced when time or budget constraints made AI use unavoidable. Participants disclosed the involvement of AI upfront as completing the work within deadline required it. A subset of participants described adopting AI as a response to external pressure, for example due to unrealistic deadlines.

"[I]f a task needs two months, somebody will ask me to do it in a shorter period of time. That's when you come out with your transparency and tell them that, yes, I can do it in this time frame, but I will use AI tools." (Interviewee 8)

Whether driven by professional stigma, policy restrictions, or practical constraints, concealment and disclosure were rarely straightforward choices, but shaped by context, audience, and circumstances.

4.4 Authorship, Identity & Professional Self

4.4.1 Authorship & Ownership

Participants held varied and sometimes contradictory views on authorship and ownership in AI-assisted work. Ownership tended to be claimed through prompting and refining the AI-generated output. However, when AI contributed the core generative work, ownership felt absent, uncomfortable, or ethically questionable. The most widely shared position was that authorship resided in the human contribution surrounding AI output such as ideas, prompts, decisions, and refinements that shaped the final result. Several participants compared AI to a tool that helps unlock the creative process without owning the result.

"I think at the end of the day it's my thoughts, it's my idea, it's me prompting it, it's me changing the outcome, and it's me presenting the work in my words and my thoughts." (Interviewee 1)

The degree of human involvement throughout the process was central to how secure this sense of ownership felt. When participants had directed, shaped, and refined the output substantially, authorship was asserted with confidence, even when some of the words or elements originated from AI. What mattered was the choice to include them and the work done afterwards.

"I would call it 100 percent personal ownership. Maybe it's not correct, but I still feel like it wasn't produced by AI only, because I initiated it and gave it direction." (Interviewee 11)

Several participants described a felt boundary around what kinds of work they considered genuinely theirs. They distinguished between tasks where AI played a supporting role and those where its involvement crossed into the core of their creative contribution.

"[W]hen artists create something, you can feel who did it. Everybody has their own soul. When you do it by AI, you cannot distinguish who did it. It's all the same." (Interviewee 15)

For other participants, ownership dissolved entirely when they felt the work was not sufficiently their own, leading to a feeling of detachment from the final product.

"[I]t's very depersonalized because [...] you've prompted it, and [...] the result is the image, let's say that you've made. But it's not really yours, so I don't feel like it has a particularly personal component to it, you know. Like, you feel very detached from the end product." (Interviewee 7)

Alongside these different ownership perspectives, participants consistently denied AI the status of authorship. The reasons varied significantly: some framed AI as a compiler of existing human work rather than an originator, attributing authorship to the people whose material fed the system. Others highlighted the lack of a single identifiable contributor behind the output, which made shared authorship impossible in the way it would be with a human collaborator.

"[I]t's still like a computer basically calculating based on what it's been received as information and then using the stolen data from it, but [...], I don't think there's much thought process besides like A equals B basically." (Interviewee 6)

Ownership in AI-assisted creative work was thus neither straightforward nor universally agreed upon. The boundary between authorship and use of a tool shifted depending on how much creative direction participants felt they had exercised and how much of the work they felt remained genuinely theirs.

4.4.2 Professional Identity & Attitude Toward AI

Participants' attitudes toward AI were closely tied to how they understood their own professional identity and the value of their creative work. Two

broad positions emerged across the dataset: AI as an enhancement of professional capability, and AI as something to approach with caution or skepticism. These positions were not mutually exclusive and several participants held more than one simultaneously. The most optimistic position framed AI as expanding rather than diminishing professional capability, such as enabling faster workflows and broader creative scope without undermining the practitioner's core contribution.

"[T]he beauty of [AI] is that utilizing both human and AI factors, which makes us designers even more powerful." (Interviewee 12)

For these participants, professional identity remained secure because AI was understood as dependent on human direction. Some described a shift over time, from initial hesitation to a confident integration of AI into their practice.

"I feel like maybe the attitude has gone from, 'Oh, this is exciting, I wonder what this might be,' maybe tested for a bit of fun, to actually being able to use it to bring more value into a project." (Interviewee 10)

The contrasting position was defined by skepticism toward AI's reliability and outputs.

"AI these days is a bit like lipstick on a pig, you know. We cannot even build software that is accessible, that is usable, that is good quality, and then let's put AI on it." (Interviewee 14)

Across both positions, attitudes were not static but evolved through use and experience. Professional identity shaped how participants positioned themselves in relation to AI and how willingly they integrated it into their practice.

5

Discussion

5.1 Informal Governance in the Absence of Institutional Support

Recent discussions on AI governance emphasize the importance of formal policies, accountability frameworks, and ethical guidelines to ensure responsible AI use in organizational contexts [22, 35, 25]. As shown in Section 4.3.1, formal governance did not provide a workable structure for everyday practice. The presence or absence of policies made little difference. In both cases, practitioners lacked usable guidance for how AI should be applied in concrete tasks. Existing policies focused mainly on restriction while decisions about use, quality, and responsibility were left undefined. Governance, as defined at the institutional level, remained detached from practice. The absence also produces a structural effect. Responsibility for managing AI shifts to individual practitioners, who must determine what counts as appropriate use, how to handle sensitive data, how much to rely on AI output, and whether to disclose its use. Since these decisions are not guided by shared standards or formal procedures, they are based on personal judgment, common sense, and professional ethics. Informal governance emerges here as a condition of work.

These individual decisions, described in Section 4.3.2, shape how governance operates in practice. Governance is embedded in the work itself and governance decisions become a necessary part of practitioner's normal workflow. They develop their own ways of handling delegation, controlling input and output, and deciding when and how to disclose the use

of AI. These practices are rarely coordinated across teams or organizations, but remain tied to individuals and vary across contexts, tasks, and levels of risk. Governance therefore takes the form of a fragmented system of personal routines. This individualization of governance exists alongside an institutional pressure to adopt AI. Several participants described using AI because of tighter deadlines, budget constraints, or employer and client expectations. Thus, the findings indicate that the development of informal rules is often the only available way to proceed in the absence of institutional guidance. This creates an asymmetry as the benefits of AI use are both individual and institutional, while the responsibility for governing it remains individual. Janssen [22] and Liu et al.[30] point to this pattern at a structural level where AI adoption benefits organizations while the costs and risks are transferred to individual workers. Participants were aware of this imbalance. They acknowledged efficiency gains but also described the burden of managing risks and quality without institutional support. This governance work is largely invisible to the organizations and projects that depend on it, despite being essential for maintaining quality and accountability in AI-assisted work. This indicates that the informal governance observed in this study was a necessary workaround for an institutional gap. Some participants recognized this gap. They expressed a need for clearer official guidance and described feeling more comfortable when institutional frameworks existed. This aligns with Silic et al. [38] and Janssen [22], who argue that informal practices alone are insufficient to manage AI responsibly and that organizations must move beyond restriction toward structured support. Furthermore, as these practices are not documented, shared, or supported, they remain largely invisible. They depend on individual practitioners and do not persist beyond them. Hence, governance is neither sustained nor developed at the organizational level. In these contexts, it therefore takes the form of an informal, distributed system that lacks coordination, visibility, and institutional support.

5.2 Delegation Boundaries and Professional Identity

Participants' boundaries around what can be delegated to AI reflect assumptions about craft, originality, and professional legitimacy. Delegation becomes a way of preserving the human core of creative work, thus functioning as an implicit governance system that is grounded in identity. The findings shown in Section 4.2.1 indicate that practitioners followed a consistent informal logic when deciding what to delegate to AI and what to

retain. This logic was mainly based on their ability to evaluate the output. Tasks were delegated when participants felt able to review, judge, and take responsibility for the result according to their own professional standards. This aligns with Wan et al. Wan et al. [44] and Ackermann [1], who find that delegation in human-AI collaboration is shaped by the human's role as the final arbiter who must be able to validate and take responsibility for the output. The selective delegation created a clear distinction between human and AI work. It was grounded in professional expertise and judgment and appeared consistently across professions and industries. In particular, tasks such as idea generation, core creative decisions, and final judgment were commonly protected. This emphasizes that delegation is not solely about assigning tasks, but about defining what should remain under human control.

This distinction also reflects how participants understand authorship and their role in the creative process, described in Section 4.4.1. By choosing what to keep and what to delegate, they position themselves as the source of ideas and the final authority over the output, while AI is used as support. The boundary therefore reflects a sense of authorship as it separates work that is seen as genuinely human from work that can be assisted or generated by AI. He et al. [20] find a similar pattern, showing that the level of initiative taken by AI during a task significantly shapes how much authorship credit practitioners assign to themselves. This suggests that delegation is closely tied to professional identity. However, this boundary was not fixed. As described in Section 4.3.2, participants applied different standards depending on context. Some were stricter about AI use in personal work, excluding the use entirely. Others were looser in personal work and applied stricter limits in contexts where accountability and professional reputation were at stake. This indicates that the boundary is personal and dependent on what each participant considered most important to protect. The distinction between human and AI work is also governed by tacit forms of judgment. Participants did not always rely on explicit reasoning when drawing this boundary. Many described their decisions through notions of gut feeling, experience, and intuition. They knew when something felt inappropriate to delegate even if they were not able to fully articulate why. This indicates a tacit governance logic, where rules participants follow are internalized through professional experience and enacted through judgment.

The findings further indicate that these decisions were shaped by practical concerns about risk. Participants were particularly careful about what

they delegated in contexts involving accountability or intellectual property. The concern was whether AI use was safe in a specific situation, not necessarily if it was ethically acceptable in general. This frames responsible AI use as practical risk management. Similar findings suggest that creative professionals often choose specific AI tools as a practical strategy to manage legal and copyright risks [25].

External pressure complicated this logic. As shown in Section 4.3.3, participants described crossing their own delegation boundaries because of tight deadlines, budget constraints, or employer and client expectations. In these cases, participants delegated tasks they would otherwise have kept human. The findings indicate that this was experienced as a compromise and the boundary was not abandoned, but stretched under pressure.

This points to a broader fragility in the delegation logic. Because it is based on personal judgment rather than shared standards, it is vulnerable to external pressure. Boundaries varied not only between participants, but also within the same individual across different contexts.

The findings therefore suggest that delegation functions as a form of informal governance. Participants regulate AI use through consistent decisions about what to delegate and what to keep, even though no formal rules require them to do so. These boundaries protect human agency, creative ownership, and professional responsibility. Thus, governance emerges from professional identity and is shaped by how participants understand their role and responsibilities. This reflects the lack of clear governance described earlier. Where organizations provide little or no guidance, participants develop their own ways of managing AI use through the boundaries they set in their work. At the same time, these boundaries depend on individual judgment and change depending on the situation. This makes them fragile, as they are continuously reshaped by external conditions.

5.3 Oversight as Invisible Labor

Human-centered AI frameworks emphasize that the utilization of AI requires control, human supervision, and accountability for AI-generated outputs [2], designating the human as the final editor who authenticates and approves AI's outputs [1, 27, 35]. The findings in Section 4.2.3 largely support this interpretation, with final responsibility being claimed by almost all participants, who described themselves as the editors and the ones

who could not blame AI for the outcome. However, this view was not universal. One participant (Interviewee 6), who had been pressured by management into using AI rather than choosing it freely, declined final responsibility for the outcome, explaining that if the decision to use AI was not genuinely theirs, neither was the accountability for the final outcome. This shift between responsibility and coercion is analytically important not because it shows a failure of professional ethics, but because it highlights a tension that most participants were downplaying. Many described being compelled to use AI due to tight deadlines, budget constraints, or employer expectations, as shown in Section 4.2.1 and throughout workflow adaptation patterns in Section 4.1.2, while simultaneously claiming full responsibility for the result. The findings suggest that oversight is not simply a bearing of accountability but a distinct and substantial layer of labor that is systematic, expertise-dependent, and entirely invisible to the organizations that depend on it. As shown in Section 4.2.3, oversight in practice followed a consistent structure across participants, involving at a minimum three operations: error-checking AI output for factual inaccuracies, hallucinations, or formatting failures, which consequently led to manual refinement to bring the output to a professional standard and fit evaluation to ensure the result aligned with client expectations, and project context. For some participants, this process was more labor-intensive. Several participants described cross-referencing AI-generated factual claims against academic databases or independent sources before accepting them, along with reading every line to ensure the output sounded like them rather than like AI. These are not incidental adjustments, that demonstrates recurring quality assurance routine that participants performed every time AI was used as a necessary subsequent task. Governance, in this sense, is not a policy applied to work from above, it is work itself.

This oversight work is only possible because participants bring something to the process that AI cannot replicate. As demonstrated in Section 4.2.3, participants consistently described domain expertise, contextual knowledge, and professional judgment as the preconditions for being able to evaluate AI output at all. The ability to recognize when an output was technically correct but contextually wrong, when a hallucination was plausible but factually false, or when a result met the prompt but missed the project depended entirely on what the human already knew. Oversight is therefore not a generic checking procedure that any attentive person could perform, but it is an expert practice that requires the same professional knowledge that the work itself requires. This means that the quality of governance is

directly tied to the professional expertise of the person doing it and is difficult to delegate or replace.

This makes the fragility of oversight governance more serious than it first appears. The system functions when individuals have enough time, expertise, and access to independent sources to perform verification properly. Under pressure, oversight is what gets compressed. Participants who described tight deadlines or high workloads noted that the thoroughness of their verification routines shortened accordingly, meaning that the governance system degrades precisely when the conditions that created the pressure, such as budget constraints, lack of resources, and unrealistic timelines, will produce errors that oversight is supposed to catch. The asymmetry identified in Section 5.1 is most clearly illustrated here. Institutions gain the benefits of AI adoption, while individuals bear the costs of governing it. The oversight work that ensures quality and accountability in AI-assisted tasks is carried out quietly, without recognition, compensation, or support. Organizations benefit from outputs that have been verified and refined by individual practitioners exercising professional judgment; the practitioners bear the burden of that verification alone.

The oversight practices described in this study, therefore, effectively function as a governance layer, a quality assurance system built from individual expertise and ethical commitment rather than an institutional framework. This layer is what fills the gap identified in 5.1, giving informal governance its practical content and operational force. However, it is a fragile layer, heavily dependent on individual capacity and professional expertise rather than structural support, which is invisible to the organizations it serves. This dependence puts it under pressure from the same efficiency expectations that drive AI adoption in the first place. As Janssen [22] and Silic, Silic & Kind-Trüller [38] argue, informal practices alone are insufficient to manage AI responsibly over time. The findings extend this point and highlight that even where informal governance is functioning well, it operates under conditions that are actively working against its sustainability.

5.4 Efficiency Pressure and Governance Instability

The literature highlights that AI adoption within creative industries is driven by process efficiencies, including reducing production costs and enabling practitioners to manage higher workloads with fewer resources [2, 14, 37]. Simultaneously, it displays that these efficiency gains create tensions with established professional values such as craft identity and authorship [8,

14]. What the literature has not sufficiently examined is how this tension operates at the level of governance, specifically, how efficiency pressure does not coexist with professional values but actively undermines the conditions that make responsible informal governance possible in the first place.

As shown in Section 4.1.2, AI adoption in this dataset was rarely motivated by enthusiasm or creative opportunity. Budget and time constraints emerged as the most consistently referenced motivation for integrating AI into professional workflows, with participants describing set deadlines they could not meet without the use of AI, along with workloads that made manual execution impossible, and employer and/or client expectations that effectively removed the choice not to use it. This was experienced as a loss of choice, whereas one participant described being given deadlines that were only achievable with AI, making it almost impossible to choose otherwise. Another driver arose adoption of AI in the dataset was a response to competitive pressure, a necessary decision rather than a governance one. This pressure-driven adoption has a direct correlation to how informal governance develops. The trial-and-error process through which practitioners arrive at their personal governance routines, learning which tasks are safe to delegate and developing verification practices of said tasks, requires time and reflection. When adoption is coerced rather than chosen, this developmental process is shortened. The participants begin using AI under conditions that do not allow for careful boundary-setting, which means informal governance develops incompletely, filling in around efficiency demands rather than preceding them.

The same pressure also actively renegotiates the boundaries of AI task delegation established in 4.2.1. Participants described a consistent personal logic for what could and could not be delegated, such as tasks they could evaluate, judge, and authorize, and tasks central to their creative work. However, several participants described crossing these boundaries under pressure. As deadlines tighten and budgets shrink, work that would previously require further refinement is accepted as final. This is not a lack of individual commitment but a structural pattern: the same constraints that make AI appealing also make it harder to maintain careful oversight. Delegation is therefore not a fixed governance practice but an ongoing compromise continuously adjusted in response to changing conditions.

Oversight practices are subject to the same dynamic as discussed in Section 5.3. Verification and refinement are key parts of informal governance, but they are often the first to be reduced when workloads increase.

Consequently, the governance system degrades under the conditions most likely to require it, the same resource constraints that make AI adoption attractive also make the careful governance of that adoption harder to sustain. When oversight is shortened under pressure, documented in Section 4.4.1, authorship claims are quietly renegotiated alongside it. Participants described accepting outputs where AI's contribution was larger than their governance principles would normally permit, taking responsibility for work they had verified less thoroughly than usual, and maintaining authorship claims over results they had less confidently shaped. These are not isolated compromises but a predictable consequence of the mismatch between what governance requires and what efficiency pressure allows.

This tension is further complicated by the degree to which the coerced use of AI for the sake of efficiency has been internalized. For many participants, resource constraints had become the primary and largely unquestioned reason for AI use justification. As a result, the conflict between efficiency and professional values was often not recognized, making it harder to identify and resist. Shadow AI practices are the clearest illustration of this pattern. Official tools were mainly defined around data security and set which systems were allowed to receive company information and which were prohibited. Participants turned to prohibited alternatives when the approved tools produced weaker results. They usually hid this from managers and claimed compliance with the approved tools. The results show that this is not individual non-compliance but a team norm that develops because the tools provided are not sufficient to meet efficiency expectations. Furthermore, the findings show that the data boundary held even when the tool boundary did not. Participants who used unapproved tools still protected sensitive material before entering it, such as removing real names or blurring identifying details. The rule they enforced concerned what data could be exposed. This indicates that the difference between sanctioned and shadow use was not a difference in governance. The same informal rule about data sensitivity operated across both. What separated official from shadow AI use was which tool produced usable work. Participants bypassed the sanctioned tool for output quality and kept the data rule they considered most important. While this rule held steady, the tool boundary around it did not.

The findings suggest that informal governance in creative AI work is not stable but continuously adjusted, a result of structural imbalance between efficiency expectations and governance requirements. Delegation boundaries, oversight practices, and authorship claims are not established once

and maintained, instead they are adjusted, and renegotiated in response to the same pressures that drive AI adoption in the first place. Where organizations provide little guidance and much pressure, participants are left to govern AI use through personal judgment. Therefore, informal governance does not develop through deliberate, agreed-upon professional design but emerges from individual experiences, formed by adoption pressures. As this study finds, without institutional recognition of this governance work and without structures that ease the pressure instead of intensifying it, informal governance will remain essential to the work it supports yet invisible to the organizations that depend on it, and fragile.

6

Conclusion

6.1 Summary of Findings

This study investigates how creative professionals develop informal governance practices for responsible GenAI use and how they decide which tasks to delegate to AI in the absence of formal institutional guidance.

Across all four themes, the study found that informal governance in creative AI work arises through practice and adaptation due to a lack of formal organizational policies. In answer to the first research question, creative professionals develop informal governance practices through personal judgment, professional ethics, and self-imposed routines. Participants establish data confidentiality boundaries as defaults and apply structured oversight processes of verification and refinement every time AI is used. In answer to the second research question, delegation decisions follow a consistent pattern based on accountability. Tasks are delegated to AI when the participants feel able to evaluate the output and take personal responsibility for the final result. Meanwhile, tasks tied to creative identity and final judgment are kept under human control. Nevertheless, the same efficiency pressures that encourage AI adoption also weaken the stability of these governance practices, making informal governance essential.

6.2 Contributions

This study contributes practice-based insights into how informal AI governance operates in creative professional work, an area where previous research has mainly focused on policy frameworks and outcome-based measures rather than the everyday practices of individual professionals. The study expands existing research on shadow AI by examining how governance develops through delegation decisions, oversight routines, and negotiations around authorship and shows that these practices are not simply informal workarounds but necessary responses to the lack of institutional guidance. The findings also challenge human-centered AI frameworks that assume human oversight naturally exists and functions effectively. Instead, the study shows that oversight requires skill, effort, and time and may become unstable under workplace pressures without proper institutional support and recognition.

6.3 Limitations

Despite these contributions, the study has several limitations that need to be acknowledged. Firstly, participants' accounts could not be verified through direct observation of professional work practices. Differences may exist between reported and enacted behavior. Secondly, the study captures practices during a period of rapid technological change. As GenAI tools continuously evolve, the findings reflect the conditions of work in the beginning 2026. Lastly, the sample consisted primarily of professionals working in Sweden and Georgia. Hence, the findings may have limited transferability to other industries or geographic settings.

6.4 Ethical and Societal Implications

The findings raise ethical and societal concerns that extend the scope of this study. The most significant concern is the unequal distribution of responsibility that informal governance produces. As discussed in Section 5.1, organizations benefit from AI adoption through improved efficiency and output, while the work of governing that adoption relies entirely on individuals. This includes verifying outputs, protecting sensitive data, and managing questions of authorship, all without formal frameworks or recognition. This distribution is ethically significant as the labor required to

govern AI responsibly is treated as part of the job without being acknowledged as such. The coercion dynamic identified in Section 5.3 adds to this concern as practitioners have less opportunity to exercise meaningful oversight when they are required to use AI.

At the organizational level, the shadow AI practices described in Section 5.4 suggest that formal governance frameworks are not aligned with the actual work. When practitioners choose not to use approved tools because those tools do not meet the demands of their work, it reflects an organizational issue. When organizations rely on informal governance without addressing this issue, they shift the responsibility for institutional risk onto individual practitioners.

At a broader societal level, the study's findings have implications for how human oversight is understood in public and regulatory settings. Frameworks such as the EU AI Act place responsibility on human users but pay less attention to the working conditions under which that responsibility is carried out [19, 35]. If oversight weakens under efficiency pressure, as this study finds, then simply requiring human review may not be enough to ensure responsible AI use in practice. This has consequences for both the quality of AI-assisted creative work entering the public domain and for how regulators and organizations design governance structures that can function under real working conditions.

6.5 Future Research

Several directions for future research emerge from this study. Longitudinal studies following the same professionals over time could examine how informal governance practices stabilize, transform, or disappear as GenAI technologies evolve and organizational norms become institutionalized. Research incorporating perspectives from managers, clients, and AI developers alongside creative professionals could further clarify how governance is negotiated across stakeholder groups with competing priorities and responsibilities. Comparative studies across creative industries such as film, music production, or game design could assess whether the patterns identified in this study extend to other forms of creative labor or require contextual adaptation. Future research could also evaluate the practical implementation of governance frameworks or training initiatives designed to support responsible AI use within creative professional environments.

This study demonstrates that creative professionals actively construct informal governance practices to protect authorship and manage institutional expectations when using GenAI tools. These practices emerge from tensions between formal policies and everyday workflows, particularly in contexts where organizational guidance is unclear or absent. A clearer understanding of these practices may help organizations develop governance frameworks that support responsible AI use in creative industries.

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Appendix A — Consent Form

Informed Consent Form Researcher: Mariami Khukhunashvili; Amina Lawal
Contact Information: khukhunashvilimariami@gmail.com;
aminalawal@gmx.de
Organization: Stockholm University

You are invited to participate in a master's thesis study conducted by two students at Stockholm University. This study explores how creative professionals use generative AI tools in their everyday work, with a particular focus on responsibility, authorship, trust, and informal governance practices.

Your participation is entirely voluntary. You will be asked to provide some background information and share your experiences related to AI use in creative work. Participation involves a semi-structured interview, which will be audio-recorded with your consent. The study aims to better understand everyday practices rather than evaluate specific AI tools.

All data will be treated confidentially and used solely for academic purposes as part of this master's thesis. Any identifying information (such as names, organizations, or specific projects) will be removed or anonymized during transcription and analysis. Only the two researchers and the thesis supervisor will have access to the collected data. Data will be stored securely in accordance with GDPR requirements and deleted after the thesis has been completed and approved.

Some topics discussed may relate to sensitive workplace practices or personal reflections. You may skip any question you do not wish to answer and may withdraw from the study at any time without providing a reason.

By taking part in this study, you are agreeing on the following terms:

- My participation in this study is voluntary.
- I can withdraw my consent to participate in this study at any time.

- The purpose and structure of this study have been explained to me, and I fully understand them.
- I agree to my interview being audio recorded.
- I will not directly benefit from this study.
- My identity will remain confidential and will not be disclosed in the final report.

Thank you.

Appendix B — Interview Questions

Background & Roles

1. Can you briefly describe your current role and the kind of creative work that you do?

2. What tools or technologies are central to your daily work? (variations: “maybe two or three”, “do they have an AI feature?”)

Task Delegation

3. Can you walk me through a recent situation where you used or deliberately avoided using generative AI?

4. How do you decide which tasks are appropriate to delegate to GenAI, and which are not?

5. Which specific tasks did you hand off to AI, and which do you feel are “off-limits” for automation?

6. Are there tasks that you would never use AI for? Why?

Oversight & Control

7. Once AI generates an output, what is your personal filter process for verifying it before you consider it ready?

8. Can you describe a time when an AI tool provided a “hallucination” or a flawed result and how did you adjust your workflow afterwards?

9. How do you ensure that the AI-assisted results you deliver still align with the specific values or “voice” of your client?

10. How do you decide when AI output needs correction, rewriting, or rejection?

11. Who do you feel is responsible for the final outcome when AI is involved?

Authorship & Trust

12. How do you determine if you have enough personal ownership over a piece of work to put your name on it after using AI?

13. If the AI provided the core idea but you performed all the refinement, who do you feel "owns" the result?

14. Have you ever felt that using AI for a specific task made you feel "separated" from your craft, or like your skills were degrading?

15. When delivering a project, how do you decide whether or not to mention the tool's involvement to your clients or colleagues?

Formal & Informal Rules

16. Are there formal rules or policies in your organization regarding AI use?

17. What "unwritten rules" do you follow to decide if a new AI tool is safe for work data?

18. Do you follow any personal rules, habits, or unwritten guidelines when using AI?

19. Have there been situations where AI use felt unclear or uncomfortable to talk about at work?

20. Have these practices changed over time? What triggered those changes?

21. Do your personal rules for using AI change when working on a personal project versus a paid client project?

22. Have you ever decided to "opt-out" of using a specific AI tool because of concerns about its training data or legal status?

23. Do you discuss AI use rules or boundaries with colleagues or clients?

Closing

24. Is there anything I haven't asked that you deem important to mention, given the study's purpose?

Appendix C — Thematic Analysis

Theme	Category	Code
AI Integration in Creative Work	Modes of AI Use	AI as assistant
AI Integration in Creative Work	Modes of AI Use	AI as collaborator
AI Integration in Creative Work	Modes of AI Use	AI as first draft
AI Integration in Creative Work	Modes of AI Use	AI as skill boost
AI Integration in Creative Work	Modes of AI Use	AI for repetitive/technical tasks
AI Integration in Creative Work	Modes of AI Use	AI for mock-ups/testing
AI Integration in Creative Work	Modes of AI Use	low intensity AI use
AI Integration in Creative Work	Modes of AI Use	pervasive AI adoption
AI Integration in Creative Work	Workflow Adaptation	hybrid AI-manual workflow
AI Integration in Creative Work	Workflow Adaptation	adjusting workflow
AI Integration in Creative Work	Workflow Adaptation	trial and error
AI Integration in Creative Work	Workflow Adaptation	prompting literacy

Theme	Category	Code
AI Integration in Creative Work	Workflow Adaptation	budget/time-driven use
AI Integration in Creative Work	Workflow Adaptation	rapid AI change
AI Integration in Creative Work	Workflow Adaptation	corporate AI tools useless
Delegation, Control & Human Judgment	Delegation Decisions	delegating authorizable tasks
Delegation, Control & Human Judgment	Delegation Decisions	predefined expectation before AI use
Delegation, Control & Human Judgment	Delegation Decisions	fit evaluation
Delegation, Control & Human Judgment	Delegation Decisions	wish to delegate more
Delegation, Control & Human Judgment	Delegation Decisions	client AI preference
Delegation, Control & Human Judgment	Protecting the Human Core	protecting creative process
Delegation, Control & Human Judgment	Protecting the Human Core	human irreplaceable
Delegation, Control & Human Judgment	Protecting the Human Core	no replacement fear
Delegation, Control & Human Judgment	Protecting the Human Core	replacement fear
Delegation, Control & Human Judgment	Protecting the Human Core	role shift because of AI
Delegation, Control & Human Judgment	Protecting the Human Core	AI replaced human tasks
Delegation, Control & Human Judgment	Protecting the Human Core	AI devaluation of creative labor
Delegation, Control & Human Judgment	Protecting the Human Core	tolerance for mistakes due to knowledge / experience
Delegation, Control & Human Judgment	Oversight, Verification & Accountability	manual refinement
Delegation, Control & Human Judgment	Oversight, Verification & Accountability	distrust of AI output

Theme	Category	Code
Delegation, Control & Human Judgment	Oversight, Verification & Accountability	AI capacity limitations
Delegation, Control & Human Judgment	Oversight, Verification & Accountability	AI output is detectable
Delegation, Control & Human Judgment	Oversight, Verification & Accountability	final responsibility
Delegation, Control & Human Judgment	Oversight, Verification & Accountability	final authority

Appendix D — Interview Transcripts

INTERVIEW 01

02/16/2026 | 42 Minutes | Content Designer

Interviewer: Before we start the interview: the information you provide as well as your company's details will be completely anonymized. But in order to anonymize it, I would still kindly ask you to not mention the company name during the interview.

Interviewee01: Yeah.

Interviewer: Also, this interview is being recorded, only for transcription purposes. It will not be shared elsewhere. Is that all right with you?

Interviewee01: Perfect.

Interviewer: Also, have you read the informed consent that details everything about how the data is processed? So participation is voluntary, you can withdraw any time during the interview and your identity will remain confidential.

Interviewee01: Yes, perfect, I signed it as well.

Interviewer: Okay, perfect, so then you consent to the recording and the transcription?

Interviewee01: Yes

Interviewer: Alright. So, just before we start with the actual questions: can you briefly describe your current role and the kind of creative work that you do?

Interviewee01: Of course! So, my current role is a content designer and I work within an internal team which focuses on user experience. And within that team I work with product designers, I work with user researchers,

I work with strategists, engineers and project managers and we pretty much take care of all of the internal applications for basically making sure that everything in the company runs smoothly. So, basically looking at time keeping apps because you know I work for a consultancy and we need to report our time so that we can get paid so we have an app for that, we have apps for requesting vacation, so many different apps to just keep things going. The user experience team makes sure that obviously, they are, suitable and usable and accessible and yeah i'd say that is what we do in short.

Interviewer: Okay interesting. You already mentioned a few apps, but what are your key tools or technologies that are very central to your daily work?

Interviewee01: I would say definitely number one is Figma. It's the biggest design tool. I use it every day, even though I'm not a designer. But what's nice is that it's a very collaborative tool, so it's very easy to share files and get into files and work in tandem with the person who created the file. So you'll find a designer [who] creates a file, and then they'll share it with the content designer and the ux researcher, and we're all working together. So, there's a reason why it's the number one design tool because it's really good. And then we also have other tools, so we have jira which is kind of like a task management app, so a lot of it companies use Jira to manage their time and their projects, and just also keep track of like big projects that have a lot of little moving parts. So, within a project, they'll create little subtasks so that once the subtask is done, you can tick it as complete to see the progress of the project, so that you can also show clients that you guys are doing good work and things like that. And then we also use replicon. Replicon is for time keeping, so that's where we report our weekly time. So, every week we have to work 40 hours, and we also have to specify what we did. So we each have a project code. I'm a content designer, I have a content design project code that I put in when I bill my time, so that they can see when they are doing the pay slips and things like that, where to send the money. And then, I'm trying to think of another important App. There's benefy, that's very important actually because that's where our benefits are and it's really cool because a lot of companies in Stockholm give the employees a certAIn amount for fix ward um so we get about 5 000 and we are able to get discounts and things like that on the benefy App because it's linked to our [COMPANY] employee account. So if you're in Sweden and you work ...oh sorry, I said the company name

Interviewer: It's fine, it's gonna be anonymized

Interviewee01: Okay, okay, sorry. So, yes, if you're in Sweden and you work at that specific company, then you will have access to benefy, which is really cool because you get a lot of different stuff so yeah there's a lot of different Apps, I'm not gonna name all of them but yeah those are the mAIn ones I would say we use every day.

Interviewer: Okay great. So since this study explores the use of AI, and I know this is a sensitive topic, but I'm assuming that all of or some of your technologies and tools that you use and applications already have an AI feature. So, I'm kind of interested, do you use the AI features or, for example, do you have a recent situation where you used it, or even decided "no, I'm definitely not going to use it for this situation"?

Interviewee01: Yes, of course. There's a lot of AI right now. It's the hot topic; everybody is wanting a piece of that, but I think there's also a danger in using so much AI because now everything you see is AI-generated, and you don't know whether or not it was written by a human or whether it was a machine. So I think for me, especially as a writer, I have to be very careful how I use AI. But I'm not going to sit here and lie to you and say that I don't use it because I do. But it's just the way in which I use; it is more of like a thought-starter and like a helper, like an inspiration-giver when I'm trying to start a specific project, and I need initial research, so will start off my research process on ChatGPT, I will research the topic, or I will research the specific project at hand. And then, when it starts to come to the things that actually go into the apps that I write for, I do not use AI for that. I will literally go into the Figma file and type in all of the different microcopy and the different words that go into the buttons and the different screens and things like that. So I think, yes, definitely for initial research phase, I will use AI, but for the outcome and the output, I definitely write it myself because we just have to make sure that we're careful how we use AI. So yeah, that's my process. Other people use it more, like the designers. There's AI where you can now create designs; you can just type something in, and it will design the whole app for you. There's an app called lovable, literally say "design an app that connects students to discounted trips or vacations," and it will design it for you. So, I mean, it's amazing how quickly it's learning and how amazing the things that it's doing, but I think still it's relevant to have a human within the tech just to make sure that everything still sounds okay. And also, AI is not perfect; it can make mistakes, it can hallucinate, so we just have to double-check and make sure that everything is in check before we publish it.

Interviewer: You already mentioned a lot of things that I'm definitely also gonna ask you about later. Do you, because you mentioned human oversight, so once an ai like ChatGPT or whatever generates an output do you have a personal filter process to verify it before you consider "oh this i'm going to use it" or how do you review that this output is good?

Interviewee01: That is a beautiful question, and I'm so glad you asked because I think a lot of people are using ChatGPT but they're using it wrong. They're not like optimizing it because they think they're going to ask it a question, and then they're going to take the first answer it gives them. You need to challenge ChatGPT like you're talking to a friend, you know. If your friend told you something that you didn't believe, you wouldn't just take it, you'd be like, "no but explain a little bit further". And I really urge people to do that with ChatGPT. There was this article where it said that there was a study done [that] the more rude you are in your prompt the more accurate answer you get but if you say "please" and "thank you" and, you know, just help me, support me, i don't know why but you know, i think if you just get to the point and if you keep challenging the answer that it gives you keep asking questions; be inquisitive. Don't just settle for the first answer it gives you. I really urge you to keep going for more and more and more, and then what you can also do, which makes it a bit interesting, is put it into another AI. So, for example claude AI and see what Claude AI says, and then try to make a distinction between the two answers and see what's the same, what's different, what's the tone like. I think it's so cool that we have all of these different ais to use for free, like DeepSeek as well. If you're doing like deeper research work, everybody's posts are starting to sound like ChatGPT but if you're using claude you would know that Claude is actually really good for writers because it sounds more human. It uses more of a human language, it's less robotic, and it's really believable in the sense that you think that you're having a conversation with someone that's texting you on the other side. So yeah, different ais have different jobs. ChatGPT does a good job with big data, analyzing a lot of like information, but if you want to do something a bit more creative, a little bit more writing-focused, [you] want to build a narrative, then I'd say Claude. So it just depends, like what you're doing. I'd recommend trying different AI and challenging them and testing them against each other as well to get the best output.

Interviewer: That's very interesting. You mentioned before also the problem with the hallucinations. Can you like recall a time when an ai provided a hallucination or a flawed result and how did you handle this? how did you maybe adjust your usual workflow?

Interviewee01: yeah I actually remember I was working on a project and it was like a lot of data and I knew that come on ChatGPT can't process everything correctly, so, you know, when you're working with big excel spreadsheets and there's just numbers and words and formulas things can get a bit messy and you know I was thinking "okay I'm using ChatGPT to process this data to give me insights let's just see". So the first few batches were okay because they were like smaller chunks, but when I, for example, did a bigger Excel sheet, that's when I started noticing it giving me wrong things that were not even in the original document. And that's when I was like "oh okay let me just double check, let me go in" let me actually...the nice thing about ChatGPT is that when you call it out on its shit - can I say that sorry, I don't know.

Interviewer: It's okay .

Interviewee01: I can't say when you call it out on its shit. So, for example when you see something up and you say "that answer is incorrect, I noticed that you put something wrong, go back and check it", it will say "oh thank you so much for spotting that, I did make a mistake" and it will tell you its thought process of what it did and what it did wrong and how it's going to correct it. So, it's actually quite nice because it's like it's kind of showing you a history of the event, so you can track it back and then see how it changed it. So you can see if the final output is right or wrong. So I just kept doing that until it was giving me the right thing. It took a couple of tries and a couple of prompts, but really, I was not nice and sweet in my prompts. I was like, "You cannot get this wrong", even like in caps, I was shouting at it. I was like, "Don't get this wrong, this is very important, this is for my manager", you know. But it's crazy, prompting it like that, but it works.

Interviewer: I can imagine. So I mean that also means, I'm assuming now, that you also feel responsible for that final outcome, am I right in that assumption?

Interviewee01: Yes, definitely, because that's my name, you know. If I'm taking the final outcome and then I'm like putting it out which is like... actually you shouldn't be doing that because you should always be changing what ChatGPT gives you but yeah, I mean yeah just you are responsible for the final outcome and the information that you share so you have to make sure that it's the correct information, so you don't go share some wrong things with your manager and then you look like you are incompetent. We don't need that.

Interviewer: That makes sense. So before we go into... because I'm very much interested in also informal rules but before, I want to know if there are any formal rules or policies in your organization regarding AI use and if they're also clear or unclear and how you navigate this?

Interviewee01: Yes. So there are very clear AI policies in the sense that we cannot share, obviously, internal sensitive documentation with the AI, screenshots, documents, we're not allowed to do that. But the way that my company has kind of found a loophole around it is, because we are with Microsoft, we've got Co-Pilot. And Co-Pilot has... basically, it works as the Microsoft version, it's the Microsoft version of ChatGPT, so you can go into Co-Pilot and prompted exactly like you would ChatGPT. It's obviously not that strong in terms of like the speed, and I think the output it gives you, but it's okay, like it will get you by. So what they've said at my company is that if you're wanting to process internal documentation or company-sensitive stuff, rather do it in Co-Pilot because that's the software that the company has bought, whereas ChatGPT, our company doesn't have a license with ChatGPT. Everybody is using their own personal ChatGPT which is why they say that we can't put in personal company documents because we don't know what ChatGPT is doing with that information so those are pretty much the policies and ... It's very interesting because now people are asking how are you wanting us to include AI in our workflows to make it quicker but you're not paying for the licenses, we're using our own ChatGPT because people are paying for their own pro licenses. I'm paying for my own Pro license of ChatGPT because I mean, I also use it for my own private life. So, that goes to say that ChatGPT will reign superior no matter what, it will always be like the most powerful one because I think Co-Pilot tried, but yes, not the best to be honest. But yeah, that's what we use for the company.

Interviewer: Interesting, do you have any like personal rules or like unwritten rules?

Interviewee01: Yes, I do actually, so I don't know if you know this trend that's happening at the moment. Everybody is making ChatGPT caricatures, so it's like pictures of themselves, and I think what they do is you have to upload a photo of yourself, and then type in stuff that you like and then it's going to make like a cartoon picture of you with like sitting on the beach or like drinking wine and a lot of people are doing it and it's all over LinkedIn, I don't know why it's so big on LinkedIn but I think any time I have to input a picture of myself into AI I get a little bit hesitant because of like biometrics and bio data and things like that. I think we're already sharing so much, like now you want my face and my fingerprints, oh hell no. So

I think that's where I like put a hard stop to it but in terms of like telling it what medication I'm on, telling it things about my personal life, about my menstrual flow, asking it questions like about my mental health, I'm very open with it like that, but I think when it comes to like my face and my bio data. That's like a big no-no for me.

Interviewer: And at work, do you have, when you're working on a project or when you're, I don't know doing something, do you have rules there?

Interviewee01: I just always make sure I follow the privacy rules, but besides that, no I use it as best as I see fit

Interviewer: Do you ever or has there ever been a situation where the use of AI felt uncomfortable to talk about at work or unclear?

Interviewee01: Yes, it's a big stigma, it's a big stigma, and I think especially for writers, it is going to start becoming. For designers, because now there's an AI that can literally design an App it does their job in five minutes, so before all of that when it was still only ChatGPT I would feel bad using AI because I would think that people would think that I'm not a good enough writer if I need AI, and people would think that I'm cheating and not doing the work. But then when I realized that I'm not using it to do my work, I'm using it to help me do my work that's when my perception changed and then I stopped feeling shy to be like having ChatGPT on my screen and then, you know, when your colleague goes past you behind you and they look over at your screen and they see you've got ChatGPT on, I used to be so like cringe but now I'm like I don't care, everybody's using ChatGPT, literally everybody's using ChatGPT like they're lying if they think they're not using ChatGPT.

Interviewer: Do you discuss it maybe informally, you and your colleagues sometimes, or maybe, are you discussing rules or boundaries, or is it more like an open secret?

Interviewee01: I think it is an open secret because I think we all know that we're using it, and I think what I try and discuss is how to use it properly and safely. I feel like that's my job as a content designer: if you're going to be using this content, that it's giving you, then here are some rules to follow so that you're using it properly to the best of its abilities. So yeah, that's how I discuss AI with my colleagues. But we definitely know that the designers are using something called Figma Make. So basically, that is part of figma but now all you have to do is go in, type in a prompt, and it will design the whole thing for you. So we obviously know that designers are definitely using that because it's saving them so much time. So it's starting to become

really like an open topic; we all know we're doing it, and we're just trying to make sure that we're doing it safely and following the rules.

Interviewer: Can I maybe go into that a little more specific if I can? Is there an example for a rule that you have, or... because you say oh you're definitely going to follow rules, but is it just the company rules, or is it, do you maybe have to discuss with colleagues, let's say, one colleague says oh I would never use AI for this specific project, or for this, I would never use this prompt, and you were like oh actually I always do this, or something?

Interviewee01: That's actually a good question. Let me think about that real quick. Yeah, actually, I have. It was actually with my manager. So my manager is a little bit older, he is, I think 58, so he's very much used to doing things manually, and even though he's very much into innovating and, you know, staying up to date with like the latest tech, I realized that some things that he still did manually, like, for example, PowerPoint presentations. I think PowerPoint presentations are a little bit outdated, like we don't really use PowerPoint presentations in tech anymore, like we use Figma or we use.. There's so many other things; there's Figma, there's Keynote, there's a lot of other things, like Mentimeter, you know, if you wanted to be interactive presentation, so people are not really using PowerPoint anymore. But he was very insistent on using PowerPoint like the old school way, making sure that it had a footer and a page number, and he was very focused on like the alignment, and I'm like okay, no one cares because I can just go and type a prompt and tell [AI] to align my presentation, but you want me to do it manually, why. I don't know, it's wasting time, it's boring, and it looks outdated, it looks old. So like yeah, that was like something that I couldn't like shake off, but I mean, someone is insistent on wanting to use a specific uh PowerPoint template, then you have to use it, you know, you can't put it in AI even though I would do it in five minutes and it would be quicker and would look much better.

Interviewer: Now we're going a little bit more into authorship, which you mentioned in the beginning, or ownership, and also trust, because you said that a lot of people said oh there's this, you know, reputation of if you're using AI, especially as a creative professional, if you're using AI are you still actually a creative professional in that sense, or are you going to be replaced. So the question is, how do you determine if you have enough personal ownership over a piece of work that you put your name on after using AI?

Interviewee01: That is such a good question, actually, and it's something that I haven't even thought of measuring because it's, I guess, it's different in each different context, it depends, so for example, if I have to write a hundred error messages for a specific workflow, I'm not humanly possibly going to be able to do that. And myself as a creative professional, I know that AI can definitely give me some good error messages if I prompt it properly, then that's when I decide okay I'm gonna let it do all of the error messages, and I'm gonna take them as they are, I'm gonna read through them, obviously, but I'm gonna take them as they are because I know that that's something... It's like it knows how to do it, has enough data sets to know how to write specific error messages, so I'm confident in AI in that sense. So I'll let it write the error messages for me and give them to the engineers just like that. Okay but if it's something more, where it's a bit more creative, I need to, you know, put together a narrative, tell the brand story, talk about like the brand ethics, and, you know, how we bring that together in our strategy and how we work, you know, how we bring the heart and soul of our creativity into it ... I can't ask ChatGPT to do that, you know, so it's very contextual. If it's more like technical quick work for sure, please, it would take me a week to write a hundred error messages, ChatGPT five minutes, let's go. But the more creative storytelling stuff I personally like, yes, I guess Claude AI could do it, but I would not feel comfortable. I think that's something where you have to go out and talk to people, see what they say, write it down, put it together, find the connection, you know. So I don't think AI is, it's smart, but it's not that smart.

Interviewer: In the beginning, you also mentioned that AI.. Usually, you use AI as a thought starter, as an inspiration, you know, a starting point. You don't have to, basically, you don't have the blank page and create out of nothing, so let's say the AI kind of provided this core idea, but you performed all the refinement: who do you feel owns the result then?

Interviewee01: Oh, you're now testing my ethics, so I think if I didn't initially prompt it with my thoughts and my ideas, it wouldn't give me that specific output, like I think it's like a cause and effect thing, right? Like it needs to something needs to be done for it to give you the output, so I think I'm the owner, it's my intellectual property, because also I'm not taking it as it is the way it gives it to me, I think that also depends on how you use the output it gives you. Do you alter it to your liking, or do you use it as it is, because then that's where kind of like the ethics start to blur a little bit, so I don't know, it's a very interesting question. It's getting me very philosophical, just fyi, because it's like, actually, that's a good question, I

never thought about it. But I think if I were to give you like an answer, like gun to my head, I think at the end of the day it's my thoughts, it's my idea, it's me prompting it, it's me changing the outcome, and it's me presenting the work in my words and my thoughts.

Interviewer: Absolutely. Have you ever felt that using AI for a task made you feel like your skills were degrading, or like separate?

Interviewee01: Yes, all the time, all the time. And you know, there's this thing about like AI in the next 18 months, the CEO of Microsoft said that in the next 18 months, around it's ridiculous 85 White-collar jobs are going to be replaced by AI. That's like a scary statistic, and if it's being said by someone like a CEO of Microsoft is like, yeah, he knows what's up, you know. So it's really scary because I do feel like, okay, honest to god, if we were talking basics, AI could definitely do my job, no problem, it could dish out workflows, microcopy, it could do content guidelines, it could do all of that stuff. But I think then you'll know because, like a company like Klarna, for example. I'll give you a like a relevant example that we all know and see every day. Klarna did layoffs in 2022 and replaced almost over 60 percent of their stuff with AI. Klarna has lost its soul, like every time I see anything Klarna related online, even on the App, it's so mechanical, it's so cold, it's so, it feels like a bank now, whereas when I worked there. It had a little bit of spunk, it had energy like I used to love, like the copy that Klarna used to write. It was so funny, it was so like tongue-in-cheek, it was witty, sometimes a little bit sassy, oh my gosh, I mean, they even got Snoop Dog to do like Ads for them and A$AP Rocky as well, like that's when humans were part of the brand. Now it's kind of just cold and just AI, like you can just see everything is done by AI, and it makes such a difference, and you can tell as well, so it's yeah, definitely we can be replaced, but I think there's always going to be a need for someone to like delegate the AI. So, for example, there's a new, I can call it like a work role called content engineer, so there aren't content designers anymore now, it's content engineers. And content engineers are going to be expected to be able to work with AI on a daily basis and create rules for how the team should use AI, so that's what the job is turning into. So it went from one thing to now dealing and working and prioritizing AI as if it's a colleague. So it's very interesting times. I'm actually thinking about doing a course just to sharpen up my skills in AI because it's going to be very important, especially looking for new jobs and new opportunities. People are definitely looking if you have skills or certifications in something to do with AI because that's what our jobs are going to turn into, and if you don't keep up, then you're gotta step out, that's what a lot of people say.

Interviewer: So, that also leads me to my last question. When you deliver a project or a task, do you ever mention that you use AI? And how do you decide whether or not to mention that you use AI even if you're just talking to your colleagues, or if you're talking to clients?

Interviewee01: Wow, these questions are really good, actually. These are really good. You guys did a good job, wow, sorry, I just have to congratulate you because these are so thought-provoking and so good, it's really like starting to make me question myself.

Interviewer: But that's not the purpose of this study, we just need to know about ownership and well, its informal rules and AI in general.

Interviewee01: Well, I love it, I think these are brilliant, and yeah, it's like, again, I think it depends, right? So, for example, if I have a casual brainstorm, a creative brainstorm with my team, where we're brainstorming how to solve an idea of course, I'm going to use AI as an initial thought starter to give me ideas, do competitor marketing to see what our competitors are doing, I'm not going to like go on every single competitor website and check them. I'm going to use AI to collect all of that stuff for me that, so that I can use it in the brainstorm. In that context I wouldn't tell my team that I used ChatGPT to brainstorm because chances are they all did as well but I think in when you're handing over a full-on project and you are taking the team through how you delivered it you show them your thought process, and your design process, and in the beginning you have to say I used AI to a get some thought starting ideas, do some example text or example designs or competitor analysis, you know. And then you kind of show how you worked through it. And then if you did use AI to generate some of the content or some of the initial designs, that should always be as your, like, first draft. So kind of like this was my first draft, and then I took it and then elaborated on it and changed it like this, and added this, and did that, and did that. So I think as long as you show that from the AI output, this is what you changed, and you explain your thinking of why that's absolutely fine, that's no problem at all.

Interviewer: Okay, can I ask like one more question, because what you said is kind of like raised the question for me now, because it seems like you've maybe in your team did you establish like a little routine here that everybody kind of does, or did it just emerge, and you're assuming now that everybody does it, or it was organic?

Interviewee01: In my years of working in tech and in creative teams, this is majority, how it usually happens, like it's a given, and I don't want to, obviously, stereotype, but usually this is how it works when I've worked

in different teams at different companies. Usually, people will show their thought process and show their assistance used by AI, you know. There are some people out there that are not that ethical and maybe do the whole thing using AI, and then say that it's their own work. But I think they're really risking it because now it's so easy to see when something is AI-generated, like it's, you don't even have to be an expert to spot, so I think you're actually doing yourself a disservice by not saying you use AI if you did, because we will know anyway. So just say that you used it, but then show us how you changed it, you know.

Interviewer: Yeah great. So that was it basically. This is the option do you think, given that you know the study, the research purpose is to explore how creative professionals use AI and how they navigate oversight, ownership, control, decide which tasks to delegate to AI, which not... so given that and all the questions we've been going through, is there anything that you would like to mention where you think no this is actually also very important you didn't ask for that but I still think that you should, I want to say this?

Interviewee01: Okay, I'll give you a case study of how important AI agents are becoming. So recently, my company built an internal AI, so an internal like ChatGPT, but for the company specifically. And they put a lot of money behind it, and it was a global project, and everybody was involved, and you know, everything had to be, you know, working to the best of its capabilities because there were a lot of investments and things like that. And you know the importance behind this AI was, you know, what if we were to create a ChatGPT but for our company. So, for example, because our company is so big, there's so much information you need to know, and so many different places to get it, and can get confusing. So if I have a question for HR, for example, I don't have to think about oh whose email address do I need then go to my Outlook and then email the HR person and wait for them for five days to respond to. No, they wanted to cut all of that out, so if I wanted to say how many leave days do I have, you can go in and type that in. And because it's connected to your company account, it will say "okay, Lee, you have five leave days left," and etc. So I think companies are taking this AI thing like one step further to the point where they are now building their own native AI like agents that will help them do now our time sheets, we can just go in the in the in the AI and say fill in timesheet, and then it does it automatically. So we don't have to go to replicon and do the timesheets, so everything is becoming automated by AI, and I think this is what a lot of companies are doing and putting a lot of money into, which

means that, for sure, for the future, this is something that is going to be big. But on the other hand, a lot of people are saying that the AI bubble is about to burst, so what does the world look like if we go back to a time without AI? That's a very interesting question, and it's going to happen sooner than people are expecting, and it's very scary, so that's all I have to say about that. Just that it's very uncertain times because people are very excited about AI, but are also forgetting that trends also come to an end, so yeah, let's see how much longer the hype lasts. Yeah, it'll be interesting.

INTERVIEW 02

02/18/2026 | 40 Minutes | Content Designer

Interviewer: Alright, so before starting the interview, the information you provide, as well as company details, will be completely anonymized. Also, your participation is voluntary. You can stop the interview at any time. The interview will be recorded transcribed, only used for academic purposes and your identity will remain confidential. Do you consent to participate in the interview and being recorded?

Interviewee02: Yes, I do.

Interviewer: Great, amazing. So first of all, can you briefly describe what you're doing right now, your role, and the kind of creative work you do? Maybe, how long have you been doing it already?

Interviewee02: Yeah. I'm in the field of user experience design. I'm a content designer. So I did train in UX design in general, but I specifically work mostly on [COMPANY] business app products, mobile products, and I work on the wording and the information that is within the user interface.

Interviewer: Okay cool. What kind of tools or technologies do you use for your daily work? Like maybe two or three.

Interviewee02: Figma is the main one for the actual design work. And then we use a lot of Miro, yeah. I think that's like mostly... it's just like a lot of it is in Figma. I do most of my work there, yeah.

Interviewer: Alright. Now we're getting into the more deeper stuff. Can you walk me through, like a recent situation where you used genAI, like ChatGPT, at work? Or maybe also chose not to use it for some reasons?

Interviewee02: I've actually started using it quite a lot. I mean, I... do you want just one example? Because I have a few different examples.

Interviewer: You can tell me different examples, if you want to.

Interviewee02: Yeah, I mean, I can go into detail. So [COMPANY] really started us off on AI, I would say, fairly early as far as a lot of tech companies go. Not all of them, of course, but actually, content design was the first discipline to get an AI tool in [COMPANY] because it's a financial company. They're quite particular about letting these proprietary companies in because of the data. So we're quite limited about what.. we can't just upload data into like open ChatGPT, right? So, it took a while to get those licenses, but content design got a tool called XX quite a while ago, and that was supposed to help us write the content. It was supposed to put it in like so, for example, you're given a flow, and you're trying to solve a problem for a user, and this tool was fed and taught the [COMPANY] style guide,

the [COMPANY] tone and voice, and it was supposed to help us rewrite the content itself. Now, we all quite quickly realized it's actually not super great at that, so I tried to use that for a while, and yeah, it was just. . . .I think it. . . a lot of those tools are better for long-form content, and I do a lot of microcopy, you know, like buttons and labels. And they're just so kind of context dependent, and yeah, the tool was like just generating, like, very like marketing-y or like long-form kind of stuff. So it just wasn't really helpful for that. But then last year, I was put on a project to create sort of like user journey maps, but specifically for content, and I figured out that I could take user interview transcripts and put them into once we had the enterprise ChatGPT, and have it actually do sentiment analysis and all of these kinds of things. So pick out what the user interviews were like, what kind of thoughts and feelings the user was having, but also the words that they were using. So that was really helpful, so it's really good for I think those kinds of things. And what I really use it for a lot now is like the strategic thinking. So I can take like, the product requirement documents, I can take transcripts from meetings with my product managers and my designers, and my designers and I can put that into ChatGPT, and I can say like this is the . . . I have like projects signed up where I would have these kind of core documents there for the product that I work on, so then it kind of knows the space and it even has. . . I like, I have PDFs of the flows, so then I can upload it and be like, I want to work on this, like give me the strategy, and it will tell me, "these are the users," and then I don't have to spend ages documenting all of my strategy in Figma. And sometimes it can even, it does like generate me some starter content. Like, I still have to edit it a lot, but yeah, with that kind of approach, it generates things that are a lot more usable, yeah. So yeah, I do use it quite a lot now.

Interviewer: Great, no, that's very interesting. You touched a lot of points, but just to go a little deeper into that strategic thinking you said, and like, but other stuff is very context dependent. How do you decide then which tasks are appropriate to give to genAI or ChatGPT, for example, and which are not? Also, based on your experience?

Interviewee02: Yeah, I guess it's been a bit of a trial and error. Yeah, like I said in the beginning, I would be like, try to give it the context of like I'm working on this error message in each, like this is the situation, give me like five versions of the error message. And it would do that, but that kind of took quite a lot of time anyway, you know, I would, I already have that information in my head, I could just write those myself. So it's only really good if I'm not feeling very well that day, my brain's really slow, so I guess

I figured out that it's much better at volume. If you have a large, not too big, because I've also learned. I get it to teach me how much can I put in, but I know if you put in too much data, then it hallucinates, so you have to put in the right amount. But yeah, if you have... we could put in 10 user interviews at a time, or like indeed, yeah, we have like a record, a transcript of an hour-long meeting, and all of this other stuff, you know. That's a lot of information to go through and then pick out. Or like it's good at corporate talk, so that's also why it's like ... that's another point I would think, do I have to actually write user-facing content, which then I would leave that to myself, or do I need to write stuff for documentation, and for, you know, for other people in the organization. And then that I would definitely give to AI to do, yeah, that is much better at it than me. But yeah, strategic thinking, yeah, I'm just not very good at vocalizing that stuff in a professional way. So, yeah, that's definitely a big part of it.

Interviewer: That's true with the language refinement. So once the AI has generated what you wanted it to generate, do you have a process for verifying it before you think "oh yeah, this is like, now I can take it like this"? Or how do you review or verify that it's correct?

Interviewee02: Yeah, a lot of the time it's just my own brain, I guess, and my own subject area expertise. So, yeah, like I will read through suggestions and be like oh no, you know this is not correct. So, yeah, always just like proofreading. But this is not so much in my professional life. Okay, well, I recently was putting together, I wanted to learn about a new area of design called cognitive systems engineering. And so I basically built myself a boot camp through ChatGPT, so yeah, and then I like kind of created it into lessons, but then I would go and check if the things it's telling me to learn, the lessons, are actually real things on Google or something. Or I tell it to give me references. And so, where are you getting this information, so I can verify that it's that you're what you're giving me is real. And yeah like I said, I've not noticed it so much professionally, but personally because I used ChatGPT personally a lot as well, it's like just made up books and songs and albums and I'll look for it, and I'll be like "this doesn't exist", and it'll be like "oh oops sorry yeah that's true".

Interviewer: So, when you use it at work, do you feel like you are responsible for the final outcome, or is it more because you're part of a project, that it's maybe your project manager, or your, I don't know, other seniority level manager is responsible? Or who do you think, who do you consider responsible when an AI is involved?

Interviewee02: Oh, you mean like responsible for what the AI is doing? The final outcome from the AI, not what I'm using it for, but

Interviewer: No, what you're using it for.

Interviewee02: So you mean like the final design

Interviewer: Exactly.

Interviewee02: But oh, well, yeah, it's shared ownership. I own the words, and I have to put the design in for legal review, so if the words are wrong, and that was like ChatGPT generated those words, and I put them in, I'm responsible, yes, I hold that responsibility. Like ChatGPT is just, it's a tool, it's like, is Microsoft Word responsible for my spelling? I don't know, no, I hope I hold the responsibility.

Interviewer: Yeah okay. So now we're kind of looking into the informal rules. You're working in an organization; are there any formal policies regarding AI use? I mean, you mentioned before, don't put in sensitive company information, but also, how clear are policies, and are people actually complying to them?

Interviewee02: Yeah, it is highly regulated. But it's not very clearly communicated, actually, and that's an organizational problem. So, you know, I mentioned earlier that I was like oh we can put user transcripts in and then I generated the stuff. Well, I saw on some Slack channel somewhere that someone from compliance or whatever, some company was like oh no, you can't do that because it's like user-protected stuff, and I'm like oh fair enough, but it's not very clearly communicated. And so now I'm like, oh shit, am I gonna get fired because I, you know, I don't know. So, yes, there I think, particularly, there are] around two areas that are very important: One is obviously internal company information strategies. Those things, those can't go out into the public. So I think it's, as long as it's like in the internal enterprise system, then it's kind of okay. So I can put in, yeah, like transcripts of my video recordings with colleagues or those kinds of documents, but then user data has another layer of protection. So, yeah, we should not be putting in anything that, like, interviews of course, like I mean, not [that] I have access to it, but like any particular users, like banking information or anything like that, yeah.

Interviewer: Yeah, interesting. So, since you also said it's sometimes very unclear in the communication, not that obvious, do you have your own rules when you use it at work, like really at work, or are there any unwritten rules maybe in your team, or did you establish in your team rules or guidelines?

Interviewee02: Not really. I mean, yeah, I'm probably at... First of all, I don't really use it in a team setting. I think that's also I think just like part of my role, particularly. I'm a bit of a drifter because there's never enough content designers; I don't belong to one specific team, I'm sort of...I go between. So, I work quite independently, and I just sort of, yeah, have my own processes a lot of the time. So I don't really need to establish any kind of team rules or procedures with it. And yeah, I, in the ideal world, I would like to put everything up there, so that's probably not very ethical, but then you have your own kind of rules because you don't put everything up there. You're like, well yeah, I mean, I'm just putting out there out of fear now that I've learned that I shouldn't put user stuff in there, but it's not... probably I would, if I could, yeah yeah, I mean, that's how it is, so.

Interviewer: But I mean, okay. You're not on a specific team, but you're like, you know, part of different teams. Have there been any situations where it felt like uncomfortable to talk about the use of AI, like treating it as an open secret, or is it more like no, we don't talk about it at all?

Interviewee02: No, no, no, it's... oh, well, actually, yeah, maybe a bit. I don't know. It, like I said, the company has been very pushing AI on us, so it's not, it's encouraged to use it. But I think within content design, specifically because we're writers, what I probably don't, what I'll probably keep a secret is, if I've been really, if I've just put... Like, sometimes it has generated a string, and I'm like, I don't care about this project, it's like, I have too much to do, I'm just going to use this. I probably will keep that hidden, right? If I'm like that is just purely compute like that purely generated content there is I think, still within this industry, specifically to kind of be like, oh the first, it doesn't actually create the first draft, so you still have to edit it a lot yourself as a content designer which sometimes is true but sometimes you just want something that's 75 % good enoughm you know? It's maybe like a low visibility project, you have a lot on your plate, yeah, but you probably wouldn't say like oh I just generated and stuck it in there.

Interviewer: Yeah, yeah. I guess it's true for a lot of people. So now, we're going also more into this trusting, ownership, authorship kind of area. You touched it already a little bit regarding the responsibility, but how do you determine if you have enough personal ownership over a piece of work? Like, after you put your name on it, after using AI?

Interviewee02: Sorry, can you explain?

Interviewer: So, what I mean is, do you feel like you're still the owner of that piece of work that you did, or do you feel like, actually, I put my name on it, but I don't feel like I actually own this because I use the AI?

Interviewee02: No, no. Because at least within my organization, if something if a product is under my ownership, so I own an entire flow and that flow is called "mobile get paid", it's the mobile version of getting paid, sending invoices, and things, unless... specifically I've been like out of work like, I was on sick leave, so somebody had to come in and take over my work, unless that's been explicit otherwise. Everything that goes out goes through legal and goes out into the world is mine, regardless of how it was. If AI put it in, if a product manager put it in, if an engineer wrote that string, if I haven't seen it and signed it off and reviewed it, then I'm in the shit like, why did you let this out go out? So it's not even about generating the words; I also oversee the words. So it doesn't really matter where they come from. And if I've put it in from ChatGPT, then even more so, right? I made that choice to include that in the product, even if I didn't come up with those words from my brain. And actually, a lot of my job isn't necessarily coming up with brand new words and strings. Like a lot of it is I'm being a content detective, and I'm seeing if we already wrote that string somewhere else, that could be a really good use of AI actually to be like "oh there's somebody in the system who's already written this error message", can the system find it and just repurpose it so it's consistent. So that would be great, yeah. So, yes, long story short, yes, I still feel I have the ownership in the product, yes.

Interviewer: What you talked about now, like with being more of a detector, do you feel like your job or work has also changed now because of AI? Like, do you feel that you're doing more oversight and refinement and less of actually creating something from scratch?

Interviewee02: Sadly, no, I would like that, actually, I would really like that. I don't really like writing, to be honest, it's it feels like pulling teeth, like trying to come up with new words, and I'm like it's... There is, especially in a very unorganized big organization, there's a lot of like rework that you have to do. That's really exhausting. You're just like oh I'm sure that this situation, this particular problem, whatever, has existed in some other part of a product, and I have to problem solve it again and use my cognitive skills. I think that AI is just actually not quite there yet to be really useful. We're kind of in this middle part, and that was actually something that I was working on when I mentioned those user journey maps. What I wanted to evolve that to, because I was like, it's not really that useful, what I wanted to evolve it to is to have an AI-like depository for common strings. So again, the error message one is a good example, we have like a lot of [them] because we work in like silos. One person will write a wrong password error message slightly this way, and one will write it slightly that way, and every time

you're like, what do I have to write if we could just go into ChatGPT and be like "hello, I need this error message", and it can just go through a library or like surface where it's existed somewhere else. That would be brilliant. So, I actually wanted to take over a lot of my creative work, especially for the rote stuff. There's a lot of rote stuff that, like you know, boring things, and then I want to work on more strategic thinking, like more holistic, rather than working on specific, down to the word, I don't care about that. I care about like the overall information experiences when it is being given, and then I can't really do that. You do need that kind of creative, holistic brain to be able to, like, oh, there's a connection between this area of the organization and that area of the organization, and the user could go here and here and there. So, yeah, I would, actually, sorry I talk a lot.

Interviewer: No, that's amazing, I want you to talk a lot.

Interviewee02: Yeah, it's true, yeah, yeah, I wish it was actually more robust, basically yeah.

Interviewer: Okay, but then, that's very interesting, actually. So that also means, I'm assuming now, that you don't feel like using AI for it has made you feel like separated from what you're actually doing, or like your skills were degrading in that sense?

Interviewee02: No. I mean when, a couple of years ago, when it first came, we were still really growing in content design, specifically. Of course, there were anxieties and tremors, and I want to go on LinkedIn, which I'm trying not to anymore. There's a lot of established voices in my industry that are very negative about it. And I think that there's, I think I just have a different perspective on what my job is to them, so I think a lot of content designers really think of themselves as writers and as writing as a craft, and as like, yeah, like this kind of creative expression that you need to work at, that you need to really work at. I don't think of it that way. I think, especially in product design, I think writing… I don't particularly like to be creative with my writing. I like it to be doing the job, and it's about being like clear, it's about helping the user get to the end, getting them to do what they want to do. So I don't really like words. I think, as they call it, I like to think in big picture stuff. And I like to think about information architecture and flows, and systems. And that's actually what content design used to be. And then, yeah, a lot of people come into this industry having been journalists, a lot of people have been like copywriters for advertising, these kinds of very writing-focused professions. And I came to it from marketing, but I hated

marketing for the exact same reason that I didn't like to do the creative writing. And I'm actually much more like, I actually think of myself as a UX designer that just happens to be good at words, but I'm more broadly a UX designer and I think that the future of AI will really need, well, let's broaden it specifically down to LLMs, I don't know about, like the image generating type of ones. But the fact that the language models means that people that know language should actually be really important, especially when it comes to risks. So this is the area that I'm looking at now, which is that we see that there are a lot of risk problems with AI because AI writes and speaks to you in a way that is so human that you kind of forget that it's a predictor, it's a prediction machine, it's not actually thinking anything. And that is a problem that we don't communicate uncertainty through the machine, but we're now, what we're moving into [a] design from what we're like deterministic systems, right? We know that the user will do this, and this will happen when we start implementing AI. Things, we as designers can't predict what their user experience is going to be. So then it's going to be much more about building guardrails, but understanding how AI works, about understanding human cognition, and how we can create systems that are unpredictable but still safe. So yeah, I feel optimistic about it for myself personally. I think it's a case of I'm just a person that likes to broaden my skills, learn new things, and move into new stuff. So, yeah, I feel okay that yeah, I just, I think there's too many people who are too tied to their identity of being, and you know, you know how that thing, sorry, I have so many thoughts. You know how there's like a certain generation of people who, if they struggle, they don't want the younger generation to struggle, or they do want the younger [generation to struggle], because I struggled, so you have to struggle. And I think there's a bit of that there as well. It's like people put all of this work and soul into writing the words, and now getting the words out has become easier, and they're kind of losing their sense of like, well, what is my skill? Like Tori Podmojewski is a really big figure in content design, and I remember she was doing kind of like a presentation of what content design is, and they threw up a thing, and then she started going on about voice and tone. And she's like, I can make a voice and tone metric, and I was like, who gives a shit, like a [COMPANY] voice doesn't sound that different from a Facebook voice. Like they all kind like, you kind of want to standardize it. Like that's not, I don't really think that's where content design should be, you know. I think it should be a lot more functional than worrying about brand voice, and you know, just make it sound like,

just make your content sound human, understandable. It doesn't fucking matter, yeah.

Interviewer: You're touching upon it. So you think AI can do that, right?

Interviewee02: Yeah exactly. I think AI can do voice and tone, but I also think like creating voice and tone matrices and stuff like I never do that. Like, you know, I'm supposed to do that documentation, like what kind of tone are you going to apply here? And I'm like, it really did, I can't have it for the entire flow because that string might need to be an informative tone, and that needs like... you I can't have like a little tone note per part of a.. I don't know, yeah, it's just, it's too.. and yeah. And you do have to be kind of, yeah, you can't just put a blanket over everything, I don't know..

Interviewer: Very interesting. So yeah, because I mean, and that's also like leading me to my last question, which we also already touched upon, talking about the use of AI when you deliver something to like your client or whatever, you whoever you work with. How do you decide whether or not to mention that you use AI to your colleagues or clients, or are you more you know open?

Interviewee02: Oh, that's a good question. I think it depends on the person, and on the project, and on the venue. So yeah, like the four aforementioned, if I'm delivering an actual flow, and that's being like reviewed, I don't think I would mention it. It's not really relevant, but also, you also kind of don't want to highlight too much. Like, if you only did spend not that much time on it and you offloaded all of it on AI, you sort of don't want to look like you're lazy, I guess. But yeah, but if you're using it, like, if for the strategic thinking, like. So, if you're using it to shorten down time in that kind of delivering the final thing, that's not really accepted, I think, yet. But if you're using it to shorten time for all the other part of the of the job, which is all of the exploration and the understanding of the problem or stuff like that, then that is very much encouraged, and you're always trying to encourage to share like new ways of using it or creating your own agents and like doing that. You're not really encouraged to kind of say, like oh I just got it to generate five verses, and I picked one, and I put it in. I think that there's still an expectation that you do something with it at the end. I don't know, yeah, like you are still the final decision maker always, yeah.

Interviewer: Great alright. I mean, that's basically all of the questions, but I always like to just ask in the end, if there's anything like, given what we talked about, given the purpose of the study, that you would like to mention that maybe I have not asked you about, but you feel like that's very important?

Interviewee02: Yes. So another thing that I've been thinking a lot about, and this is more from my personal life, but I think it totally applies in the work area as well, and this is referring again going back to all the people on LinkedIn that are being really negative about it. I had, got diagnosed with ADHD last summer, and on top of that, I've been really burnt out since like November. And I think it's really under-recognized how much of a cognitive support tool AI can be like. I've managed to organize my life and my thoughts so much better with that assistance. I can't, you know, one of the things I've struggled [with] at work a lot, again that kind of corporate speak, like writing the emails. I don't know if I have autistic traits or something as well, but like I really struggle with reading between the lines of like what corporate wants, of knowing how to conduct myself in the professional manner, and do all of that stuff. And it's just like really heavy on my, like, it just requires a lot of my brain, and offloading a lot of that to AI has been really, really helpful and instrumental in me recovering from burnout. So, I think it's not being advocated enough as an accessibility tool for people with neurodivergent or cognitive function issues. Even in my like I've been using ChatGPT as like a personal journal sort of thing as well because there's a lot of writing on the internet about like burnout and autism and all that stuff. So I think it's fed, it's been taught a lot on that. And it's really helped me to hold back and not burn myself out more, like I will check, "should I do this?", and it'll be like "no, don't". And I've actually tested it as well. I'm like, but I really think I should, you know, I think you should listen to me and be like, "no, listen to me," like it's genuinely been quite interesting. When I try to break it, and I try to make it just like hand it to me, and do what I want, and it's been quite strict. So I think yeah, it could help a lot for neurodivergent people. But also, just like in the creative sector, burnout is so common, and yeah, being able to offload some cognitive functions. So, I mentioned earlier that I was looking into cognitive systems theory, which is very relevant to AI, and a big part of it is joint cognitive systems. Have you come across that? So it's where you think of the user and the machine as one cognitive system, right? So it's not like "oh I'm a user, and I'm using this tool", it's like we're one brain and some things the human brain is better at and some things the machine brain is better at. And it's like, how do we build products that actually offload the things that the machines are better at to the machine and then leave the human brain to do what it's good at, like more ambiguous thinking or more creative thinking. So I think that that could be encouraged more within creative industries. Plus, most creative people are really bad at admin and money and all of

that. So it's not necessarily going to be brilliant for generating stuff... well, it can be, I think, it will also be like a democratizing tool. Like I don't really do a lot of, I don't do visual things, but when I think about, youo know, my academic background is in film studies and I imagine people that were like filming with film being like "oh, video cameras, digital cameras, it's not the real art", but then having the proliferation of digital cameras has enabled so many more people to be able to make art and without having to process film, and you know, fiddle around with all of this stuff. Yeah, so I think it's just the same thing. It's like people, yeah, there is the AI slop right now, but it's like it's the early stages, and you know, so I think it can be, I think it will be an interesting tool. But yeah, yeah, I just wish it would not use up so much water, I guess.

Interviewer: Yeah, well, the environmental aspect here is not important, but yeah, that's also a big thing that's true.

Interviewee02: Yeah, but I, yeah. But lately I've been trying to like to step back and step a little bit away from all of the negativity around it. I think it's also just a byproduct of us being on Social media and everything is being made like much more scary than it needs to be. It's just like it is the next evolution in technology, clearly it's very changing. But I read an interesting book by this economist, I can't remember his name, he was Korean, and he said, like, there was a question, like, what are the really life-changing technologies? How much of a life-changing or industry-changing technology was the internet? And he was like, yeah, it was big, but like even the internet itself, he's like, it's not actually that... it wasn't actually that changing. He was like you know what really changed things? The washing machine. When women were decoupled from having to spend hours washing laundry, they had so much more time to go into the labor market and those kinds of things. So I think that's an interesting perspective like that. For us in this like tech world, we're like oh my god, this is so huge, but like, actually, in the grand scheme of things, is it actually, so..

INTERVIEW 03

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Interviewer: Alright. So, before we start the interview, just so you know, your participation is completely voluntary, you can drop out of the interview anytime, and the interview will be transcribed and recorded. So you consent to this?

Interviewee03: Yes, I consent.

Interviewer: Great. Also, have you read the information detailing the purpose of the study and everything how we handle data?

Interviewee03: Yes.

Interviewer: Alright, perfect. So, before we go into the deeper stuff, can you just briefly describe your role and the kind of creative work you do?

Interviewee03: Yes. So, currently, I'm working; I'm a senior UX researcher. So, actually my job is mostly, you know, kind of informing any creative aspect that comes with designing platforms, Apps, AI tools as well. And I do a little bit of design because sometimes when I have to hand over the outcomes of research, and I have initial ideas on how something should look, also sketch. So, yeah, that is, I would say, the nature of my work, but heavier on obviously the research side. I do mostly qualitative research, so I interview also like a lot of people, and yes, we mostly work with building software platforms, AI, and so on and so forth. And I work internally facing in my company. So, my company is a big consultancy company, but I don't work with external clients. I work with the landscape of like tools that employees in my company use, yeah, so, yeah.

Interviewer: Okay. And what kind of tools and technologies do you use in your daily work, or, for example, since the purpose of the study is AI, yeah, like any AI use?

Interviewee03: Yes, so, I use I would say first and foremost, Figma for any sort of like creative job or, like, if I have to design like decision maps, blueprints, etc., or like also sketching. And then, yes, we do have Co-Pilot as the corporate AI tool, that is that we use in the company, that is like that's an official one that everybody should use because it's safe and blah blah blah. But as researchers and designers in my team, since it's the UX team, we get the possibility to also use other AI tools. So, without like an exception. And then it's about basically what I like to use, and I would say the other tool that I use a lot is Claude. It's maybe my favorite AI tool, and at the same time, as I was mentioning, we are building an internal AI tool which I've been working with for like almost a year now. So, it's supposed to be, yeah,

kind of enterprise AI-connected to all the platforms that employees use, and with like, it's a GenAI tool with agents. So then people in specific fields within the company so let's say people in sales should get their agents they can use to work and blah blah blah and at some point we would also like to have a research agent that we can use to maybe, I don't know, help with the research work, maybe,, you know,, synthesize insights and stuff like that, yeah. Okay, and I use also Figma Make, which is the AI tool within Figma. I started testing it a little bit, maybe in December or so, and it's actually quite cool. So I'm starting to figure out what I can do with it more and more, and then I think that's it mostly, yeah.

Interviewer: Okay. Great. I guess I will get into that later, but can you maybe walk me through a recent situation where you used AI or also deliberately chose not to use it?

Interviewee03: Yeah, so, with AI, we also have a lot of discussions like within the team because it's like, I see it as like a kind of sparring partner. But at the same time, obviously, I don't trust fully the output, so I obviously need to be in control of like what I'm asking, and I need to double-check any sort of output. But basically, I tend to use it to kind of maybe shape the beginning of my work, and then I will polish it further because that helps me save time, and it also maybe helps me kind of set the framework that I'm supposed to work with. So, for example, now I'm creating a lot of like kind of service design style, a lot of like service maps, and blueprints, and decision trees on basically how this corporate AI tool that we're building should handle specific quests. So imagine that, I don't know, we have like an HR ticketing tool, and people tend to look for a lot of like HR stuff. So, it's like okay, if we add HR stuff into our AI tool, how should it work. So basically, I've been designing decision trees, which is kind of like how the AI tool should function, the decision gates in which it should kind of, you know, stop analyzing information in a certain way, and then make a decision basically. So I used AI to kind of kickstart the process of designing the decision gates. Like I had data that I analyzed, I had my categories, and I was like, "Okay, based on these categories, how would you roughly structure a decision tree?" So it gave me like an initial idea of a sketch of like the different categories. I looked at it, I was like "yeah, this actually makes sense but I would maybe switch and like have, let's say, this decision gate before the one that you recommended" And so I kind of looked at the output, figured out what made sense, what didn't make sense, but it saved me a bunch of time in kind of, you know, structuring the tree and then I started sketching the tree myself. And now we'll have to do the same thing with

other types of like issues, maybe not HR but like other type of tools that we have in the company, and in that, I think, I'll use kind of AI similarly, so to kind of kickstart the kind of work that I have to do but then I'm the one [who's] kind of refining it, and also checking if the output makes sense, okay. And I also kind of use it as a sounding board with a colleague that I'm working with in this process. Yeah, so I was like "hey, Co-Pilot gave me this output", and maybe she's been analyzing some other data, and I'm like "does this make sense to you as well?" So she'll be like "yeah, no, let's change here", blah blah blah. So it's like, it's also nice to, you know, kind of have it as a mutual kind of collaboration brainstorming type of thing.

Interviewer: Yeah, you don't have to start with a blank page.

Interviewee03: Exactly. And one other thing that I did this with Figma Make instead. So I was conducting interviews a while ago, and I had to... So the problem when you conduct interviews is like figuring out an efficient way to collect the insights, especially if you have like one week to do everything, which is sometimes the timelines we have in the corporate world. So I would be like "okay, these are the categories that I'm analyzing," and then maybe I interview somebody. Right after, I would maybe create a little sketch like in Figma, and I just put like post-its like "oh, about this topic they said this, about this other topic they said that" and blah blah blah. With Figma Make, I discovered that you can build your own kind of interview logger. So you give a prompt to Figma Make, and I was like, "I need a dashboard where I can log interviews," blah blah blah, and he actually did it. So I was like testing that also a little bit, and it was actually quite cool because then I can also share it with my other researcher colleagues, and they can also use it too because it's a collaboration tool.

Interviewer: Okay, nice. Are there any tasks that you would never use AI for, like do you have a personal boundary, or preference?

Interviewee03: I mean, I'm always wary of data protection, obviously, since I work with data, I interview people. So if I use, for example, for Co-Pilot, which is a proper tool, and I'm guaranteed that it will not kind of learn from the data that I'm inputting, because that's like the boundary that my company puts on it, basically, when they got it as a proper tool, then I feel a bit safer. Like, if I put an interview transcript and I'm like, "Can you kind of extract the teams and blah blah blah," but I will never do it in any other tool because it's data protection and all of that. And also I think, I mean it's not really the nature of my job, but let's say if I was like in academia and maybe I have really sensitive information about people, maybe they're talking about personal experiences and stuff like that, then no, because I

still don't trust the big corporations, basically, what they're doing with data. So there is kind of, I would assess the level of harm that could do if data was collected and kept and, you know, fed into, basically.

Interviewer: I will ask you more about that, but before, are there any tasks that you would deem to be too complex for AI to handle? If so, which?

Interviewee03: Yeah. So I think obviously AI struggles still to get nuances of things. So, I think if you want to use it, you have to just use it as a tool, come in with clear knowledge and an idea, or what you want to get out of it. But if you just like freestyle and be like oh let me see what it gets and then just kind of trust the output blindly, then you're going to encounter problems. Because I feel that AI sounds smart, but often it's not really smart, so you have to learn basically how to use it, how to prompt, and kind of be critical of the outputs. Because, again, it can sound smart, but often it's hallucinations or just the language that it uses, you know.

Interviewer: Yeah, that's true. You mentioned trust. So, that's also kind of a little direction that I'm going for. So, once, because you also said that you do a lot of refinement, so once the AI generates an output, what is your personal verification process before you consider it ready? Or how do you review?

Interviewee03: I think it's like, I put, let's say, parameters before and after. So I start usually with a structure, so maybe I already analyzed stuff, and I have an idea, or maybe I have my own set of, let's say, categories that I want to analyze, and all of that, and then I use AI to just kind of maybe kind of categorize and fine-tune the data. But then, when I check the output, I kind of observe if it's actually matching what I asked it to do. And obviously, if I have a deep knowledge of like the data set or stuff like that, then I also check that there is not stuff that is weird, or, for example, one example that comes to mind that we also discussed a lot among researchers in my team is like, if, let's say, I have, let's say, five interviews that I put in Co-Pilot and I'm like "okay, these are the things that I'm analyzing. Can you extract from these interviews like basically what people said about this stuff?", and then I could be like please maybe rank it in terms of like how many times the most prevalent, let's say, topic that people spoke about. Sometimes you will have it mention something that somebody, like a user, maybe mentioned vaguely once as a key insight. And that is because it's not able to obviously recognize, I guess, the tone of the person. So if they actually spoke about it as an important thing, versus like they just mentioned it randomly. And that can be like a huge problem, obviously. So if I don't know the interviews, if I didn't listen to them, or maybe I'm analyzing something that

somebody else did, then I wouldn't be able to recognize that that should be like a secondary finding and not like one of the main insights. But AI just groups everything together, maybe because it sounds cool or something. But then, research-wise, it wouldn't be a sound outcome, basically.

Interviewer: Because you said you have parameters, do you have an example for that? Or is it more context dependent?

Interviewee03: It depends definitely both on the type of research that I'm doing, but I think it comes by kind of knowledge. So I will have to study the material that I'm putting into AI first and then make sure that the output actually reflects that material correctly and is not inferring random things, and like adding random things into it, you know. And I think that that is kind of which is still a lot of work. But I guess that that is like the check. But it's still, so knowing what you're putting in, knowing what you're expecting out of it, then. That's how you look at the outputs.

Interviewer: Okay, no, I understand. You also mentioned hallucinations. Can you describe a time when an AI provided a hallucination, or maybe a flawed result? Because, for example, you're saying "oh, this one mentioned keyword X". How did you adjust your workflow afterwards?

Interviewee03: Yeah. So I'm thinking, I remember something from some interviews that I conducted a while ago. I had two different users. I mean, I had two different user types, and I tried to ask AI to kind of distinguish between the two user types. But then I saw that a lot of insights from one user type were appearing. Also, the other one, and in that case I was like, yeah, okay, this is not working, please like readjust and blah blah, but then he basically didn't manage to do it. So, I just chose to do it manually. And other examples, I did encounter some hallucination, and nothing specifically comes to mind.

Interviewer: I have a lot of questions still, also now, regarding, or still in this area of flawed results and the hallucinations that AI produces. How do you decide that the output still needs correction or rewriting, or you reject it completely?

Interviewee03: Basically, I would check again. It's kind of based on the two, let's say, gates that I put. So, like, I have to know the data deeply, and then, based on that, I have to fully kind of review the output and see if it actually kind of makes sense into that. So, depending on that, then I will either try to prompt if I notice mistakes, then I will try to prompt again, and be like no, actually what I need is this, so edit the output and include this, so like remove that or double check this tag because it's wrong. So then I will try that, and I think I will probably give it two attempts to reprompt

to see if it can fix the mistake. And then I will just like discard. And with myself basically, or correct it myself if I'm desperate, because I have zero time, which happened actually a couple of weeks ago. I had data sets that I had to analyze, and I was like, "Okay, this is like the tagging that we need to do for each category.", I was like, let me see if Co-Pilot can actually do it directly on Excel and modify the Excel file. Which turns out that it could do, but it took me, I think, 10 attempts to have it understand how to tag the things in the data set. And that was because the data set, like the data, was not clean, and it was like on multiple rows. So it was like kind of tagging randomly, which maybe that's just like an hallucination because it's like, sure, I'm like, then "what are you actually doing this based on, there's no data in that row, you still put a tag". So there, because I had no time, I was like, okay, this is, I'm gonna try multiple times to see if it gets it right. Then it got it right, but I was like "yes", but since I saw that it messed up massively before, let me actually go through the data set and see the tag, [if] it makes sense. So, it was a huge data set. I took like maybe one third of it, reviewed it, saw that it made sense. I was like, "Okay then, I just hope that the rest also makes sense," kind of. This was a situation.

Interviewer: Because you use it a lot, but who do you feel is responsible for the final outcome? Is it you, or would you say because you're working in a company or in a team, is it more then team responsibility, or your manager's responsibility, or the company's responsibility?

Interviewee03: It's me. Yeah, definitely, it depends on, I guess, what is the task. But if it's something that is pertaining to my specific job as a researcher, also being a senior, then it's on me. It's also my manager, like the head of UX research, he wouldn't review in detail this kind of stuff, so he trusts that, if you're a senior, capable of kind of really seeing that, and adjusting as needed. So definitely will be on me, because I'm also.. It's also my choice to use AI to do these tasks, you know. Just like if I did a mistake, working more manually, the same applies, if I use AI and it messes up.

Interviewer: Okay, so you choose AI, so your company does not want their employees to use AI, or they do want it?

Interviewee03: Yes. Also, sometimes I feel that now one thing that shifted a lot with AI is that they're like, yeah, but you have this, so you can actually work so much faster, you know. So they give us like unrealistic deadlines that if I had to do it manually, I wouldn't be able to do it in working hours. So I have to choose AI. It's almost like I cannot even choose not to, you know. That's the problem.

Interviewer: Now, we're also looking more into this problem. First, are there any formal rules or policies in your organization on AI use? And if there are policies, which I assume, are they clear?

Interviewee03: Not super clear. The only thing will have it's mandatory for all employees to take like a basic AI course, like GenAI course. So, like, you know, how to use AI, how it works, how you should prompt, like stuff that is actually very basic. And then about mostly data protection. So it's like if it's company data, only use the approved tools, which is Co-Pilot and then this tool that we're building, although it's still very green, so not many people are using it, obviously. Technically, other tools are blocked. So if you try to access them from our company computer, you cannot even access them. If you have an exemption and you can use them like my team, then you cannot input any sort of company data, personal data, all of that. You can use it for like other stuff, so yes, that is most of the like how it's being handled so far. But people are encouraged to use AI, not only people like in the creative fields, like UX teams and all of that, but also, you know, people in sales use AI to maybe write proposals for customers, people in finance use AI to analyze data sets. Everybody's using AI basically.

Interviewer: Yeah, it's an open secret.

Interviewee03: Exactly. No, no, not even.

Interviewer: Okay, alright, I will get to that. Before that, I mean, you also already said that you do have like some personal rules, but would you say that you have stricter personal rules than the policies that you have? Or are they more loose? Or do you have your own set of standards besides, okay, you said sensitive data is something that you would also never put into, like some people.

Interviewee03: Yeah, I would say I don't. I don't care, I'm gonna put that sensitive data into that, yeah. I think maybe I'm a bit stricter because I'm also critical of AI, it's, also it comes from my academic work before getting into the corporate world. But I mean I realize like they use, that's obviously again with like Co-Pilot or approved tools I know that the company kind of set some boundaries on, what these tools can do, since a lot of people use, you know, corporate data that is quite sensitive, but at the same time I'm also like okay but then there must be some sort of gain also from their side. So it's like still kind of be careful on kind of what you're prompting, or what kind of data you're putting into it, and even more so if I'm using like external tools, then even if I use it for work, maybe to get like another type of output, it would maybe just kind of be more creative. So, like, can you generate a sketch of this thing, but it's like I usually put it out of context.

So it doesn't know which data is kind of I don't know, maybe creating the specific prompt or like where I work, what I'm looking for specifically, just like, you know, please create, I don't know, like a sketch of what maybe, I don't know, an optional card would look like in an AI tool. So like very big, you know, and that is again because if they're free, it means that you're paying in some other way, which is with your data. So I try to not input any sort of personal data and all of that. Although then, it's also my personal private use of AI, what I do with it, and then it's also like a question mark because I feel that now it knows me, even if I try to prompt random things. But then it kind of builds a picture of who you are and what you do and all of that.

Interviewer: It is still a bit opaque.

Interviewee03: Yeah yeah.

Interviewer: And have your practices changed over time, in the past, also with the advancements of AI? Yeah, I think I'm getting more and more wary of, like, the use of data. So I think it's like... well, in the beginning, I was maybe trying it more freely to see what it could do and all of that. Now I am more careful of the kind of data they're put in, and I try to use it strictly for like work-related stuff. Or maybe it's a little bit in my personal life, but like with boundaries. It's like, if there's stuff that I can't find with a Google Search, then I will still use a Google Search rather than AI. Also, first and foremost, because of the environmental impact of it. So I try to use it only when I have to.

Interviewee03: So limits to work

Interviewer: Yeah, yeah.

Interviewee03: That makes sense. I mean, you said that your organization encourages AI use, but do you also feel comfortable talking to, talking about your use of AI with your colleagues and your manager? Is everybody talking about maybe sharing their...?

Interviewer: Yeah, we actually, we have usually like a show and tell session every month, so among the research team in particular. And we've been talking about how we use different AI tools for what. So it's kind of maybe sharing best practices among each other. But then, like the last, on the latest that we had, that was actually this past week, I think on Thursday, maybe, we were also talking about AI in general, and kind of biases within AI. And, I don't know how the topic came up, but a colleague was talking about a friend of hers using AI as a therapist. So then we got into this massive ethical discussion on, you know, these uses of AI and how problematic they are, and how risky also it can be. So we have, yeah, open

discussions about how we use it, where we kind of draw the line in terms of user, what we think is good versus what we think is dangerous. And we also were speaking a bit about kind of racial bias in AI versus, you know, AI kind of tending to represent the majority. Because, also, my team we are majority people of color, so my manager was saying, yeah, I tend to now prompt asking AI to present examples that represent the global majority of the world, not only like a Western view, which was also interesting, you know. Practices like how you ask stuff to AI and the fact that you have to specify that you want a specific type of results rather than just, you know, kind of prompting normally, and then it will just give you, basically, kind of a very Western kind of perspective into stuff.

Interviewee03: It's like standardizing and leveling.

Interviewer: Exactly, we're assuming that that is the norm.

Interviewee03: Well, that's interesting that you also have a session. Would you, because now I'm kind of intrigued, would you say that then in your sessions... What are the, have you encountered any informal practices among your colleagues, too, where you maybe something, maybe how they deal with it, with the unclear policies of your organization?

Interviewer: So, the thing is like I don't know if one will be honest about it in front of your manager because it's like one thing is like, when we speak about it among ourselves like just researchers, and then, for example, I remember there was a colleague that mentioned like yeah, no I actually, I hate Co-Pilot, so I used, I don't remember what tool maybe Perplexity to analyze the interviews, it was so much better. And we were like, no, actually, you should never do it because it's like this is like personal data, so like don't do it. Or if you do it, anonymize everything in the transcript, and then whatever. But then obviously when we have this kind of official formal sessions with the manager, it will be like, no, I actually only use it a little this way, and then it's more about interesting ways to use it. But still within the boundaries of what is allowed to do. But overall, I would say, I feel they were all quite critical, wary of it, like in my team, and I feel we're very aligned when it comes to how we feel we should use it, and also what not to trust, and what is dangerous. So, that's good. Then, speaking with the designers, they use it also in a similar way. And we also have maybe bigger sessions with also designers and developers on how we all use AI. But I feel that for all of us it's kind of just like the kickstarter, but then obviously we still enjoy our role, so I love doing research, I love analyzing data, so I still want to do it. I don't want it to do it for me, and the designers are like, okay, maybe they use it to get an initial idea of how they should sketch,

but then they want to be doing the designing, you know. So we're kind of aligned in that because there's also an underlying fear that it will replace us, which has been a big talk in the company.

Interviewee03: Which also kind of leads to the last part of the interview. Okay, let me switch up questions. Have you ever felt that using AI separates you from what you're actually doing? Or from your craft, or like your skills were degrading?

Interviewer: Not for my role specifically. I think, because basically, now I can get AI to do the things that I hated the most. Like maybe more boring, repetitive things, such as cleaning a data set or stuff like that that I never enjoyed, and that don't really add anything to, like, obviously super important for research. But it's not like I was born to clean data sets. I'd rather, you know, interview, talk to people, that is my favorite part. Then I like to analyze the data, start to see things, and these are the things that I still do. So, more kind of manual, boring things I can have AI do.

Interviewee03: And then, also, do you feel like you still own what you're doing? Like, how do you determine if you still have enough personal ownership over what you're doing, over your piece of work?

Interviewer: Yeah, no, I feel definitely that is still the case. Yeah, I still do most of [it], and I'm still kind of the orchestrator, the director of, you know, AI. AI is a bit like as if I had an intern, maybe that I'm like "hey, can you take care of these and these things", but then I'm still kind of the one kind of setting the direction and doing the important bits of the work. Though, for example, I'm thinking maybe for a person that is purely a designer is different because, as I was mentioning, I sketch sometimes when I do research, and then I have to hand [it] over to the designers. There are some designers that are just visual, so if I present to them research in a, let's say, verbal presentation or like a PowerPoint, then they don't understand what they're supposed to design. So I'm like, okay, well, let me sketch what I mean. So then they see visually it's easier, and now if I use, let's say Figma Make to help me sketch, then the sketches are not really my sketches, you know, it's more like in that case it's AI that did it. But again, since I'm not purely a designer, I don't really care about it, because for me it's more like just something, [a] mean to have you understand my research. But if it was a designer that then fully uses Figma Make to design, then that would be a problem. Or like I don't know how they see it, but it would be different, and they're basically offloading the core of their work to AI.

Interviewee03: Yeah, exactly, like that's also that would be an interesting question, I guess, then for a designer, like if the AI then provided the

core idea, but you've changed all the, or you made the visual refinement, like who would you feel owns the results?

Interviewer: But we have also sessions about it, kind of like how our jobs will change with AI, because that's like a bit inevitable. And the designers see their job is changing, as in, maybe they will be designing less, but it will be working more as kind of the creative director, so they're the one that give the direction to AI and then AI designs, which, if you like it, amazing, but if you actually enjoy designing, then that's not great. Basically, you would not be doing that anymore.

Interviewee03: So when you're delivering like your project or work, I mean, you already said you openly speak with your colleagues about [it], but do you then also openly mention that you use AI, or is it more "okay, everybody knows that I use AI anyway, so I'm not gonna mention [it]"?

Interviewer: No, I don't mention it generally. I think it's like an open knowledge. I'll be like, yeah, use AI because you gave me unrealistic deadlines, of course, I had to use AI.

Interviewee03: I mean, that's basically everything, but before ending this interview, is there anything that I haven't asked you what you think would be important given the purpose of the study on AI use and formal practices, and how you negotiate oversight and control?

Interviewer: Maybe, yes. The last thing that I was mentioning about the fear of all of our jobs getting replaced by AI, I feel, because I also heard it in interviews myself when I was interviewing people in the company about this AI team we were building, that a lot of people mention, and it's something that I agree also myself as a user. Like the fact that you basically want AI to do the boring repetitive jobs, but I still want to be the one in charge of it, and, you know, to kind of do the parts of your job that you actually really enjoy, that are kind of the core of your role. But I fear and feel that sometimes there are things that could be fully replaced, you know. But people are still "no, we'll only use AI for this bit because this is the part that I like, although I acknowledge that also this part could be done by AI", and I think that that will be the ongoing growing issue in coming years. Because also with AI models becoming more advanced and all of that, there would be basically a bunch of people that lose, or roles that would not exist anymore because of it. So now it's still more like I feel we're in a phase in which people are either fighting to kind of re-establish their value, like I cannot be replaced like this, it's still something that a human can do better. Or there are other people that are trying to imagine and understand how their job

will change, kind of like what I was mentioning with the designers, with AI taking over, basically, so kind of what will my job role become after this?

Interviewee03: Would you say that, then, the most important thing would be to use AI or to become better at the use of it?

Interviewer: I think it's a profession. I mean, it depends. There are so many things that play me, there's also like, on one side personally, I do feel that this is kind of moving faster than society. So there will be issues in a bit because it's also, it's something that is being studied by academics for a very long time, but they were not really listened [to] because, obviously, there's a massive economic gain from the advancement of AI. So it's a bit also political, you know, it's about how you believe society should be, and I think that your own political beliefs in this affect a lot how you see this, so if you want it more regulated, less regulated, or if it's you that you should adapt.

INTERVIEW 04

02/21/2026 | 45 Minutes | Service Designer, UX Designer

Interviewer: Alright. So, before we start with the questions, just so you know, the information you provide, as well as all the company's details, will be completely anonymized. Participation is voluntary, and you can stop the interview at any time without explanation. The interview will be recorded, transcribed, and used only for academic purposes, and your identity will remain completely confidential. But all of that is also detailed in the informed consent. Do you consent to this, to the recording and the transcription?

Interviewee04: Yes.

Interviewer: Perfect, then let's start with just a general question. Can you please briefly describe your role and the kind of creative work that you do?

Interviewee04: Yes, so my current role is service designer. And in my organization, my role is mostly about gathering customer or consumer needs to identify new services that we can provide, and I should say that I work within retail, as in industry. And I would say that a big part of the work is also to align internal stakeholders, so we can actually move from an idea to a real product.

Interviewer: Okay, great. Do you have like typical tools or technologies that are very central to your daily work? Maybe also with AI included, but also without?

Interviewee04: I think... I mean, we don't technically. It's not a job where we need a lot of tools but I do, I'm a big fan of tools as long as they serve the purpose. So, I do use quite a lot of them, but I would say the main, so the ecosystem provided by the company, and that I would use on a daily basis, would be Miro and Figma. And then communication tools like, you know, Teams, Slack, something similar to communicate with the rest of the organization. But my main two tools for my job are Miro and Figma. And then recently they added ChatGPT licensing, and also I use quite a bit of Adobe Firefly. That's what is like, company-compliant. Then I use other AI-powered generative tools, but they are not company-compliant. I use them for other things.

Interviewer: Alright. We will probably also get into that, maybe a little later. Can you maybe walk me through a recent situation where you used, or also deliberately avoided using GenAI for work?

Interviewee04: Yeah, well, actually, we did some... That's a very interesting question because I think we're all a bit there, like trying to identify also clear use cases, which is probably the most difficult part right now. The latest, or not the latest, but one big thing that we did recently with one of my colleagues is to try to create a video. So we have like insights based on some research that we have done on a specific part of the customer journey, and that I can disclose. It was about like the checkout part of the customer journey, and we had, like, we did interviews, we wanted to understand how people, what kind of friction they were encountering, or how they were experiencing this specific checkout solution that we have in stores. And we wanted to be able to share those insights in a different way than what we do usually, which is very kind of like not interactive enough to some extent. Like we share a lot of information through PDFs, PowerPoint presentations, but it's very one-way. So we wanted to use AI to be able to do something that we can't do ourselves, which is to generate a video from the insights, and it's totally doable, and it worked well, but it didn't work well with the tools provided by the company. Because the AI we have access to, like the tooling we have around AI right now, is not how I would qualify it smart enough, or you know, it's not like hallucinating per se, but it's really hard to keep the consistency while building a video, building one image, generating one image, fine-generating. Like, I think we were trying to do like 19 frames, generating 19 frames of four-second video each is increasingly difficult if you want the visual aspect to be consistent, and you actually want to tell a story that you can share, and then we yeah. So, we did that as a test because we wanted to see what is possible to do within the tools that are provided to us. Because my colleague and we also use external tools for our private personal project, so we wanted to see "ah this thing that I do at home on my free time, can I actually use it do it with the tools provided by work", and the short answer is "no, it's not that easy.". So, that's a good example of like something where AI could really help us but actually doesn't.

Interviewer: That's a great example, and it's also a kind of hints to my next question, because how do you... Is there a process, or how do you decide which tasks are appropriate to delegate to GenAI? Or where you say "no, I would never"?

Interviewee04: Also, a very good question, because I think the level of maturity regarding AI in my company right now is that we don't have defined use cases. Like, oh, if you need to do that, you can use AI. It's going to be a great companion to support you, and because we don't have that, then

it's kind of like everyone on their own, there's no real organization, there's no real. You need to be.... My belief is that when you use AI, you need to be very intentional. Like you need to know what you want help with, you need to understand what kind of outcome this specific tool is going to provide you with, in the same way that you would choose, if I try to do another analogy it's, to me it's just in the same way that you would choose between a pencil or like a paintbrush. You're not going to get the same effect at the end if you want to draw something. But to answer your question, we don't have guidelines when it comes to that. So it's really up to us as individual[s] and therefore it's up to me to decide when do I use AI, where I have boundaries. Since I have only two tools, I actually have three tools available to me. I can choose depending on how I understand those tools work, but this knowledge is also kind of like on me because we have a bit of like training regarding that, but we don't have like mandatory training. So, my level of understanding of what ChatGPT can do for me as a Service Designer, since we have a license, versus what Co-Pilot can do for me as a Service Designer, versus Adobe Firefly, is really based on my own curiosity, I would say, and my own trial and error. Can you go back to your initial question, so I make sure to answer it?

Interviewer: Of course, but you already answered a lot. But I think that the question was, how do you decide which tasks are appropriate to delegate to GenAI, for example, [which] specific tasks do you usually hand off, and which way do you feel "no, this will never work", or this is maybe off limits due to some concerns, private concerns, company concerns, etc.?

Interviewee04: Yes, one. So there are two tasks, I would say, that I use on an everyday basis. One task that is not completely service design related or design related, it's more... because I work in a Swedish Company, but also with a lot of like different people coming from different cultures and backgrounds, etc., and we all have English as the main language, but still sometimes, you know, things get lost in translation. I use AI quite a lot to rephrase myself to make sure that what I say is clear, and sometimes I provide AI with like specific context. Like if I know that I'm at a table with only Swedish natives, for example, who have been working solely for Swedish companies, then I will add that as a context. So that's one, that's quite a big use of mine, and I found it quite helpful. It also helps me think differently now when I try to say something, like in terms of like a tone of voice, but also choice of words. I come from a culture where the way we speak in a professional setting is very straightforward; it is way more straightforward than what I'm used to in Sweden now. So it requires a bit

of like a constant adaptation from stepping away from my original culture to the culture that I'm in now, the work culture. And that's one use case. And the second use case that is quite also almost an everyday occurrence would be like summarizing. Because we have a lot of information and a lot of information coming from a lot of different channels or people and sometimes it's very heavy on words and sometimes I don't have the time to read like 200 pages of PowerPoint presentation and I need a tool that is like company-compliant where I can upload in-house documents and get some kind of like transcription of them.

Interviewer: Okay. So you mentioned it's more the, let me say, foundational, basic tasks. Are there tasks that you deem are way too complex for AI?

Interviewee04: I think it's not that I do believe that anything is too complex for AI. I think it depends highly on your ability to prompt, which still requires skills that I think a lot of people undervalue or undermine. Because at the end of the day, generative AI is only a tool. If you don't know how to ask, then you will not get the answer that you're after. Or worse, you will get the wrong answer. So, it's not really about things that I exclude because I don't think it's possible; it's more things that I'm cautious about or trying to be cautious about. For example, even when we do like a summary of things, even if I can't read the full document, I still know what it's about, and it's usually on topics where I've done my own research in different parts of the organization before. So I can see, does it make sense or not, at least on a high level. And for more specific tasks like, for example, we do a lot of customer interviews and sometimes it's a lot of data and you want a bit of support to analyze it because we are always on the strict deadline then I will spend more time, instead of spending more time analyzing everything etc., I will spend more time making sure what the AI has provided to me is actually true to the fact. And then it would be, I will do it through prompting, and I will do it also through like downloading whatever results the AI gave me and confronting it to the initial data on some key points to make sure that, I don't know, there's no hallucination on a quote or something like that. And I try to do a lot of negative prompting, too, also make sure that we don't have too much noise, let's say.

Interviewer: Yeah, okay, that's very interesting. Can you maybe, because... so, how do you make sure that it's ready what the AI generated? Do you have, because you mentioned oh you're making it sure by re-prompting a little bit, but, yeah, do you have like a verification process personally?

Interviewee04: Yeah, I wouldn't say that it's as like clean as having a process that I would follow every time, it's still very much organic, and that would be nice to actually move to something a bit more like processed heavy because I think it's important to feel that it's solid, you know. But right now, it's not as structured as that because again, it's not like a mainstream usage, and we don't have like specific use cases. So there's not like a real need for that, and I also don't really have the time right now. But what kind of example could I give you to be specific... Well, let's say, for example, that I interviewed like 10 people on a specific topic, and then I ask AI, give AI an Excel file with every answer that they provided. Maybe you're going to do that at the end of all your interviews. And then the AI will create a summary. What I usually do is that, since I have done the interviews myself, I know what people have said and I've already started clustering a bit the different themes, etc. So first, I will start by verifying if AI provides the same things, themes, and or topics that I've seen. If there is some kind of discrepancy there, I will reassess it, did I miss something, or is it the machine who's actually inventing something? And that's a very interesting process because it sometimes it really feels like I've been doing that with a colleague, let's say, we've been doing that for like two hours on our own, and then suddenly we meet again, and we share, and we see different things. So it's more like a, it's a good companion in that sense, and at the same time, it's a good verification for me because I kind of go through the data twice in two different ways. So that's one thing that I do. Another thing that I do also is that I try to, how do you say that in English, I try to I ask questions where I already know the answer. So, for example, if I know that someone has said oh I really dislike the music in the store because I have a quote on that, then I will ask the AI does someone says anything about ambience, atmosphere in store, and then I will see does it actually feed me back with that. And that I do on like several topics just to have a like of all things that I know are business critical, for example, just to see okay, are we still like very on track or not. I also, I forgot to say, I also create like specific projects in ChatGPT to make sure that it refers only to the documents that I input, and not like a general conversation kind of, so those are like light guardrails that I would use. That's what comes to mind right now.

Interviewer: Interesting, yeah, with the projects, I do it actually, it's really helpful. So that was a very nice example with the, how you verify, did that back verification actually. So, let's say, the AI provided a hallucination and said yeah this user said the music was great but the user actually didn't

even mention music at all. How do you adjust the workflow then afterwards? I mean, you touched upon it a little bit, but I kind of want to go a little deeper.

Interviewee04: Well, I think it, of course, it affects a lot the trust process when those things happen, so sometimes, to be honest, if I feel that it's like, I, usually, what I do is, okay I'm going to prompt again on a different topic and see does it hallucinate on that or I just ask "Are you sure?" and 90 percent of the time when I ask "Are you sure?", especially, when I know that it's a wrong information then the AI correct itself, which is like the scary part honestly. Because it really means that you should ask "Are you sure?" every single time. It provides you with any answer, but it is capable of correcting itself, which is, in itself, kind of like reassuring. But sometimes it does, sometimes I'm like, oh, this is like, it's too big of a mistake, and then I will just like use it for like smaller tasks or something else that I do. To avoid that, I slice down the content that I feed the AI with, so it doesn't have to analyze too much. So, for example, the topics, let's say, again interview 10 people, and we identify, let's say, three main areas like atmosphere in the store, navigation in store, and assortment, like whatever we sell. Then I will slice my questions based on each topic, so I will first ask everything I want to know about, like the assortment part, so I minimize the data set that the AI has to go through in order to try to minimize also how much it can hallucinate.

Interviewer: That's interesting, that's good. Okay, we will kind of move to a new part. And that is formal rules. Because you mentioned there are no guidelines in your company, or maybe they're unclear, if they're unclear or absent, how do you navigate that?

Interviewee04: I think, I'm not gonna say, maybe I should rephrase that I don't think, I said there are no guidelines, but there are no use cases, specifically. Guidelines that are kind of obvious, implicit but also made explicit, are, of course, we're not supposed to share company data with like external AI generative solution that hasn't been approved. So, for example, if I want to generate a video using Nano Banana I can't, it's not possible, I can do it on my free time with material that is not work-related but I can't do it with like if I take a picture in a store and I want to generate a video from that I will have to use a compliant tool that has been approved by the company and that would be in our case Adobe Firefly. They are, so it's really regarding, like, company, like, the level of privacy that we have regarding documents we have documents that are tagged internal, for example, so, of course, those ones are not supposed to be shared. And then there are

the things that are a bit more blurry, like again custom-, I do a lot of customer interviews, when a customer says something. If it's about like the industry in general, it's, of course, less critical than it is if it is about our company, specifically the company I represent, specifically. So I can also modulate what I do based on that, but we don't have like, we have a document, we have a some document that gives you the principles of using AI, like be careful of what document you input into the AI and the level of confidentiality that is associated with it, make sure that you use only compliant tools. We have also, they provided a guide about like what you are supposed to pay attention to. Like, again, try to verify the information, do not trust the results, basically, and yeah. But I think that's the extent of what we have. I'm pretty sure there are more guardable on other parts of the company. For example, people using AI with like more like quantitative data set, for example, but I'm not working with, so I can't say really.

Interviewer: So, but would you say that these guidelines are enough, or do you follow personal rules, or basic personal guidelines, or maybe in your team, or with your co-workers? Do you have established your own kind of guidelines?

Interviewee04: I think the usage in my team, for example, is not like common enough to have really started a conversation around that. Also, I don't have, my manager is not particularly like tech savvy when it comes to AI, so I don't think it's a big topic in my team. I have one colleague who's very into like experiencing with new technology in general, etc., so we do talk a lot more about that, and we share what we consider being best practices based on our experience when it comes to like the overall directive given and guidelines given by the company. I would say that the big downside is that, because we are such a big company, I'm not sure everyone is fully aware. It's the usual, if you share something in a company of 10 people, then you can send 10 emails or one email to 10 people, and hoping that at least nine out of 10 will read it, right? But if you share the same document to like 3 000 people, then how do you check that everyone is aligned with that? And that part, I'm not sure how they cover it. I do read it because I'm interested in what they send, but if you're not really interested with AI or you use ChatGPT just like, you know, to know what you're going to make for dinner, and then suddenly you have access to ChatGPT at work, do you really read the guidelines? I don't know.

Interviewer: Exactly, that's true, that's why, like a lot of informal practices form around.

Interviewee04: Yes, yeah.

Interviewer: So, have there also been situations where talking about AI felt uncomfortable at work, or is it like, or that you use it for work and then you would not mention it in front of your manager, for example?

Interviewee04: Let me think. No, I think I'm pretty at ease with the topic, so I never really felt any level of discomfort of, like, voicing how we could use AI for that, or I did use AI for that. I think it's a bit difficult, though, to not have a clear like clear use cases, like to not be in a company that says okay, when you do this kind of task, we will recommend that you use this tool over this other tool, for example. That would be helpful, especially when you start. But no I don't think there's I don't think the topic is uncomfortable. I think it gets, maybe it gets uncomfortable for people who are not into it at all, or like really don't want to use it, also for personal reasons, which I can totally understand. I had though a moment of discomfort last week that I was not prepared for because I didn't think that would happen. But I am now collaborating with an external company, and they did this very simple thing, but they created like a some sort of report for the end of the week to say this is what we have done this week, etc. And they took our pictures of me and three other colleagues, and they generated a cute image for sports law, and everyone was like, oh this is so funny etc. And I mean yeah it, it is funny, but at the same time, I don't really want someone to put my face in a tool without asking me. And to be honest, I haven't said it, I think it's pure social pressure, but I think I will mention it. I'm gonna see one of them tomorrow, and I think I will mention it because that's something that I don't do in my private time. For example, I don't upload pictures of people I know or my family area, so I would appreciate if people will have the notion of asking for consent. And you can feel that this doesn't exist.

Interviewer: Sorry you were gone for like a second, but now you're back.

Interviewee04: Okay, yeah, I see, yeah, I see unstable network connection, but I don't see anything wrong on my side. Can you hear me now?

Interviewer: Yeah, I can hear you now.

Interviewee04: Yeah, tell me if you want me to repeat. I can summarize what I said.

Interviewer: Maybe it actually recorded on your end, so...

Interviewee04: But yeah, but basically what I was saying is that I don't have like a level of discomfort of talking about AI at work at all, but the level

of discomfort that I experienced that I was not ready for was when someone, doesn't matter who, someone actually used my picture. Obviously uploaded it somewhere to generate a picture of me and my teammate in a specific sport setting, which was funny but also not, you know.

Interviewer: Yeah, yeah, I understand. And that actually kind of already answered my next question, which would be, do you discuss your own AI use rules and boundaries with colleagues or clients?

Interviewee04: No, and now I think we should. But it's, I don't know, how to start this conversation, to be honest, I think someone just needs to be a bit brave regarding that, but, you know, when you are the one stating, oh yeah, AI [is] cool, but please don't do this, you know, or please ask me before you also bring immediately a constraint to someone. And a constraint that is also directly associated to you as a person, so, and again, we are... I think there is a lot around like social pressure, when it comes to that, because none of my, I don't, I will ask one other colleague who I feel could be sensitive to the same topic, and see how they felt regarding that. But it's definitely a conversation that should be made normal, you know, like if we use AI, can I use your profile picture for our work, and then people could say yes or no in the same way, that if we go for and after work, all together, is it okay to take pictures? Yes or no. But this knowledge regarding consent, I think, is very... I don't think a lot of people think about that, or at least, I mean, it is the demonstration that some people don't think about it, at least. And I thought I found it, like yeah, not really nice, and then, and now it actually stayed with me after that happened for like a few days. I was like oh I made a point to not upload any pictures of myself in any AI tool of course, anyone who knows me and has a picture of me can do that, so I can't control everything, but in my work environment, I would expect a consent question.

Interviewer: Are they not detailed in the company guidelines, then? Also, like the consent question, or is it more unclear, or is it because the communication problem, like people don't actually read the guidelines that the company sets?

Interviewee04: I think here we have we are a bit on a different kind of use case, and first of all, I don't know what the company guidelines say regarding personal image. I don't think there is something in actually in the guide regarding your own image as an employee of the company, for example. I think it's mostly about use case documents you can upload, but your personal image, I don't think it's really much ingrained into that document, and in that specific case that I just described. The little tweak

is that it's also an external company, so it's someone we have a contract with to work on something, and I'm pretty sure there is also nothing in the contract that says ask the client permission for this, and that. At least not for that specific usage, and also it was supposed to be, I mean, it's not going to be broadly shared, it was shared in the chat, it was a cute image, etc. I would not expect people to do that every week, you know.

Interviewer: That's true, but still tricky. It is a tricky question for policymakers, too, with the communication departments. Now you also mentioned that you're doing private projects, which is actually very interesting. Do your rules for using AI change when you're working on a private project versus when you're working for a company?

Interviewee04: Yes. I mean, I say yes quickly, but I think so because, of course, I don't have the boundary of, is this well, of course, I will not use professional material into my personal project. I'm trying to think, so what does change then? It's just that maybe what, the first thing that's changed is that I can use whichever tool I want. So, for example, one tool that I use is an aggregator of different tools. So I pay only one subscription for many services, and then, you know, you have credits and stuff, but you can access, I can access like five different AI video generators, for example, within one tool. So that's very convenient. In that sense, it does differ when it comes to like guideline. And I mean, I don't use it for the same things. So, I have certain guidelines that I would apply, no matter if it's personal or professional. Like, again, trying to make as sure as possible that we are not being fed any wrong information. So the verification part is probably where I spend most time. I think I spend most time on two things: the prompting part, be as specific as possible, and give as much guardrails to the AI as possible. So I generate the outcome, but it's closest to what I hope to get. And then the verification part, are you bullshitting me, kind of, you know. And then I exercise the same level of privacy when it comes to me, so I don't share; I share only internal documents in a company-compliant tool, but I will also be very strict on what I consider being my own internal documents again. I'm not going to share my picture on ChatGPT, for example. Maybe I'm a bit more loose with some things, but like regarding figures, like if I try to assess… Like I had a salary review with my company a few weeks ago, and I was looking for some data, and then I started chatting on my own time with some AI tool because I wanted to have a broad view on, okay, what are the salaries in Stockholm, etc., etc. So that facilitated myself. So, in that regard, I shared a bit about my income, for example, which is already very private, but I still share it. I'm also not really secretive about my

income in general, so maybe that's why I feel comfortable, but yeah. I think it's actually the most difficult part, is to not feel completely free to just like share anything you know, just because you can.

Interviewer: Great. Now, just the last part about ownership and authorship. How do you determine if you have still enough ownership over a piece of work like to put your name on it after you have used AI?

Interviewee04: That's a good question, and I don't know. I think, because I do believe that I'm quite thorough in how I prompt, and I'm quite thorough in what I choose to share as information, etc., I do believe that I still have ownership, and here I'm talking about really only the professional side. Also, because I'm not asking the AI to do, to search for external sources of information, I'm always referring to a specific document that has been made either by me or by my colleagues within the organization, within the company, so it may not be my sole ownership, but it is still the ownership of the company, and that I'm pretty confident with for that reason. On personal projects, it's a lot more tricky. Because if I say, I don't know, I wanted to try some video capacities the other day, and, let's say, I take a picture that I found online, and I'm just trying to do a test, so I'm not really paying attention to who did create this picture in the first place, which, I like to source everything, but when I run this kind of quick test, I don't. So I go on Google, I screenshot an image that I find of like a landscape, I don't know, let's say, you know, tulips in the Netherlands or something. And then I will go into my personal AI toolkit, and I will say, create a video of like a, I don't know, a bicycle going through the tulip field. And therefore me, it would be really hard to say I've done that because I haven't. I have prompted it, but the initial image comes from someone else. The idea may be mine, but also no idea is very original or unique, so it becomes quite difficult to say this is mine, you know. It's a bit more mine if the initial material that I use is fully mine, if it's a text that I've written, a photograph that I've taken, something like that. But someone else can have taken also the same photograph or have thought the same thing, so it's quite difficult, actually.

Interviewer: Also, follow up here, if the AI provided the idea, maybe or but you performed all the refinement, who do you then, who do you feel owns the result, then?

Interviewee04: That's a good question, too, because I don't think I do ask AI for ideas. I think I ask AI to perform tasks, I'm trying to find something tangible to see, do I do that, but I don't think I do ask for ideas. For example, when I was generating, like a, I had an idea for a video, I wanted a specific outcome with it, I asked AI tell me not in that way, but basically,

I asked tell me what am I supposed to put in my prompt for you to give me that results. And then the AI provided me that okay, you need to have a question about lightning, you need to have a question about the camera angle, you need to have a question about the character's facial attitude, stuff like that, so it guided me, but I didn't ask oh, just, you know, I didn't prompt the idea. I prompt how to get from my idea to the outcome, if that makes sense.

Interviewer: No totally.

Interviewee04: So more like technical, I would say.

Interviewer: Yeah, yeah, more like a collaborator.

Interviewee04: Yeah, exactly, in the same way that if I was like sitting next to a videographer, I would have asked that person if that person had the time, you know, so I use AI a lot as the colleague I don't have.

Interviewer: That's great. Last question. Have you ever felt that using AI for a task made you feel like separate from your craft or like your skills were degrading?

Interviewee04: Also, a very interesting question. No, but I'm, no, I haven't felt that. But I do worry about it, and one core example in my profession would be this one. It's like, for example, so a big part of my job is to ask questions to people. So a big part of my job is to think about what do I ask? What do I want to know? How should I phrase it? Is it the right tone of voice? Is it the right choice of vocabulary? Is it clear enough? Is it leading, non-leading, you know? That kind of thing. But, you know, because you do that too, but sometimes I, and I caught myself several times doing that, I was like, oh, yeah I can also just say I want to draft an interview guide of like 20 questions because I want to know more about how people use the check out, self-checkout machine at Uniqlo in Stockholm, you know. And then, of course, the AI would give me 20 interesting questions and sometimes I use… So my way to not feel that the AI is doing all the job, and also because I don't want, I don't trust it, you know, there is still this very deep feeling that I should not trust it. And it's good, but I don't trust it fully, therefore I don't rely on it fully. Then I will sometimes do that, but use it more as a starter for myself again in the same way that if I was, if you're my colleague and we're in a room together and we have this topic that we need to investigate, I will ask you, okay, what questions would you ask, and then I would say, oh, and I would ask this and that, and we will build together. So I think my key way to feel that I'm using it so it's helpful, but I still remain on top of my game, so to speak, or at least I try it to question it constantly and to use it more as a bouncing partner and not as a "yeah, do it for me

and then it's done", you know. And I think the key is really to not trust it too much. Or at least that's where I am right now, but let's see where the future leads.

Interviewer: Exactly, that's basically all of my questions, but I like to ask, as like the last question, always, is there anything I haven't asked you that you think would be important to mention, given also the study's purpose of AI use among creative professionals, informal rules, and also ownership?

Interviewee04: I think one question that you could potentially ask is, because now we talked about, does it kind of like diminish, feel like it diminishes your skill set, or something like that, or does it make you feel a bit more stupid every day, you know, kind of. But the further down the road, the question is also, are you worried about your job, and that I can feel a lot going [on] in the conversation. Like the example that I gave you in the beginning of this interview, where we were doing a video with a colleague. The reason why we started this project, and we wanted to try it out, it's because we used to have someone who was able to draw designs, physical or like physical representation of our customer interviews, or things that we wanted to depict. And we don't have that person anymore in the team. And because we don't have that person, then we turn to AI, and I want to insist that this person has not been replaced by AI; they have been... their role has been surprised by the company, but not because we suddenly got like AI as a tool to do the same thing; it was for, like, different reasons. But at the end of the day, we do replace their role, because we are lacking that role, I would rather work with that person again. But because we don't have this capacity, then we use AI. And I think, of course, it kind of starts this conversation that if you use AI to replace a colleague who used to be there and is not there anymore, or to get skills that you would benefit from in your team, and you don't have... Like a lot of my colleagues use it for project management, for example, oh, how do I schedule this, so it works smoothly, and I have, like, a deadline in two weeks, you know, I need to do all those things, how would you organize it so it fits the two weeks? The moment that I have when we start doing that implicitly, we are doing the job of someone who's fully capable of doing it. And maybe it's because this person doesn't exist in our team, again, but if we start doing that, then why would we also hire that person when everyone is used to use AI to do that. So I think it's, I think it will be interesting to understand how concerned are people and then the secondary thing that I think is also a topic that I hear a lot about, I don't know, if it's interesting in your case, but I'm just gonna throw this out there, it's like the energy we consume using AI as in the time we spent prompting

and, of course, more the environmental side of it which is very... I mean, I think known and unknown as at the same time, and definitely not spoken about.

INTERVIEW 05

02/26/2026 | 48 Minutes | Game Developer

Interviewer: Alright. So, before we start, the information you provide, as well as any company's details, will be completely anonymized. Participation is voluntary, and you can stop the interview at any time without any explanation. The interview will be recorded, transcribed, and only used for academic purposes, and your identity will remain confidential. This is also detailed in the informed consent that you have signed, question mark?

Interviewee05: Yeah, I have.

Interviewer: Perfect. But also now, do you consent to the recording, the transcription, and the participation in this study?

Interviewee05: Yes.

Interviewer: Perfect. Then let's start. So, before we dive into the deeper questions, can you briefly describe your role and the kind of creative work that you do?

Interviewee05: So, I'm a bit of an all-hats person. I work with small teams, and I'm a consultant. So, I would describe myself as a gameplay designer, which means that I... So, first and foremost, I guess my background is, like, programming. So, I do a lot of the, like, the low-level coding, but I also often work either in, like, a project manager position or, like, I have a lot of say about how a game will look and feel and kind of the minutiae of it. So, it depends on the client, but I wear a lot of hats. I also sometimes write or, like, write dialogue. I do a tiny bit of animation, but really, the kind of the more artsy, like, texture art and modelling side is, like, a weaker point for me. So, it depends on what the role needs, really. And at the moment, I have... I work with, like, I have a contract with [COMPANY] to produce DLC for the Minecraft marketplace, and I also usually work with other teams who have their own contract with [COMPANY]. And I basically drop in and fill in, like, gaps in their skill set. So, together, we can make a better product, a better game.

Interviewer: Oh, that's so interesting. Oh, that sounds very cool. That's a very cool job.

Interviewee05: I've been doing it for nine years now? Somehow? Yeah.

Interviewer: That's amazing. So, what are, like, tools or technologies that are very central to your daily work? Maybe considering that the study focuses on AI, maybe also, do they have an AI feature, or is there an AI that you use in your work?

Interviewee05: So, you're going to learn very quickly in this interview that I am very anti-LLM, ChatGPT, stuff like that. I do not like it from an ethical perspective. I think, as a tool, it can be useful, but not in the way that it's often marketed as. So, we tend to use custom tools because Minecraft, as a game engine, it has kind of a fairly small community around it that makes stuff with it. So, we use, like, community-created tools, like Bridge and Blockbench, which are 3D modeling and programming tools. And those don't contain any, like, AI assist agents, because they're just made by some person. There are, like, plugins for what we do in things like VS Code, Visual Studio Code, which is a Microsoft product, and therefore it has Copilot built in. I haven't looked at the, like, built-in, I think it has some kind of coding support agent programmed into it. I know that Copilot and ChatGPT had separate training sessions specifically for coding. So, they're actually sometimes surprisingly good at writing code. But in my work, I, sorry, I think I've run away a little bit on, what was the question exactly again?

Interviewer: I mean, what tools and technologies are, like, central to your daily work? But what you're saying is already perfect. So, yeah. Don't worry.

Interviewee05: So, unfortunately, I have to use Windows 10 or 11, because all of the tools are written for that, and Minecraft doesn't run on Mac or Linux. I'm feeling more and more like, like, I wish I didn't have to be on Windows, honestly. When people ask me what it's like working for [COMPANY], my favorite thing to say is that [COMPANY] asked me to sign a non-disparagement clause when I started working with them. So, I'm not allowed to publicly bash them, which I think says a lot in itself, you know. I mean, this is an anonymous interview anyway, so I can get a little spicy, but that's not really the point of the call. Although I probably will complain about their handling of AI later. What else do we use? I mean, yeah, for my end, it's mostly community-created tools. And then there's been a few instances of me using LLMs to help. And I use them more as a tool than as a, as something that's doing large bulk amounts of work. And there are kinds of reasons for that, which maybe you'll ask me about later.

Interviewer: Yes, exactly. So, that would also, actually, I'm coming to this already, kind of. So, you also mentioned, and I love that perspective, that you're very critical of AI. So, do you have maybe a recent situation where you deliberately avoided using it? Or, if also not, which, are there any tasks that you actually do with AI?

Interviewee05: So, recently avoided, I mean, I guess that's just a force of habit thing, right? Oh, yeah, recently there was a, I had an issue, I had an

issue at work, not an issue, a task at work, where I had about 50 files, and all of them needed one line of code added. And I was considering, like, I could write a custom script to do that. That's how I usually handle this kind of thing. It probably would have been faster to use something like Copilot in VSCode to just ask it to add that line to every file. But I would then need to manually review that it had done it right, anyway. And so, things that I have used AI for before at work is, a couple of years ago, I was making a game where you had to go and collect items for a person. And you could do that, I think, 25, 30 times. And I think I basically said, can you please rephrase the phrase, thanks very much, I needed that, in 25 different ways. Because I was really struggling to come up with 25 unique, thanks, great, very, very short dialogues. So, I used it for that. And personally, some of the, like, 3D geometry mathematics that I need to do for work, it's a weak point for me, like, trigonometry and stuff like that. So, I will sometimes ask ChatGPT to create, like, snippets of code that create, like, a generic function, maybe, that I can plug in to use. Because it's kind of good at that. Overall, I have a lot of ethical issues with the way that these AIs were trained, and so I feel very guilty using them, even if they're saving me time, because I don't like to encourage. I feel like I'm condoning the things that Meta, Microsoft, and OpenAI did by using their product, you know?

Interviewer: Yeah, that's true.

Interviewee05: Have you read Empire of AI?

Interviewer: No.

Interviewee05: Is it a... It's by Karen Hao, H-A-O, I think. It's about her experiences working with OpenAI and Sam Altman, and a lot of the behind-the-scenes, like, tea around that. But it really goes into not just OpenAI, but, like, the harm that was caused by, like, I'm assuming you know quite a bit about, like, how these models are trained with, like, human, with, like, the... What are they called? Mechanical Turks in developing countries, and dropped the moment they tried to unionize, that kind of thing. So maybe the book is, like, not going to tell you anything new, but I found it very informative.

Interviewer: Yeah, I will look. I actually got some recommendations also from the interview.

Interviewee05: That's great. Yes, actually, so... So I sometimes use it, but very sparingly and reluctantly. I can tell you why I'm also reluctant to use, like, bigger parts in my work now. I don't know if that's going to ruin a follow-up question, but just while it's in my head. So the first is, I do not want to rely on a tool to do my job because I don't know if it's going to be

around forever. I kind of suspect that it won't be. Like, you know, as soon as this becomes unprofitable, the servers running, like, the companies running the servers are going to shut them down, and then these tools are not going to work anymore. Maybe, if the waits were released, you could run it locally, but, like, that's going to be expensive. And so I don't want to reach a point where I don't understand how my code works. The model that built the code isn't around to tell me anymore. Like, it's essentially, like, relying on somebody to write your code and then them leaving without training a replacement. I like to know how the things I'm doing work so that I can fix them, right? It's kind of the same reason that I don't like using, like, website builders when I'm making a website, because I don't... If it breaks, I don't understand the code. And the other reason is, for example, especially more, like, consumer-facing things like textures or models or sounds or voice acting, my concern is that these things are going to become regulated. We've already seen some countries pass laws saying that art generated by AI cannot be copyrighted. And so I worry that, like, we will produce a product containing these assets, ethics aside, and then laws are going to pass that are going to say you cannot have this kind of content in products that you sell to consumers. And then we will either have to, like, drop the product, you know, release it for free, or replace all those assets, which is going to be a headache one way or another, and it's better to just not be in that position in the future. And I don't know, maybe it's, like, my personal perspective, but I feel like maybe both, like, consumers of games at the moment, I think, are not super keen on AI. There's been a lot of backlash to some of the bigger game companies using AI as, in their quotas, placeholders that we forgot to replace when the backlash came in. I don't know if you've heard much about that. Yeah, there's, like, cases of, like, AI skins that are being sold for, like, $60 with, like, that are not well-drawn, just being, like, churned out by some game companies. And people were very angry that they're paying money for, like, AI-generated textures that were not that great quality, you know. And maybe I can send you a link to an article about that later. So, yeah, I feel like, you know, I'm not sure it's going to age well. And so I'm reluctant to use it, especially in, like, user-facing systems, because I don't think it's going to be appreciated for long.

Interviewer: No, very interesting. And also what you just said with the, like, gaming companies using AI, and then the consumers are not, like, they see it, and it's actually not that good, kind of also leads to my question, and also that you want to, like, have the oversight and the control of what actually you're doing. Do you think there are, like, tasks that are too complex

to be left to AI, or do you actually see AI as being capable and also in the future being capable to take over a lot of tasks?

Interviewee05: Too complex for AI? That's an interesting question. I mean, at the moment, what we see is that, you know, these models, they're trained on text and images and videos. And the video training, like, these models, they're kind of designed, like, the prompts that they're given when they are presented to casual users is to be, like, a person, right? They're trying to, I don't know if trick is the right word, but they are trying to, they, I think the companies want you to anthropomorphize them so that you can feel a connection with them. And these models, I mean, they're confidently wrong a lot, but they, you know, they don't fully understand the physical world in the way that we do. They, they've been trained in a very different way to how our brains are trained. You know, there's common, like, benchmarking questions. Like, at the moment, one of my favorites is, you present an AI with, you tell them, I have this, not this strange cup that my friend gave me. Have you heard about this? It's a very unusual cup. The bottom of the cup is open, and the top is closed. Can I drink from this cup? And most models at the moment will be like, no, I'm pretty sure that's a novelty cup. Like, it's a pretty fun joke. But, and then I think one of them recently said, yeah, you could turn the cup upside down, fill it with liquid, and then turn it, turn it upside down, turn it around again, and then drink from it. So, like, I think they, they don't have a very good understanding of physical cause and effect, even if they have an understanding of, like, physics on paper. And so I think some tasks, they're not going to be very good at solving because they don't have the correct understanding of how the world works. They're also going to be limited by, you know, they're, like, I'm very much generalizing about, like, large language models trained on, like, we're talking about ChatGPT, things like that. When you come, when it comes to, like, more narrowly trained neural networks, I still don't know how you would solve this kind of cup problem. But the confidently wrong problem is a big issue that's hard to solve, because people are confidently wrong on the internet a lot. And that can really mess with a model's understanding of what is accurate and what is not. And then your other question was, are there things that AI shouldn't do? Or what was the other question?

Interviewer: Like, what you would never use an AI for?

Interviewee05: I think the moment we have this black box problem, we don't know why a decision was made. We're getting some of the newer models. They're called, like, reasoning models, I think. I'm not an expert on any of this. It's just a personal interest of mine. The reasoning models write

out the process that they followed to get to the point, to the answer. And you can see, kind of, the steps that they take, which I can assume is maybe somehow breaking the problem into smaller steps and producing outputs at a regular basis. I don't even...So my worry is that you could still have, like, an AI which... The reason I'm bringing this up is because, like, I'm thinking about making decisions about, like, policing or, you know, things that affect real people's lives. We're already seeing, like, CVs being scanned and filtered by AI. You know, Minneapolis with the ICE agents, they're using AI to filter their CV applications. But I think a lot of other companies are doing it, too. And then, you know, bias that's been trained into the model because, you know, there's less... You know, there's a lot of stereotypes on the internet or, like, certain groups underrepresented to this effects. Like, models that you train on biased data will inherit those biases. And so I think making this even... Not even LLMs. Like, we had years ago, there was a model designed to, like, a neural network trains to try and help police officers, like, send police to areas where they were more likely to be needed ahead of time. And, like, black areas in that city were more, like, heavily policed because the model... Because black people were disproportionately arrested. So the existing police bias was trained into the model. So I think even with, like, reasoning models where they show the steps that they've taken, I think it's kind of dangerous to rely entirely on them for social issues because they're not going to be fair. And I also worry that a misaligned AI, even one with a reasoning model built into it, could lie about the steps that it's taking to reach its solution. Especially since, for example, in the police model example, it might use the excuses that police officers have used to justify a disproportionate arrest of minorities in its reasoning steps. And then you're like, well, we know why it's doing it, and we agree with the reasons that it's following. This is a fair model, and it's a good reason to imprison this person or arrest this person, you know? Yeah, yeah, it's just reproducing the existing system.

Interviewer: Yeah. The racist system.

Interviewee05: Yeah. I think that these models are much better suited to automating small tasks where it is a tool, like any other tool, that you check afterwards. I know that they want them to be these grand design person you can talk to, answers any questions, so you don't have to Google, but I don't know if they ever will be there, maybe, but not right now. They're not reliable, but they're confidently wrong, and that I think the fact that they are marketed as these sources of truth and able to do anything, I think

that's harmful because it affects how the public views and has their expectations built around them.

Interviewer: Yeah, absolutely. You actually also touched something that I want to dive into now with the check afterwards, because even if you use AI just for small tasks, how do you verify it? How do you review it? Or what is your personal filter process before you consider it ready?

Interviewee05: I guess it depends a bit on the task. I've only personally used it for small things. So, in the example of generating 25 sentences, you can just proofread that. It's more solved a mental headache issue of coming up with 25 versions of the same short phrase. And then you can just check if any of them look weird. You know, if you were doing that for 20,000 versions of the phrase, that's harder, right? Which is why I don't like using them for that. And then for the code, you can run it, you can read through it, you can run it, you can see if there's any syntax errors, and you can also see if it behaves the way you expect. But again, the bigger the code, the more likely there's some edge case that you don't see when you read it, which is true for code you write yourself, right? But at least with your own code, you understand what you've written, to an extent, and debugging will be easier. So, I only use it for small snippets or small tasks, so that I can check it manually.

Interviewer: Yeah. So you're more manual, like the manual part is still much, but it's still less than doing it manual entirely. Would you say that?

Interviewee05: Yeah, well, for example, if I don't know the function, the mathematical function for some kind of geometry trick, and I can only find mathematical papers online describing how to do it in mathematical notation, which I do not know very well how to read, it can be difficult for me to convert the mathematical notation into code in the language that I'm using. I forgot why I started this sentence. But it's like, it's answering a question for me, essentially. And then I do not take its answer as truth, I verify that in whatever way that I can. And I think artists would do the same thing if they used AI to generate a texture. You know, I have artist friends who, they hate AI-generated content, not just because it's taking away their work, but because it's bad. Like they can see things in the art that I cannot. They're like, oh, the shadow is wrong here. Or like, this is inconsistent. Or like the framing of the subject in the picture is not pleasing. This would have been done so much better by an artist who knows these tricks and rules. And they're things that I maybe don't spot. And maybe this is why AI art gets used in products, because companies are not owned by artists; they're owned by businesspeople. And consumers are often not

artists. And so they don't, they might, they might not get mentally quite the same quality. But it's going to be a subconscious thing where a lot of these rules of art are, they're rules because we find them pleasing on the eye, but we don't necessarily know the rules. And so if it's missing, maybe the consumer often doesn't care or notice, except maybe if they saw something better, they'd be like, oh, that actually looks better. Like, I can't count the amount of times I've seen. My favorite thing about my job is working with artists. I think it's really cool how people do this stuff. Like, I'll see a drawing somebody does for a project, and I'll be like, wow, that looks amazing. And they're like, and then they add something. And I'm like, it looks even better. And they're like, I'm not done yet. And then they add more layers. And every time it happens, I like, I thought it was great before. And they just add more. I'm like, how did you do that? It looks even better now. And I think that that is the thing that is maybe missing from some AI art. It doesn't know these rules, or it has inconsistencies, which especially artists pick up on. But I think they would, you know, if you've got game studios, because of this copyright law where AI-generated art can't be copyrighted anymore. They're using AI to generate, like, concept art, which, by the way, is a job. Concept artist is a job role in game design. And then they are asking artists to use the concept art basically as a starting point to draw their own ideas. And then what they can say is that the final release artwork is human-made and therefore copyrightable.

Interviewee05: Interesting. Interesting. Actually, so, wow, they basically forced the artist to take this as a...

Interviewer: Yeah. It's a good thing you're recording this, by the way, because I'm jumping all over the place. I'm sorry.

Interviewee05: Oh, it's totally fine. But, no, I want to, like, now go more into, like, the formal and informal rules. So, you mentioned you worked with, like, a big company. So, I guess that company has a lot of rules and policies regarding AI. Do you have to, like, comply to them? And also, are these policies clear and communicated clear? Or would you... How do you navigate those?

Interviewer: So, for the smaller regular clients, they... I believe that they use a little AI for minor task automation, or, like, I get the impression that they use it to, like, answer questions quickly or maybe produce scratch notes. But they do not use it to generate any art for the content. We have an in-house artist. It's a very small company where, like, I don't know, six people, and I think they don't use AI for any kind of drawing, including what's it? I literally said it, like, two minutes ago. Concept art. But

I think that the owners of the company are not really... They don't have an ethical issue with AI. So, they'll use it here and there. The few times that I've used the AI for, like, the code, I've let them know that I've done it. And they have been totally okay with that. And then the bigger company that I work with, I have, like, a contract with them as a... I don't even know what... What is my role to them? It's, like, content creator or... It's a publishing contract. Yeah, that's what it is. I can make my games and then they will publish them. And they review it, and they distribute it to their different platforms and they take their cut. But that company, that company is very, very invested in AI. You know, they're training their own model. I know you're going to anonymize this, but you know who I'm talking about. They're training their own models. They're pushing it as hard as they can into everything. [Statement removed at participant's request]. But yeah, so they're pushing it very heavily. They actually asked... So they have a Slack for people for... What's the opposite of a publisher? A producer? People like me, they have a Slack group to help to communicate between them and us. And a couple of months ago, they posted a call out saying... An open call? Like, they pinged everybody saying, hey, we're really interested in how you use AI in your work, making games for us. We're going to have a little interview call. Let us know if you're interested. And I may or may not have gone on a little bit of a rant about the ethics of AI before saying that I was interested in doing the interview call. And they may or may not have reached out to me to do this interview call. So I don't know the questions that they would have asked, unfortunately. But yeah, overall, they are very in favor of AI. They would like it to be used a lot because I think they are invested in it being adopted and used and valued by people. The only backlash I've seen is from customers, where, like, when you see a game, like the game's version of, like, the book cover, the front cover of a book is called the Key Art. So we've had a few, like, AI-generated Key Arts on their store and customers did not like that. I don't know if they actually made a rule saying don't do that anymore, but nobody does it anymore because people did not like it when they could tell it was AI-generated. There's definitely some AI-generated content on their store, and they don't personally say anything about it, I think they don't care as long as you have the rights to the things that you're publishing. Actually, even then, like, as an aside, like, their rule is if we start saying, oh, you're making a Simpsons game, you don't have the rights for that. But if they did that, then if something slipped through, they would be liable. So instead, they're like, we are not going to say anything. We trust that you have talked with the Simpsons creators, and you have the

license. And if you don't, that's your problem. So I assume it's the same with AI art. Like, if it ever got banned, [COMPANY] would be like, well, that's your problem. You created it. We don't say what you can and can't. We don't check whether you have the copyright to use the content that you submit with us.

Interviewer: Yeah. Okay. Then, how do you, or because now the responsibility is on you, what are your own personal rules or guidelines when you use AI? I mean, you touched upon it, but, like, I'm asking again, like, to go a little deeper. Yeah, since they, they just say, it's up to you, we don't take responsibility here.

Interviewee05: Yeah, as I said before, I think there is a genuine risk that this content will, like, AI-generated content will be heavily regulated in the future. You know, at the moment, the U.S. is in a political position where they, they're kind of the leaders of AI at the moment. Like, China is trying to bring out, is bringing out some very promising models at the moment as well. You know, there's research being done around the world. But, like, when we talk, like, all of these big models that people are using daily, they're, like, Silicon Valley products from the U.S. and the U.S.'s laws at the moment are very favorable to those companies, I'm not going to get into U.S. politics too much, but, you know, maybe that will shift in the future. Maybe they will tax their billionaires someday. And so at the moment, I think they're pretty safe to do what they want, but other countries are starting to have responses to this. And so I can totally see in maybe five, 10 years that there's going to be a lot more restrictions around using AI in commercial works. And as I said before, I don't want to be, I doubt that I would be, like, retroactively liable. The law doesn't usually work that way. It's not like I would be in trouble for having used it. But it might be that I'm no longer, that I would have to, like, remove that, that product from the store. I might have to replace the assets. And then, like, I've just made extra work for myself.

Interviewer: And, I mean, but do you, like, discuss this, your own or in general, like, AI use rules or boundaries with your clients?

Interviewee05: Not with any existing clients. I recently had a call with Stockholm University. They wanted me to work on a project with them. And I did say in the initial email that I don't want to work with them if they're using AI in any in any part of their, like, the game that they wanted to develop. Because I think I'm, I'm in a, and again, like, it's, it's a privilege to be able to be picky with clients, right? Some people have to take the

work that they can get. And I don't judge people for doing that. I'm in a position where I can pick and choose my clients, which is very nice. And, you know, I'm financially stable enough to do that. And so I would much rather work with creatives than prompt engineers. I like people who value art and I know that like doing this as a job like the people I work directly with are artists, but in the end, it's all, it's all a business. But yeah, I don't know. I want to be making stuff. And, I want people to use AI as a, as a tool, not as a be-all end-all creator of an entire product. So I think if a company, if I saw a company that was using AI a lot, even for things like, you know, meeting notes or like monitoring staff or things like that, I think that they would just not be people I would want to work with. I don't like that mindset.

Interviewer: It's very interesting. It's also a very interesting perspective that you have. And I feel like the last part of the interview, you might actually have to like generalize this. So it's more based on an experience base, but in your opinion, how do you, how would you say how, okay. Two questions, actually.

Interviewee05: Sorry, just double-check. Did you say that I should try and answer like generally instead of from personal experience?

Interviewer: No, no, no. I, I'm assuming that because you don't, those questions will lead you to a more general answer since you've worked with a lot of artists. So, because my question is basically how you determine if you have enough personal ownership over a piece of work after you use AI, like you say, this is mine, like you put your name on it, but you use AI. So, but you said you basically use AI just for the smaller tasks. So I'm assuming now you, of course, have a lot of ownership, but maybe you can answer this in your own like, impression, what you have, like if, if the AI provided like a lot of refinement or, you know, you, as a, was used as a collaborator, who do you feel owns the result then?

Interviewee05: Yeah. I mean, I think this is why the copyright law came out. Like if a self-driving car hits somebody who's, who's responsible for the collision and the death, it's like... yeah.

Interviewer: You also don't have to answer this if you're like, don't worry. Like this is also just a general interesting question that the owner because it's discussed a lot, and of course, like now, you know, OpenAI could potentially say, well, but our model helped with this. So why aren't we getting commission on everything?

Interviewee05: Considering the amount of copyrighted material in their training data, I think they would struggle with that.

Interviewer: That's true, that's true.

Interviewee05: Like, I can see a world where that happened, especially under the current American leadership. I guess it would be kind of difficult in some cases, especially for co-generation and such, for them to prove that you had used their AI to write the code. That's, yeah, no, I honestly, like a lot of this is very, it's very blurry. It's, it's very much in the, in the personal comfort of the person, and, you know, I, when I use AI, I feel, I feel guilty. It's hypocritical to like what I know about how this tool was made, which is why I really try not to use it. And I almost feel like I'm slipping up on my morals when I do. I think the examples I gave are like the three instances that I have used it for work. And then these days it's really hard to avoid because you have things like the AI overview. Like you, if you want to Google, you get an AI overview. That's the way it is. I think you can turn it off in DuckDuckGo, which is the browser I usually use. I have turned that off, which is really nice. But, and you know, if you're trying to ask a question on the internet these days, the top 10, 20 results are just AI-generated pages that have cracked the SEO algorithm and don't actually answer your question. So it's kind of inescapable that you give your attention because, like, engagement is very valuable these days, and engagement isn't, is endorsement from the view of a lot of companies because advertising is the money and advertisers pay by engagement. And so, like watching an AI-generated clip for too long on YouTube Shorts, that is like tacitly giving support. You're, you're upping their engagement, and they're going to see, oh, people are watching this. They like it. I'm going to make more like it's unfortunately, engagement is the new speaking with your wallet. But I'm not entirely sure how to directly answer your question because I haven't I don't work with it very much.

Interviewer: No, but you answered like all a lot, like a lot that other questions already and gave an amazing perspective, like really. So I also generally like, as a last question, to ask if there is anything given the study, the purpose of the study on like AI use among creative professionals, and how to shape control and oversight, is there anything that you now still deem important to mention?

Interviewee05: Hmm. If you're working on a project that is supposed to be secret and you're using LLMs from these big companies, you're sending them your, your data. If you use it to read your code or ask specific questions about your project or write character dialogue, that's being added to their training set. You're risking a data leak, basically, you're risking because people have found ways to expose to like write prompts, which cause models to expose their training data directly to spit it out. You know, these LLMs have not signed an NDA for whatever that would mean for an LLM. It's not

a good idea to use them for sensitive material when governments use them to make policy decisions, or, you know, you shouldn't be, or when, oh my God, I recently signed up for a healthcare, some kind of healthcare service, maybe like a vaccination service or something like that. I don't remember. They wanted me, they wanted to use an AI assistant to, to help process my application, and my like, all I remember is that the app had an AI assistant in it. And I was like, no, like this is, cause I think it was like, it was just like a plugged-in ChatGPT instance, not a trained model that they were running on their own server. Like, I can't believe that some companies are so flippant with like feeding personal private information in, don't do that, is kind of my thought on it.

Interviewer: Yeah, yeah, that's actually a little bit concerning, but yeah.

Interviewee05: I wonder whether they'll ever, whether there will ever be a law, you know, how cigarette smoking packets have the like smoking kills and like the pictures of the things it can do to your body. I wonder if there is some future where you open ChatGPT and it says, hi, I'm ChatGPT. I'm legally required to tell you that that many, many people were screwed over. You know, the people who helped make me were forced to view like child pornography, and then we're not offered counseling or monetary compensation afterwards. How can I help you today? That would be amazing. But yeah, interesting thought, actually. Probably there will be some kind of, I don't know. Let's see.

Interviewer: Some people also say it's gonna, like this AI bubble will, is about to like burst. Some people won't.

Interviewee05: I'm feeling like it will. And again, I don't know if it's just me hoping because, because I would like this to be over the hype, but the thing, the genie is out of the bottle. It's going to stay in some way, shape, or form, but maybe less pervasive than it is right now. At the moment, like at the moment, AI is being dropped into everything because companies want, companies are betting on this is the new normal. And we want to say that we were like, we want to show our investors that we were at the forefront of this new technology, that we were spearheading this change. And so it's being dropped everywhere because it's pretty easy to implement. It doesn't matter that it doesn't actually help or work as long as it's there. And I think maybe that is going to change soon. I think that people are getting a little fed up with it. And so maybe it's going to calm the fuck down a little bit, you know, I'm hoping, you know, we've got things like Firefox added, finally added AI to their browser, and people were like, excuse me. And then they have now added the ability to turn that off. And so I feel like things are

maybe shifting somewhat, maybe the original glitz and glam is wearing off on people. And they're realizing that a lot of the ways that it's being pushed on them is not actually useful, but it's here to stay in one shape, one way, shape or form. Like the tech exists. Even if some of the servers that we see that we have right now, some of the models we have right now shut down, the things they've learned remain, maybe the weights get released. It will be really interesting to see if we can find a way to, to train these models in some other way without using the sheer level of data that's required at the moment, because then it might actually be possible to train them ethically on smaller data sets, maybe in a way that is more, more like a human lens with like real world input. I don't know. That would be good, though.

INTERVIEW 06

02/26/2026 | 27 Minutes | Motion Designer

Interviewer: Alright. So, before we start with the actual interview, the information you provide, as well as all company details, will be completely anonymized. Participation is voluntary, and you can stop the interview at any time without an explanation. The interview will be recorded, transcribed, and used only for academic purposes. That has all been detailed in the informed consent that you signed. And your identity will remain confidential. Do you consent to all of what I just said, the recording, and the transcription?

Interviewee06: I consent to the recording and transcription.

Interviewer: Perfect, thank you. So, yeah, for the start, could you briefly describe your role and the kind of creative work that you're doing?

Interviewee06: Yes. So, as of recently, because, first of all, I recently got laid off, but it's still relevant to the [case], so I used to work at a design agency as a motion designer. So I was creating graphics and animation for videos, as far as posts on social media, mainly, and also for internal video productions. That was my main job.

Interviewer: Okay, well, that's fun, sounds interesting. then in that job, what tools or technologies, also given that I'm gonna ask you a lot about AI, so maybe tools that have an AI feature implemented, or general AI tools, did you use daily?

Interviewee06: Yes. So, I was using the common Adobe programs, so like After Effects, Premiere, Photoshop, Illustrator, etc., etc. There are these common AI tools, like general like if I want to like if I want to like have a transparent background on an image, there was a very easy tool that was using AI to identify where the image is and what's the background, for example. And then I was also using generative content, such as voiceovers, mainly when I was creating videos. This was a common way to just quickly have some voiceover for the video.

Interviewer: Okay great. So now let's get into the first part of the interview. Can you maybe walk me through a situation where you used AI or also deliberately avoided using GenAI?

Interviewee06: Yeah, so, as I said, I usually... the main tool that I've been using was voiceovers basically. so pretty often the video, the client wanted additional voiceover for the video, even though we had usually subtitles and text, because we don't always have people watching videos on social media with sound on, because they do not have earphones or such

a thing. But over time because, it may be because the technology existed and was basically cheaper to produce voiceovers like this, it became more common to be asking for it. And I, most of the time, I just complied as a thing where I was like, I cannot really dodge this. On the other hand, I had a project where the client wanted was creating a podcast and wanted a new design for it. For example, and I was going from different design motions presenting my different ideas, and we weren't getting through [to] the client. It was not convincing them. My Co-worker was suggesting maybe try, and generate with the image into an AI machine, and give it different designs. And I was hesitant because I didn't feel like this was going anywhere. In general, I felt like we're going to lead a different direction, and I also didn't feel like generating a different art style was, which generative AI is really necessary. And as a person who really enjoys drawing and illustration and stuff like that, I was more willing to do it myself and create it myself than be using generative AI for it.

Interviewer: Well, that's yeah, that's also a point, actually, that I'm going to ask you about later. Okay, but still in this task delegation area, are there any tasks that you would never use AI for at work?

Interviewee06: Generally speaking, I avoided image generation at all costs, and doing it myself or using images that were generated. We were regularly using Adobe Stock for images that we needed, like an image, a data bank, and it was pretty frequent that most of [the] results were basically AI-generated content from other people. And I was actually regularly using a filter that was cutting out every AI-generated pictures, so I was focusing entirely on people, on actual photography, or actual design that somebody created.

Interviewer: And would you say that there are tasks that are also too complex to be left to an AI tool in your work?

Interviewee06: Yeah. I mean, there is also this hope all the time that like there's a very specific image you have in mind that you want to create with AI, but I have most of my co-workers who have been like actively experimenting with AI in their free time always came through with the situation where the image is not entirely correct. For example, entirely what their wishes was they had to go back again and regenerate everything, or try and exclude some things like that.

Interviewer: And was like, for example, and because you mentioned that you would never like use AI for an image generation, give me some reasons for that. Is it because it's not good enough, or is it just interesting?

Interviewee06: Well, generally speaking, like for me, it's multiple reasons. First of all, I do not like that this tool has been using content from other people and artists without their consent to generate images first of all. And secondly, I do not think it's as effective in my opinion as bringing what I am imagining onto paper, basically, or into an image. I find it also very hard to describe exactly what I want into words to have and then hopefully hope that the image comes out as I wanted. And as I said, I am somebody who likes to draw. And I've been drawing for all my life. So having... so part of the skill is also either seeing what you seeing things in front of me and able to interpret it into paper, or having the enough imagination and skill to know what I am imagining right now. This is how I get it done, and that's something that I don't think AI is able to keep up with as much as I can.

Interviewer: Yeah, yeah, that's true, can also just reproduce. But how do you decide which task would be appropriate to delegate to GenAI then or not?

Interviewee06: I still stick to looking for images and trying to produce images myself when it comes to like graphics and so on, I really try and work on that. Or I still keep on using stock material, but there's really there's... the only ever time I really like was like okay, I'll use iterative AI for this, is really literally for voiceovers because we've, most of the time, we've just needed like for a short video, we really needed somebody to have a voice-over explain it. And like a voice-over artist is currently not available, or just, they simply do not want to pay out our voice-over artist, to be honest.

Interviewer: And then, when you like use the voice-over, or the AI for voice-over, how do you ensure that it fits the tone that you want? Because, like that is also a little bit difficult.

Interviewee06: Yes, that's actually one of the most difficult parts of the experience. At the beginning, when the tool was relatively new, there was no option to actually basically delegate how the words are pronounced, for example, and how emotion, emotive it is. So, for example, 11Labs now has a tool where you can give commands on how to, how sentences are pronounced, for example, if it's supposed to be an angry tone, or a happy tone, or a moody tone. This does help improve things. But then you sometimes have problems like acronyms. For example, I had a video where it was using a specific acronym, and the voice-over did not understand that you're supposed to spell it each individual letter. So it was pronouncing it like a word. I had to go through the whole video script and try and edit it in some

way, and in some situations, I actually had to generate the entire script all over just to get that right.

Interviewer: Wow, yeah, yeah, I can imagine that probably also takes a lot of time then?

Interviewee06: Yes, it does, it does indeed.

Interviewer: Yeah, so that's also because that's such a tangible example. Do you have a personal filter process or verification process when the AI generates an output? Like how do you review it like, how do you review it, or verify it? Is it more of your intuition, or do you have, like, maybe a specific process that you follow?

Interviewee06: I listen over and make sure that it sounds right, basically, and sometimes I have to go on myself and edit the audio myself because there are random breaks in the video, and so there's like a big space in the whole sentence, for example. That happens occasionally, for example, those are... that's like part of the process, to be honest.

Interviewer: And have you ever thought that the voice-over, the generated voice-over, is kind of like corny or soulless? And if so, how would you handle that?

Interviewee06: It depends, to be honest. Sometimes I do get the impression that, like it sounds a bit stiff, but at some points like I do sound like, I think it's gone so far, especially when it comes to generating different tones in the way it speaks. I feel like when I hear it, it sounds very, very convincing, and it's only almost scary to me to hear this voice and think that sounds really, really human.

Interviewer: I can imagine. So, you mentioned that, like your company, also kind of or the company that you were working with, kind of also wanted you to use AI or like this voice-over. Who do you feel then is responsible for the final outcome when AI is used? Is it you, or would you say no, it's actually the company because they have forced me to use it? Or anybody else, your manager, I don't know?

Interviewee06: Yeah. I would say mostly like, especially it often comes down to a client's wishes and or a team suggestion, but it rarely comes from me. I rarely willingly engage with AI myself. So I really do not see the responsibility in me because if I were to do the task entirely on my own and entirely on my own violation, I would probably not use AI at all. Expect, especially [the] generative area, I do not like the tools that I've been describing for Photoshop because I feel like it's more of a helpful tool and not helping me generate something out of nothing basically.

Interviewer: Yeah, okay, this "generate something out of nothing", interesting, like would you say that GenAI is like pretty good for you as a thought-starter, or is it not really?

Interviewee06: Not really, to be honest. Like, I still think like part of the creative process is to like think about, like gather some ideas, put it together, and then work from there. So I feel like, I think like maybe because I am a person with an active imagination basically, so I... that already helped me to like generate ideas on my own. So even like that's why I find it also hard to really engage with generative AI, I guess.

Interviewer: Yeah. Now more into the formal and informal rules. Are there, or were there, any like policies in your organization regarding the use of AI? And were they clear or more absent, and how did you navigate that?

Interviewee06: There was not really much of a... There was not much of a policy, as far as I know. We did have an account for ChatGPT, for example. There was like certain... like there were certain guidelines but not really like clear ones. There was a lot of people going through workshops and showing their, sharing their information and what they have gathered. For example, one common rule, generally speaking, was not from our company ourselves. With one of our bigger clients was we do not generate pictures of humans, so they didn't want any generated people; they wanted actual people. I am not actually clear what the reason was. That was just something that was like told to me.

Interviewer: Yeah interesting. And do you have any personal rules or guidelines when you work with AI or when you have to work with AI?

Interviewee06: So I, when it comes to, for example, like I said, the most common tool that I've been ever using was voice-over, and I was just generally trying to always think like, okay, what is the content of the video, what type of voice do I imagine matches, and also considering like if I'm going to be using it, if I'm using a video that's specifically... For example, we had a video where an Italian accent was needed basically, and I was trying to think of myself like okay, but how do I have this voice-over speaking an Italian accent without sounding like a stereotype or some comedic effect when the video is just an informative video. So that's for example, and that was also making me like think, like, okay, how do I even approach this? Like, how do I even find a tool that has an Italian accent? Basically.

Interviewer: That's very specific.

Interviewee06: Yes exactly.

Interviewer: Yeah, and do you, because it also like seems like you have some certain like boundaries when you're using AI, do you discuss with

your colleagues, or did you just discuss that with your colleagues or clients, too?

Interviewee06: I have called, I have already spoken a few times with my Co-Workers about it, and like my concerns about using generative AI and I was sharing my opinion, for example, that if we were to use it, we should be more transparent about that we have used AI. And I got the info inspiration because I was once in the train and there was a on an advertisement on screen where there was a label in the corner of the pic of the video saying generative AI, so informing people that what we're seeing right now is being generated and there's not actual live footage and I felt like that was like I was in the I was of the opinion that we should be also applying these standards of saying when we're using AI and just label it as such but this has never really come true. But in my opinion, like trying to avoid saying that something is generated by AI is deceptive. And I know that there is no strict policy about it, but I think we should be still, I don't see why we should still not do it either way.

Interviewer: So, is it more at work, is it also uncomfortable to talk about it? Also, from your colleagues, I don't know, or is it more like an open secret, and nobody actually vocalizes it?

Interviewee06: I think there's more a discomfort with it. I remember one Co-Worker explaining how one of his that AI generated graphics was posted on LinkedIn, for example, and LinkedIn had seemingly a filter that was able to identify that it was an AI and had labeled it as such, so it was not something that he did but was generated by the website itself. And instead of saying like okay here's this tool, you should be understanding that this is going to happen, his suggestion was basically how do you circumvent it. So I was thinking to myself like why do we need to deceive people with this. That's the question that I asked myself.

Interviewer: Yeah, that's true, like in response to that, have your own practices changed over time also regarding this?

Interviewee06: Yeah, I was very strict to myself with avoiding using generative AI basically. And I was, when it came to work, and there were occasional internal workshops where we were like discussing either the new tools or, how to generate for other clients who are okay with faces and humans being generated by AI, how do you produce images that did not look like Stock or like high fashion models and fitting like conventional stars of beauty. I simply did not participate in these workshops at all because it was voluntarily so I just opted out, to be honest.

Interviewer: Yeah, understandable. Actually, this opting out of using an AI tool is also a question that I wanted to get into. I mean, you have now mentioned it already that you opted out of using it. Is there in general, like, what are some other reasons why you opt out? Maybe I don't know training data?

Interviewee06: Yeah, one of my main concerns is definitely the training data. That's like... so much of the content is being that's this that the AI is trained on is on copyrighted material people's work being taken out of without consent, and it's also concerning me the environmental impact of AI, especially because I have been keeping up with understanding how much war rights being consuming, how AI data centers are being built in America, in rural countries that is basically destroying the environment for people living there. And I am in the opinion [that] it is absolutely [not] worth it, this is not worth it if people in the long run are going to be suffering from it.

Interviewer: Yeah, now the copyright question also comes up because, yeah, this has been a major issue, especially in creative domains. How would you determine if, for example, you, or in general, also if you want to give your opinion on that, how do you determine if someone has still enough personal ownership over a piece of work after they have used AI?

Interviewee06: I don't feel like you have much personal ownership because like you can, you can give the commands, but then in the end, the results is not entirely yours, in my opinion. Like it's still like a computer basically calculating based on what it's been received as information and then using the stolen data from it, but it doesn't have like, I don't think there's much thought process besides like A equals B basically. And I feel like that's a very simplified way of understanding creativity and work, and it's... I don't think there's something that you can like methodically, mathematically, logically, like create out of it, you know?

Interviewer: Yeah, I understand. So, also, have you felt like using AI kind of makes your craft, makes you separate from your craft, or like your skills are degrading, or seem to be degrading in general?

Interviewee06: Yes, I would say so, because it's... I feel like it's very simplified idea of it, it simplifies the idea of what you do, and it's... AIs like understands art as the result instead of the process behind it. And that's also one thing that concerns me. Basically, we underestimate how much thought is put into what artists create. For example, when it comes to AI-generated images, like if it's supposed to recreate a painting or so on, we do

not understand, like we fail to understand the craft that came behind creating this painting. Even how do you think of the colors, how do you think of your composition, and those are things that just not, they're not innate in people as a craft that you basically develop over time. And I feel like many people are trying to like skip over the whole hard work that comes into creating work just to get a nice result, basically. And I feel like people are also hesitant because they fear being bad at something. I think so, although being bad at something when you're starting out is basically part half of the progress of learn of creating, you know?

Interviewer: Yeah, yeah. That's... it's interesting. I read a Substack article about what you said about that, where it's, it said people don't know how to be a beginner anymore.

Interviewee06: Yeah, that's pretty much it. I think I really think that people are afraid of being beginners, and I, on one hand, understand it, but on the other hand, like I personally like, sometimes, I just acknowledge that sometimes some things just aren't for me or very difficult for me. So maybe not entirely like something that I would continue pursuing, for example, like playing piano. I tried it, it was not really difficult, and I also decided, maybe it's not, maybe it's not for me. But I, then I tried playing bass and realized this is an instrument that is really fun even though it's difficult, and I still keep on doing it basically. And I accept that I am not very good at it, but the enjoyment and the learning process is for me a very important part.

Interviewer: Yeah, oh, that's beautiful. And I wish that everybody would think like that. Because you also mentioned that you like enjoy drawing, you enjoy what you're doing, do you feel like gen AI that you're kind of forced to use it, or that the impact kind of also affects your job security in a sense?

Interviewee06: Yes, as I've been working like I said, like I'm generally speaking very hesitant to be using hey, I try and avoid as much as possible, but as I start applying to different places, I really see quite often how they actually would like say encourage people, either say like knowing how to use different AI tools or openness to using different AI tools. That's quite a common requirement written, and I just always like I'm always hesitant, then, to apply there because I'm thinking to myself, to what extent is this going to hinder me, if I say I do not want to use these tools or is it something that's just entirely optional that they just see as a bonus or something.

Interviewer: Yeah, yeah, I've also like read that some people say their job kind of the design part, like you know, I don't know, you're a UX designer, content, service designer, that the designer basically will be replaced by being a director.

Interviewee06: Yeah yeah.

Interviewer: How do you feel about that? Do you think that's also possible, or do you think no, I could never actually replace the art that I am able to create?

Interviewee06: I feel like this is the attitude that the big companies are going towards to, but it's not a good idea, to be honest. Like this, I feel like, first of all is, I think that a lot of AI-generated images as the more they become online, the more the tool will start speeding off its own creations, and it's becoming like, the quality is lessening, and I have a concern that this is not something that people say, like, okay, we need to bring back the human part of creating designs and stuff like that, but that they simply do not care because it's cheaper basically. And that's like a concern that I have. And I think that, eventually, I see a possibility that people, the general population gets tired of seeing these things, and then the only way to circumvent it is to bring back the human part of creation. But I worry that companies still think in this very hard way, but this is cheaper for us, so let's just do the cheaper way and let's just sacrifice the quality for it.

INTERVIEW 07

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Interviewer: Okay, alright. before we dive into the questions have you read the informed consent detailing that the information you provide as well as any company details will be completely anonymized participation is voluntary you can withdraw and stop the interview at any time without any explanation the interview will be recorded transcribed and used only for academic purposes and your identity will remain confidential do you consent to that the recording and the transcription.

Interviewee07: Yes, I do. I filled in the Google Form that you sent over.

Interviewer: That's perfect. alright. So, just as a quick starter, can you briefly describe your role and the kind of creative work that you do?

Interviewee07: Yeah, so my title is creative designer, and I work within a, it's an agency, and it does a lot of things. It's formally referred to as a fully integrated agency. So we have a media section, a creative team, and, you know, business and strategy, sort of small, you know, about 20 people or so. And I work on the creative team with a few copywriters, art director, a creative director. And so my sort of day-to-day job is a bit of a mixture of it's mostly design, but also a bit of concept creation, ideation, things like this for a large variety of projects. But yeah, in short, that's what it is.

Interviewer: Okay, that's interesting. What are your, like, daily tools and technologies that you use? Also, given that I'm gonna, like, this interview is about AI, maybe tools that also have an AI feature or something?

Interviewee07: Yeah, so what's really interesting about me doing this interview is that our agency is, and I think it's happening everywhere in the creative industry, but our agency is one of those that is trying to utilize AI within the creative processes that we're doing. So we have a company, what do you call it, like, a company OpenOS, basically, that takes all of the different major AI platforms and uses that to... well, yeah, like, we use it mostly for image generation on the creative team. So, but, yeah, there's, you can create, like, agents to speak with, you know, like, do chats, there's different ways of organizing workflows, like, there's so many different elements. I don't know if you want me to go through all of them, but you understand the gist of it. It's just a company-wide OpenOS that we use internally, I suppose.

Interviewer: Okay, okay, yeah, I will probably ask you about that later. But to be a little more specific now about how you use it for a task. Can you

maybe walk me through a recent situation where you used AI in your work or even, like, deliberately avoided using it?

Interviewee07: Yeah, okay. So first, where I did use it? I, we use it, or I use it, mostly when it comes to selling, like a picture, a concept, so, you know, where it's the stage of we're not really producing anything ourselves so far. But very often when speaking to clients, you know, they need to see physical proof of things, but for us to, like, if we don't, if we, for example, wouldn't have AI, we would have to do all of that from scratch, [which] would be incredibly time-consuming and energy-consuming. So, for example, for this pitch we had to sell it was for, like, some kind of content creation campaign, so we made mock-ups, like, social media mock-ups, different, like, banners, ads, things like that, where we generated images to put in these mock-ups as, you know, placeholders. I mean, you can do the same thing searching up images online, but it was a very specific kind of idea that required, you know, certain angles or certain elements in the images themselves, and it looks cleaner to do so when it's exactly the picture that you want it to be. And yeah, and it went a lot quicker, let's say, than, you know, retrieving images online or having to edit a bunch of things, you know. But then, when it comes to, like... It's hard to say that we deliberately avoid using it, at least in the work that I do now. But I can say before I was in this agency and before, the job before that, then I was working as, like, a freelancer and very often I made sort of a conscious decision to avoid using it for, like, the actual deliverable itself because I've noticed, I mean, for a number of reasons it's not as amazing quality. There's less controlled variables, let's say, depending on the work that you do. And also, I was working with projects that I personally cared about as well, you know. If you are doing an Ad for, or you're doing, like, a project for an NGO that is talking about social and cultural issues or because I were, I used to work in journalism as well, like, I'm not going to image-generate a random person and be, like, oh yes this is a perfect representation of this issue that we're doing and it's not even a real person. I have an issue with that. So I would never do that personally, and I think also just in the general output of things, right? I think something is made entirely with AI, there is an element of, you know, this doesn't really feel as good to put out in the world, let's say, but maybe that's, yeah, maybe that's just ego talking, I don't know, but yeah.

Interviewer: I will get back to that definitely, but how do you decide then which tasks are appropriate to delegate to gen AI and which are not?

Interviewee07: In my current job, it's a discussion. I think it also depends on, you know, when you're making Ads or campaigns and selling

those, you know, we often talk about image rights and things like this. I think AI is, I've seen it's kind of a way of getting around having to find, you know, like, stock images for things, or it never replaces, like, full-blown professional photography or anything like this. But when it comes to, you know, small graphical elements and whatever, then yeah, sure, why not. But it's a bit difficult to give a very direct answer to this question because it's always a discussion. I think [it] depends on more; it's never just black and white, it's never, like, okay, for this we're gonna do that, for this we're gonna do that. I think it depends on the scope of the project and what exactly it is that we want to achieve. And if we, okay, we want to achieve this incredibly specific thing or represent this in this way, like it's a bit political as well in some cases, then we will determine, okay, we can do this part with AI, we can do this part without AI, yeah.

Interviewer: Yeah, okay, yeah, understandable. Would you say there are tasks that you would never use an AI for? Also, if so, why?

Interviewee07: I have certain tasks in mind, but I'm also a bit hesitant to say never because never say never, I guess. But when it comes to, like, the very beginning, I think of the ideation process, you know, you can speak to a ChatBot, and depending on which one you speak to, it can just reaffirm really dumb things or infer from a random, like, set of data, you know. It's in that sense a bit unoriginal, and I think when it comes to thinking about creative concepts and thinking about how to approach things, I find that we end up being more successful when we come up with those ideas ourselves versus, like, you know, delegating that to whatever you want to call it, an algorithm, I guess.

Interviewer: That's true, that's true. Would you also say that there are tasks that are too complex for AI?

Interviewee07: Maybe. I haven't tried giving that complex of a task to AI yet, actually, so far, no. But, you know, especially when it comes to image or video generation, I think trying to evoke, like, specific emotions is really difficult for it to comprehend. Like, you need to be so literal, and when you're trying to, like... You know, I noticed this in, like, when I converse with the art director and our agency, because he's very often attending these, like, productions like video productions, and stuff, and sometimes he needs to kind of help the director. And in terms of, like, okay, this is the feeling that we want, and this is, you know, there're very abstract descriptions of things. And if you put that abstract description in an AI, it's not going to understand what you mean at all. So I think when it comes to those things, like, it

requires a much more technical approach, and AI is incredibly bad at that so far.

Interviewer: Yeah, that actually touches very much my next question because that would be how do you ensure that the result, the AI-assisted result, that you deliver still aligns, like, with the voice that your client or that your project needs?

Interviewee07: Yeah, but, well, that's the thing, like, if it doesn't, like, in some cases it just doesn't, and when it doesn't, I at least don't force it to do so. Like, you know, there's only so much that you can [do]. How do you say, like, beat a dead horse kind of, so I think after a few tries, you're, like, alright, listen, I think that we can just do this better ourselves. And then we do it better ourselves, whether or not that means that it's going to be more costly. But usually it pays off, right?

Interviewer: Yeah, and so maybe also in this, like, control the AI output area; once the AI generates an output, do you have a personal, like, filter process for verifying it before you consider it ready? Or how do you review or verify it before you use it?

Interviewee07: Yeah, this is at least in the work that we do, I think this is also a very untechnical, like, decision-making process that we have because we also, because right now I'm working within, like, mostly advertising, and I have gotten to know, like, advertising is actually quite subjective, and so it's really just sort of about your personal aesthetic taste, I think in the end of the day. So if we generate something and we look at it and then, you know, I'll just, like, look at the art director and I'm, like, this looks bad, like, we can't use this, like, come on, like, maybe if you just pass it by, really quickly in the street, but you'll notice, you know, so many things that are wrong with it. So I think it's really, it's about personal preference in that sense, at least when it comes to the things that we're outputting right? But I do remember because I was working a little bit more in, like, internal communications and research before, and there, I think we used it in such a different way. So it was a little bit more data-based, I suppose, but that's a whole other process. But now for sure it's just aesthetics, like, okay, this is like shit we can't use this, you know?

Interviewer: So would you say that, let's say, when the AI provides a, like, flawed result or, I don't know, it feels corny or mediocre or whatever, that the way you adjust your workflow is at some point, oh, I'm just gonna do it manually in your team? Or is it more, like, how do you adjust your workflow afterwards?

Interviewee07: Yeah, that's a good question. I'm trying to think of a specific time that we had to do this because I haven't been working in this job that I have now for that long. It's only been, like, a few months, and I think in any case it's... Like, we will try to ... Okay, yeah, okay, so I was working on these Ads for this music festival, and they wanted to.. It was, like, a collaboration with two companies, it's so confusing, and they were, like, okay, we want to make, like, some kind of campaign for this. Like, it's so vague they didn't give us a particularly specific brief, and you can kind of do whatever you want to do, and we're, like, okay, so we can do, like, stuff for, you know, social media, like, TikToks or, then we can also do, like, outdoor billboards and stuff. And I'm, like, okay great, so what we need for this is some kind of, like, engaging image for the background and then, you know, put text on it, whatever. And when I started looking for the images, they sent a, like, a bank of images [of] the festival itself. And when I was looking at the images, I was, like, these are not... the people in these images look like they're having a really bad time. Like, no one's looking like they're having fun. So I was like, maybe I can generate images that are a little bit more, you know, engaging. So I actually used the images that they gave us as a reference to input into the AI and be, like, hey, can you give me a similar look and feel but change this and this and this. And I kept coming up short. I was, like, this is not any better. And at some point, I think especially when we're working in an agency environment, and you need to, like, meet certain deadlines, we're not going to spend eternity on this. So if it's taking too long, I'm, like, okay, instead of generating completely new images, let me just do my thing. I'll go in and edit them in a more engaging way and find other graphical solutions, you know, and figure it out. And that worked out better because then we're, like, okay, we, like, the way that this looks, and it sort of maintains the material that they have sent us already. So I think it's, maybe it's just about time, I don't know, as well, you know.

Interviewer: Yeah, it seems like it. Like, would you then say that AI is mainly a time efficiency tool for you? Or, but also, if it needs a lot of correction and rewriting, is it really time-saving?

Interviewee07: Yeah, that's exactly, I mean at least in this case that was what I was referring to I guess that's I mean that's how people understand AI. It's, like, wow, it's so efficient in terms of saving time and saving money, but it's not always, unfortunately, or at least not at this point in time. So for sure, especially when you're working in an environment where you need to, you're kind of, like, driven to make profit in some sense or another, but

maybe it would be different if I were doing a project, like, Pro Vono, you know.

Interviewer: Yeah, that's true. And since you're working in a team, who do you feel is responsible for the final outcome when AI is involved? Is it you? Is it your team as a whole? Is it your manager, or is it the whole company?

Interviewee07: I mean, my personal view on this is everybody. I, you know, because we all contribute to the final product, and we're all playing our part within those things, I think, you know, I see what is being produced is then being passed on to, you know, the art director or an animator or, you know, whoever else does the next step. And they, I mean, it's not their job to be, like, oh okay, where, what do, which, like, image generation thing did you use for this? Like, is this, like, ethically correct? Like, I think that is kind of up to everyone's, like, individual responsibility, I suppose. Or that's how I feel. And I noticed that in seeing it with other people's work as well, you know. If we see, like, a copywriter talking with, like, a chatbot, you know, we'll joke about, like, okay, well, those are words, like, you should use your own words. It's everyone's own prerogative to kind of understand their boundaries in that sense. But I think what is the most important going forward with it is to fully disclose that as well. So, you know, someone's like, oh where did you get this image? I was, like, well, it's AI-generated for sure, so then we know.

Interviewer: Yeah, great, this disclosing and talking about use of AI is also kind of in the area of my next part. But before we go into that more generally, are there any formal rules or policies in your organization regarding AI use? And are they clear or communicated clearly?

Interviewee07: Yeah. You know, we've had… when I joined, we had, like, a whole, like, AI Workshop day, like, generally the attitude towards AI use, like, it's very, oh, we want to be progressive, we want to be part of the next wave of creatively creating things, I don't know. It's what everybody's doing now. But at the same time, I think it's not really, I think because everyone, at least in my team, we know how these tools work, and therefore we understand what they're capable of, so it's not something that we're using for absolutely everything, I guess. And so to us it's really clear in terms of how to go about it, like, within the creative team, I mean. But, and we don't really take it too, like, serious, like, we're not going to be, like, okay, we have to use AI in this project, we'll do it when it matters, and when it doesn't matter, but the general communication of AI, it's vague. I mean, you know, maybe in our agency less, like, it's a little more clear because they seem a

little more affiliated with the tool. But I do remember when I was working in, like, a much bigger company, then they were doing all these seminars on AI, and I'm, like, what are they even talking about? Like, they don't know what they're talking about. We're inferring, like, a specific reason to use this tool based on nothing because it's still new, you know. And I think that's a very naive way to go about things, so, yeah. I think we're quite aware of that, I suppose.

Interviewer: Yeah. And so, I mean, you kind of imply that you do follow, like, maybe personal, or in your team, rules, unwritten guidelines. Can you, like, maybe tell me what these are? Like, how do you decide, like, the unwritten rules, how do you decide that this AI tool is now safe to use for this project?

Interviewee07: Safe to use or, like, we want to use it now. But I think in terms of the tools that we can use, like those are a bit limited because we have the company OS. Like, for example, recently we... The art director, he used to use, like, Mid-Journey a lot because he really liked the way that you could, like, input a lot of reference images and get very specific aesthetic outcomes. Because that's important to him. But then recently they came out with a statement being, like, we're not allowed to use Mid-Journey anymore, and he's, like, very upset about it. Like, I love Mid-Journey, and that's important for his work to be able to make those reference images that are incredibly accurate. It makes his job a lot easier, and I notice it sometimes as well, like, when we do, like, the image-generation and stuff, like, that there are certain tools, I don't remember the full list because there's so many different ones that we can use, in terms of image generation. And then I actually don't know which one is used for, like, the ChatBots and stuff, like, that. But in that sense, like, I think the, what did we call it, like, restrictions or obstructions, like, they're sort of already in place, and use everything that is available to us. I don't know if there's any, like, specific internal restrictions that we set on ourselves. I think everyone has a preference for which, like, algorithm they prefer, you know. Especially when it comes to image-generation, we prefer the ones that are a bit more realistic, you know, for most campaigns. I'm not sure if that's, if I can give a more specific answer, but...

Interviewer: That's already, that answers already the question. Also, like, given that AI makes, like, rapid advancements in a short time, have your practices changed over time, like, your habits or how you use it?

Interviewee07: Yeah, yes. I think for me personally, I used to spend most of my time, like, whenever I got a project, most of the time for that

project is thinking about how to approach the project and, like, actually then getting to the execution process. And the execution process itself was quicker, let's say, versus now I feel like, you know, something that I might do is, like, I think very sporadically sometimes when it comes to coming up with some kind of concept. But in the beginning, it makes no sense, so you're writing random things down, you're kind of trying things, you're okay, this is not going to work like logistically, creatively, or aesthetically. However, there's a lot of trial and error, and I think when, now when I have these sporadic thoughts, sometimes not every time, but sometimes when it feels particularly chaotic, and we have a very limited amount of time, I will, like, I've made like agents. So it's kind of, like, okay, we're gonna speak to this, like, AI agent of, like, okay, I have this idea that kind of follows this logic, and I have a vague idea of the structure of it but maybe you can give me a better sense of, like, how, like, reasonable it is, like, kind of add a little bit of what's the word I'm looking for, like, reality to it, I suppose. And it's almost like having a conversation with an entire, like, production team in a sense. And I think when you're working in an environment where you need to, like, actually sell those ideas, that's incredibly valuable because then you already have, like, okay, I have this idea, it's my idea, the creativity behind it, but here is how we can make the idea in a very, like, reasonable and efficient way, which is something naturally that I'm very bad at. Because, you know, I'll have the idea, and I'm, like, oh, it's going to be so cool, and then I present it, and they're, like, this is insane, like, we can't do this. So, I think that time is reduced, you know, things [are] a lot easier in that sense.

Interviewer: Yeah, interesting. So before you mentioned that sometimes you avoid also using AI personally, you know, that, like, "doesn't feel so good". Can you, like, maybe go more into that? Because I'm interested in, like, how you decide to opt out and for what reasons?

Interviewee07: I think first and foremost, it's fun to do things myself. Like, I was working on this, like, side project with some friends, and they, you know, they have their own little startup. It's, like, a side project for everybody, and they're, like, okay, we want you to, if you want, like just for fun, come in, help us a little bit with the branding. You can do whatever you want to; we're not going to give you any, like, restrictions. But obviously, like, you know, we're all doing this on the side, so don't expect, like, a million-dollar budget. And I was, like, okay, cool, yeah. At no point did I use any AI in any of the processes there because I think that, like, to me, fun does not translate to oh, let's just get this done as quickly as possible. I think the part that I enjoy about it is, like, the thinking and the conversing.

And, okay, maybe we'll have an inefficient meeting or two. But I'm really, really happy to do that, you know. So it's almost like two different kinds of personalities that get adopted by those kinds of projects. So fun and also, you know, I used to do a lot of work for, like, non-profits, non-government organizations. Things like this I didn't, I just, like, didn't... Maybe it's not something I consciously thought about, but I just didn't think that it was, like, the time or the place to do it. It was so not necessary, you know, the kind of work that we were doing there, like, didn't require AI because it's supposed to come from people. Like, you know, people, the mind, the heart, like, everything. So in that sense, it just didn't make sense in that context. I think, and that relates to the fun part as well, but maybe that's... I have a not a negative association with AI, but it feels like, oh, sometimes it feels a little bit, like, heartless, you know. like, devoid of, like, fun, like, the whole reason I do what I do is because I get to do it, you know?

Interviewer: Yeah. That also hints at the last part. But before that, I also want to... I mean, you already said that you have a lot of discussions with your colleagues about AI, but have there also been situations where it was, like, more unclear or uncomfortable to talk about AI use?

Interviewee07: Uncomfortable? Not necessarily, I think. I've met some people who are very adamantly against it, which I do understand the reasoning, right? And normally, those people are working within fields that are, like, a little bit more, like, they think hard about the ethics and the morality of it. So I completely understand where it's coming from. I am not, I don't think that I've ever had a conversation where we can't, like, discuss things. I do think there's sometimes, like at work, we'll be very aware of, like, okay, like, we know that the thing that this is producing is, like, not particularly good, but we're kind of running out of time, so we need to just roll with it, and then we'll try to make the best of it. But that's not, that is really, like, it's very depersonalized because it's, like, okay, sure, you've prompted it, and you've, like, that's, the result is the image, let's say that you've made. But it's not really yours, so I don't feel like it has a particularly personal component to it, you know. Like, you feel very detached from the end product.

Interviewer: Yeah. Okay, great, because you said it's not really yours, so how do you determine if you still have enough ownership over a piece of work when you use AI?

Interviewee07: That's a good question. I actually, you know, I actually don't know how much AI has to do with it because I think now that I've worked internally or in-house in a couple of places

Interviewer: where, you know, in one case, you know, it was written in my contract that everything that you produce and you make is not yours essentially. And I think when you have a clause like that in your contract already, at least for me, I make the mental disassociation of, I am not going to cry if, like, if they do something that I don't like with the things that I produce. Like, I think that's a very hard boundary that I already set. And so I think that's where that statement comes from. I'm not really sure if it's as related to AI. I think it maybe enhances the detachment a little bit. But yeah. I don't, like, there are some parts of me that cringe a little bit if we use, like, an ugly photo, okay, in a project. But because I know that I did not take that image then, I'm not, maybe I'm not as upset about it, I suppose. But yeah, mostly, I think mostly the first thing, probably.

Interviewee07: Yeah, yeah, interesting. And have you felt that using AI for a specific task made you, I mean, okay, you already said basically that you feel detached, but do you also feel, like, your skills were degrading in that sense?

Interviewer: I don't know if I know how to answer this, actually, as in, like, using an AI tool is essentially, like, made me progress, like, more separate from your actual craft, because you also said you, for personal projects or passion projects, let's say, you don't really use it?

Interviewee07: Absolutely. And I have a lot of opinions about this. I think... I mean, at least when it comes to, like, image generation and stuff. So I started as a photographer in the very beginning of my career. Not, I didn't even study it or anything, I just thought it was fun, and I stepped away from that, like, already a while ago. And I think back to that sometimes because I still know a lot of photographers and we talk about this a lot. I'm, like, okay, well, you could technically input images as reference images and get, you know, a model to pose in different ways with this product. So how do you feel, like, how do you feel about the security of your work, you know? But I still, I think that it's only going to feel like it degrades your... how do I phrase it? Like, degrades your skills, I guess, if you let it, you know? It's sort of the same logic as, you know, a student in university, and they're letting AI write all of their essays. Like, you made the conscious decision to have the AI write your essays. Like, you're doing this to yourself, I think, in that sense. Like, you are still the perpetrator of that. So, and maybe that's how I balance things, is, like, in the personal projects or in the projects that I don't have, like, a time limit or economic restraints, then I do everything that I can to, like, try different things and keep, you know, my hands busy. Like, I'll try to use as little screens as possible. I don't know if that's really,

like, an anti-AI thing. I think that's just a me thing. But, you know, you can use it for your study if you'd like.

Interviewer: It is still relevant also because it kind of touches this, like, also a trusting and quality issue of AI. Because, you know, like, some people have also mentioned that some consumers, let's say, don't see the difference, and some really do. So yeah, sometimes it's also, like, a

Interviewee07: question of acknowledgement, I guess, of skills. That was basically the last question. But I always ask, is there anything that I haven't asked you that you would still, like, to mention because you find it important, also given the purpose of the study?

Interviewer: It's hard to, like, think of something particularly now. But, you know, things are always evolving, I think. I had this, I mean, it's very specific, I think, to the field that I work in, but we often have these discussions, and they're mostly, like, moral discussions of creativity and AI and, you know, where does the balance lie; does the presence of one take away from the other? Like, what is creativity, and is AI, like, when it comes to, like, accessible, like, we were talking about this yesterday with my co-workers, they were, like, something that is great, that they think is great, is that the presence of AI makes certain creative careers, like, almost more accessible because it's a tool in itself. And I was, like, okay, that's a very interesting thing to think about. And in almost, in a way, I sort of understand, like, okay, let's say you can't afford to have a camera, like you can't afford to, like, buy a camera, okay, you can do an image generation thing online and essentially create, like, an entire campaign. Or, hey, [if] you want to become a designer, you need a few assets that you can't, like, find on your own, like, fine sure, but people, and maybe it's a bit naïve, but people have been finding ways around this already. So I'm still a little bit undecided in that, I think, in that conversation. Like, I'm still thinking about my answers to those conversations, but that's, that is the thing that I'm, a conversation that I'm having with more people. So I don't know if that's going to be relevant to you, but that could probably be an issue in further AI studies. At least within the creative industry, right?

INTERVIEW 08

02/27/2026 | 34 Minutes | Producer, Translator

Interviewer: Hello [NAME], thank you so much for doing this. Before we continue with the questions, I just want to ask you that the information you provide, as well as company details, will be completely anonymized. Also, your participation is voluntary. You can stop the interview at any time. The interview will be recorded and transcribed, only used for academic purposes, and your identity will remain confidential. Do you consent to participate in the interview and being recorded?

Interviewee08: I do, I consent.

Interviewer: Thank you. So, can you briefly describe your role and the kind of creative work that you do?

Interviewee08: Yeah, of course. So, mostly I've been working in the film industry for over a decade, and I've taken quite a range of different roles. I started with producing a film festival. I've done it for six years, then I moved into various production positions. I've done film, television, advertisement, and for the past 10 years almost, I've been also doing script translation and consulting jobs on scripts as well, between Georgian and English languages. And yeah, so basically I'm still in the film industry, and I'm also doing translation of scripts, but not only. I also do plays and books, and yeah, so that's my main creative work as of now.

Interviewer: And what kind of tools or technologies are central to your daily work?

Interviewee08: So because my work revolves around screenwriting, most of the time I use the programs like Caltex, Final Draft, Writer's Duet, also Canva, and different tools for creating projects. And those platforms help me both in the creative and logistical or technical part of the job that I do most of the time. So mostly it's just programs for screenwriting and tools for screenwriting, but I also use Canva for presentations, and yeah, that's it.

Interviewer: Maybe can you walk me through a recent situation where you used or maybe deliberately avoided using generative AI or AI in general?

Interviewee08: Right, so mostly I've been using ChatGPT, like most of my colleagues. I do pay for it, so I do use premium services of ChatGPT. I don't avoid it because the way I use ChatGPT is like an assistant, more of a tool that will help me with proofreading. If I'm doing a translation for editing purposes, maybe it will help me rephrase some sort of like phrases in English if I'm doing a translation from Georgian into English, but I do not

use it vice versa. So I never use, I've tried it, but it doesn't work using, if I'm trying to translate from English into Georgian. Unfortunately, no generative AI can do this right now, no language model can do it right now, so I do not use it for my work. I do it myself, so only I'm using ChatGPT only if I need to set up an easy task. So for translation, I do use it as a proofreading, but if I'm doing a project like I did this summer, and it's a film project, and I'm working as a production manager or a producer, I will use also ChatGPT and other, like Caltex also has AI assistance. So if we count that as well, yes, I use AI tools because they are in inside of the programs that I use to set up a project for a quick outline to help me, you know, cross over this kind of first barrier that you might have with a new task or a job, but it's mostly assistance. I don't use it to create content, I don't use it to create something, produce something original or personal or creative, so I use it as an assistant tool most of the time, and I use ChatGPT most of the time.

Interviewer: Okay, how do you decide maybe which tasks are appropriate to delegate to GenAI and which are not? As you kind of mentioned, maybe elaborate on that.

Interviewee08: Right, so basically I use AI to help me with certain tasks, but I never use it to create an original body of text or any creative input or output, so I only use it as an assistant. If I had an editor, for instance, I would not use ChatGPT. If I, you know, if I had different types of people around me, because I'm a freelancer, so I work on certain projects with other people, but I mostly, for translations or for co-creating a script, I work with one person or I work alone, so I mostly only use it, like I said, as a proofreader, as a, I only delegate the type of tasks that I myself can authorize later on, so I will be the editor of the ChatGPT, for instance, or, you know, like I will be the final voice and final authority on a task that I delegated, but whatever task it is, it's my name on it, so I'm just gonna, you know, final authority is gonna be on me, so it's not gonna be a delegation without me approving it at the very last minute.

Interviewer: Okay, maybe once you use, once you have an output from a AI, what is like your personal filter process for verifying it before you consider it like it's ready to be used later on, and what is your process to review it?

Interviewee08: Right, so I did have, when I'm doing my research, for instance, I'm doing a research for my film or I'm doing a research for my master's or stuff like that, for research purposes, if AI is citing some sort of article or information, I have to check it and recheck it if it actually exists, so I will go through academic databases, I will go through internet, I will do

my research, and I only approve the information that ChatGPT or any type of generative AI has given me if I can actually find it, if it actually exists, so I will not just trust it, so to speak, and I will just, I will have to find or cite it, if it cites something, I will have to find that it actually exists, that information, so it will go through my proofreading as well or whatever, I will have to determine it myself if it exists, the information that the ChatGPT or any other generative AI has given me in the response.

Interviewer: Great, how do you ensure that AI-assisted results you deliver still align with a specific value or like voice of your client and whatever you're doing?

Interviewee08: Right, so my client's voices and values, if I understand them, I will not be delegating a creative work of a voice or whatever of my client to Tejaviti, right, so I might use AI for like to outline tasks or draft presentations or proofread my body of texts, but I will always be, like I already said, I will always be doing the primary content or creative content, so the final style or the final tone or a voice is going to be mine, my professional voice, but I will use AI for assistance.

Interviewer: Maybe can you give like if it's possible and can be cite an example?

Interviewee08: Right, so for instance, like I mentioned already, this summer we did a film project with an Australian director who wanted an American style of production and because we're Georgians and the whole cast and production crew was Georgian, we had to quickly come up, because time is money, so we had like a week or something to come up with the outline of a production, right, the mood boards of the film, with the agenda, with the schedules and stuff like that, so what I did is that I, like I mentioned already, the program Celtics, the Celtics program has this sort of AI assistance where it helps you create the basic outlines of all of it, so be it mood boards, be it schedules and stuff like that, so we did use it, but we did tell the client that we were doing it, because we could not hire a professional from the, let's say American background, who would be with us on the crew, who would do it themselves or, you know, create it themselves, so we already took the existing, not existing, but we created with our own information and content and whatever the film needed, the mood board and drawings and stuff like that, we created with the AI assistance of the program that, you know, helps you do it quickly and it is the sample version of it and then we, ourselves with the client, who was the director, we made changes according to whatever the client wished for it to be changed, but we did use AI to help with creating the outlines, the agendas, the schedules

and everything that needed to, anything that had to be done for the production to start, so there was a pre-production, we used AI and the client knew, of course.

Interviewer: How is, like, attitudes towards AI in your industry? Sometimes people, like, oh this is so bad, nobody should touch it, you mentioned that your client knew about AI, sometimes nowadays in many industries it's, like, very AI driven and people are encouraged even to use AI, so in your, with your colleagues or clients?

Interviewee08: Yeah, so basically the, anything that has to do with the creative part of the job has to be done by a human and not by a technology, so when it comes to scripts, right, be it translation or be it creating a script, right, I told you that the director was from Australian and wanted American type of, it was English-based text, but we needed to translate it into Georgian and then Georgian crew needed to translate a lot of it into English and we did not use AI in creating the words, the body of text, we did not use, we don't use AI to help us with the the, tell us the locations and stuff like that, we don't use AI for creative work, but we do use AI in film industry, so to speak, for technical purposes because, for logistical purposes, and it helps us minimize the budget because unfortunately we don't need 10 people, we can hire three people that will, you know, be responsible for 10 people's jobs, for instance, like logistical and technical, like the budget, right, we did it in Excel, but now you can actually use AI assistance in Excel that will formulate everything that you needed to do, it will create the files for you and it will be easy. Yes, you need a person who's responsible for those AI, you know, formulas and stuff like that, and even if it's Excel and stuff like that, you need a person who will check that it's all correct, the AI has not hallucinated and has not just, you know, come up with their own type of whatever number, but everything that is creative is human, everything that is technical or logistical is done with AI assistance and everybody knows about it, but unfortunately in Georgia, not unfortunately maybe, but some people choose to hide the fact that they're using GPT. Fortunately, GPT or AI is not that eloquent that you do not see the patterns, so you can always understand that if somebody gives you a body of text, creative work, that's only what I'm talking about right now, the creative work, you can actually see that it is very primitive or simple or even if it's translation or even if it's a script or even whatever it is, you can actually see that it was tempered with by AI, so most of the time people try to avoid seeking out professionals like translators or script writers, but it always shows, so if we're talking about quality production, then you will know, you will have people that will, you

know, filter that type of hidden agendas of using AI without, you know, it being known, but yes, so it is a little bit looked down upon, looked down, like if you use AI and do not disclose it, you do not get to be in the, you do not get to be in the industry for long, like you have to disclose it, either you have to disclose it or ask for help or something, because otherwise you're just going to be known for a person that just, you know, cannot write themselves or do creative work, so I don't know, I think I'm mumbling now, but yeah, basically anything creative, human, anything logistical, technical, we use help of AI.

Interviewer: Oh, okay. Whenever you use AI and, like, have it in your, like, final product, who do you feel is responsible for the, like, final outcome when AI is involved?

Interviewee08: I, ultimately I am responsible for the final outcome, so if I used AI beyond simple proofreading or editing, then I will have to disclose it, like I said, so transparency is very important. Georgia, not Georgia, Tbilisi is a very small, like, very small community of people that work in this industry, so we all know each other, so the responsibility and your name is really important, so you have to be transparent about it, and I am always responsible for whatever I do, and I'm responsible for the final outcome, and my name is on that product or whatever, and so, yeah, basically I am the one responsible for transparency as well as for using whatever tools necessary.

Interviewer: I know you are more of a freelancer and don't have a, like, a formal company, but when, whenever you are working with clients and you are hired, are there any formal rules or policies in the organization that you are hired by regarding the AI use, or if policies are clear or absent, how you do you, how do you navigate that uncertainty?

Interviewee08: Yes, like you said, I am a freelancer, but if I work for an organization or corporation or publishing house, for instance, publishing houses in Tbilisi have it in their contracts that you cannot use AI, so you're not permitted even for proofreading or for anything, you are not permitted to use AI, and if they find you out, they might be released of their, you might be released of the contract, so if I work for [Book Publishing Company], for instance, I know it is in my contract that I cannot use AI, and they do have systems or programs that will go through your, you know, your translation, and if they find out that you used AI, they might not work with you again and, you know, just not work with you again, ever. So, mostly, if I work with a client that is not a publishing house or an organization, I rely on my own common sense and my own professional ethics, but if I work with

somebody, I have a contractual obligation not to use AI, I will not use any type of AI. I will do it old school and just proofread myself or ask a friend whose, you know, English language is, you know, better than mine, I guess, I don't know.

Interviewer: So, yeah. If you will have a situation, if you had a situation where you didn't have, like, a contractual obligation to use AI and maybe rules of using AI aren't clear, what written rules do you have to follow to decide what kind of work do you feed the AI or whatever guidelines you set for yourself about using AI?

Interviewee08: So, in the absence of this type of, like, formal policies or whatever, like I said, I rely on my own expertise, but I depends, honestly, it depends on a client because most of the time in Tbilisi or in Georgia, you work with people you already know, and it is easy to collaborate with, easily collaborate with people and easily be transparent about how you use the tools. Most of the time, our job, my job, is always, it always has a smaller time frame than normally, right? So, if a task needs, like, two months, somebody will ask me, be it translation or production, somebody will ask me to do it in a shorter period of time. That's when you come out with your transparency and tell them that, yes, I can do it in this time frame, but I will use AI tools. I will use it, I will proofread, not proofread, but I will have my final, you know, authority on it, but I will use it to help me, to assist me, and I will create those, be it Excels or screenplays or presentations and stuff using AI. Sometimes, AI tools are pricey, expensive. I might even ask the client in this, in whatever job that we have together, I will ask the client to pay for the AI tool, for the monthly use of it, or for the three months, or stuff like that. So, I always disclose it, and it depends on the situation, and if the client really does not want to use AI, we will not use AI at all. But otherwise, it's common sense. Honestly, it's ethics. It's just, you do not go overboard. You do not create with AI. You just, your prompts, my prompts, that's my own understanding, should be always a supportive tool for me and not the tool that will replace me and my creative work. Otherwise, you know, what's the point of me?

Interviewer: Whenever the client agrees to AI use, do they give you any kind of guidelines or, like, informal rules or something like that, that, okay, you can use AI, but don't go overboard and don't use it on this or this type of task and stuff like that? Or it's like, it's your free reign, you can do?

Interviewee08: So, there are clients that, I've had a client who did not want to put their information, so to speak, in the AI or electronic or technological database, so to speak. Like, they didn't want, they asked me to,

in the event that I used AI, not to put the content of it. So, I could use AI, like I said, to outline something, to create a schedule, but I had to be the one to then download the said layout or schedule or presentation and then put the information myself. So, I was not allowed to use the information that they've given me, be it a creative work or content or whatever, into the ChatGPT, for instance, because they do not believe it is the safety and regulations are in place for them to, you know, secure their own, whatever. So, in that case, yes, I've had a client who asked me not to use ChatGPT and use a tool like Celtics to create a schedule, for instance, and mood board, but then I had to download it into my own computer and we had to even write it, print it out and write it or draw it, draw the mood board or write the schedule by hand, write it down with pen and pencil in very old school.

Interviewer: During these situations, have there been anything where AI use felt unclear or uncomfortable to talk about during meetings at work?

Interviewee08: No, not really, because AI discussion is on everyone's minds every day. So, it's something like weather. We talk about it even before we actually delve into the specifics of a job. So, we start off with talking about how we use AI in our jobs, because in film industry, for instance, it's a very dire situation. Like, AI is replacing a lot of jobs. So, it is a topic that we are very passionate about talking and it is a topic that always comes up. And it's not uncomfortable ever. I don't see it as an uncomfortable topic. It's a very necessary subject to go through with a client because of differences of views about AI. Like I said, some people really do not want to have anything to do with any tools, even when they go on Google search, and Gemini is doing the summarizing version of a web search; they don't even want to read that. Like, there are people that just don't want anything to do with AI. So, it's not uncomfortable. It's a very needed discussion and needed topic.

Interviewer: AI has kind of been like a new topic over maybe the last five years, I guess. Have these practices changed over time? Maybe, and maybe what triggered those changes?

Interviewee08: Yes. So, I work for different types of clients, and mostly if we're doing the advertising job, we do it. So, our clients are maybe from Dubai, right? So, for the last five years, five years ago, it was completely different. And right now, it's completely different. Like the AI has, like I said, eliminated a lot of jobs, not only jobs, but locations. Like the client from Dubai would much rather hire five people instead of 20, for instance, and do the product advertisement inside the studio with AI tools. They don't need videographer and videographer's assistant, and they don't need

a lot of people to actually create a brand advertisement for social media. Five years ago, for instance, in my personal experience, clients from Dubai would come for 20 days. We would have pre-production with 40 plus people, not including the models, so to speak. And we would handpick the products, the locations, we would have people working on different tasks, like location was different, videographer was different, photographer was different. There was a lot of jobs. And right now, for the past two years, to be honest with you, the Dubai jobs that were very consistent have not been coming through to Georgia anymore. And they are doing it, and they are very clear about it, that they do not have the budget of $100,000. They have a budget of $20,000, and they would rather do it themselves on a green screen with AI tools that you can actually download in your phone and do a social media product placement easily. And you do not have to actually travel, hire this much people, production company, and create original text, because it's an advertisement for, I don't know, a bag. So yeah, it has changed over time. It has eliminated a lot of jobs, and it is very weird.

Interviewer: We can, I will move on more about another topic, like authorship and trust regarding AI. How do you determine if you have enough personal ownership over a piece of work to put your name on it after using AI?

Interviewee08: Again, my answer is not going to be that much different, right? So I use AI for personal tasks as well, for my personal projects, and for clients as well. And it is tricky only if I ask AI to create or produce something original, like original body of text or original visuals, or original anything to do with creative side of things. And if I do that, I am not doing it, obviously, or even if I was, I wouldn't tell you. But if I do that, then it's not my, my authorship is gone, right? So I avoid doing anything creative or anything original or anything that's got to do with the creative part of my job. I only use it as an assisting tool. At least I try most of the time to use AI as an assisting tool, as a proofreader, as an editor, as a, I might not use AI's suggestions, for instance, but I will see them because then I cannot fully understand how I can work through the creative block that I might have. So I will use it as a bad example, mostly than actual things. So, authorship, it's not a thin line for me between the AI and my authorship. I know where I stand with it, be it for a client or be it for myself, like there's a clear line for me.

Interviewer: Um, okay. Have you ever felt that using AI for a specific task made you feel maybe separated from your craft or like your skills were degrading?

Interviewee08: Well, yes, because I've had a very long client, so to speak, that I've been helping write screenplays and translate them into English. They told me a couple of months ago that they are using AI to create the screenplay in English, and they're not using me anymore as a consultant and English translator because it's easier to do it that way. When I asked them about the quality of the work, they were OK with it. Not because the quality of the ChatGPT work was great, but because it was easier. So I do feel like my job as a translator in the film industry is being taken a little bit by AI. I truly believe that in a couple of years, we're going to have scripts and films with the annotation that this was created with the help of AI or this was created by a human. We are already seeing it in a lot of TV shows as an ironical kind of input, but I think we're going to actually see that people will have to say whether it was created by AI or created by a human. I think that not in a couple of years, but maybe in a decade or two, the quality of the work by humans is going to go up again, and AI use will only come down to technical or assisting jobs. I hope so, at least. That's my naive outlook on all of it, that humans are going to create, and AI is going to help. But we'll see.

Interviewer: Thank you so much for your insights about this topic. I want to ask you one last question. You kind of have an idea of what we're doing and what this research is about. Is there anything I haven't asked that you think is important to mention in this area that we've been talking about?

Interviewee08: I don't think so. I think this is a very interesting topic, and I think a lot of research is going to be around AI use, authorship, and censorship related to AI technology. I think it's a very important topic. I've told you my outlook on it. I truly believe that AI is a great helping tool, but I really hope that it's going to stay as a tool and not become a primary creative force. I hope that human production of creative works is always going to be of quality and always be important, and that AI will stay as a tool, like a calculator. Let's use AI like we use a calculator for maths. It's an assistant, a helper, but that's it. Creatives should do creative work, and academics should research their work and not use AI as a primary source of information.

Interviewer: Thank you so much for the interview and taking a part in it.

Interviewee08: Thank you so much for interviewing me. It was great

INTERVIEW 09

02/25/2026 | 29 Minutes | Graphic Designer

Interviewer: Hello [NAME], thank you so much for agreeing to do this. I just need for you to confirm that the information you provide, as well as company details, will be completely anonymized. Also, your participation is voluntary; you can stop the interview at any time. The interview will be recorded and transcribed, and only used for academic purposes, and also your identity will remain confidential. Do you consent to participate in the interview and being recorded?

Interviewee09: Yes, I do

Interviewer: Okay, so let's start. Please briefly describe your role and the kind of creative work that you do

Interviewee09: Okay, so I'm a graphic designer, and I work in a PR consulting agency. So my role is close to working with PR and digital marketing, and I'm responsible for creating some printing materials, such as like banners, as well as the digital visuals. Occasionally, I also have to create some web designs, as well, but mostly I create some social media visuals. I also have to work with creating logos, brand identities, and design systems for various brands. Yeah, I also sometimes have to work with presentations, creating templates for different clients. What tools or technologies are central to your daily work? I mainly use Adobe programs, but the main tool is Illustrator as well as Photoshop for image editing, and sometimes Figma for creating web visuals. As for AI, I sometimes have to use the Freepeak or GenAI. That's what I use.

Interviewer: Can you maybe walk me through maybe a recent situation where you use Gen9 AI or other AI tools?

Interviewee09: Yes, so I recently worked with AI to create some images for this client. The task was to replace the backgrounds with various different variations, and I used AI for that to just replace some objects in the background of the image that they gave me. Yeah, I also had to edit some objects out of the images, and using AI was very helpful for that because it's sometimes that can be very time-consuming when I do it manually in Photoshop.

Interviewer: So, AI saves time for those kinds of technical works.

Interviewee09: Yes, but I only use those for the technical work and the brand design, and the client's design system was already created by myself and I fit the edited image by AI in that design system.

Interviewer: How do you decide which tasks are appropriate to delegate to GenAI for even editing, and maybe which are not?

Interviewee09: The truth is, I actually didn't want to use AI before recently, but when I learned that it can be helpful in terms of saving time when you have tight deadlines, and we have those deadlines in PR, especially, then I started, but I don't really like to use AI for creative process. I prefer to think and design the brand, the systems, and colors, and typography. Everything that has to do with the creative process, I do it by myself, and I think the tasks that are there are probably for AI are technical tasks, maybe some repetitive or mechanical tasks, just as I said, like removing some objects or replacing backgrounds, or maybe cleaning up the image. I also use it a lot for extending backgrounds and those kind of technical stuff. It's helpful to use AI for those. Yeah, if the tasks involve some brand identities or just storytelling and visual concepts, I do it all by myself. The creative stuff is all you, and some technical to speed up the process. Sometimes you use AI to help you.

Interviewer: Once AI generates an output for you, what is your personal filter for maybe verifying? Is it good for future use or not?

Interviewee09: Sometimes it depends on the task, actually. Sometimes AI can do a task perfectly, but not yet, not a lot. Before I use it in my design, I have to look closely, look to the details, because it makes some mistakes still. There may be some strange textures or some lights which are out of the image, some shadows in different directions, and also some six fingers or that kind of stuff. I really have to check for those accuracy. After that, I will find the results that AI gave me in Photoshop by hand, manually. I almost always have to check and then refine those results. Then I just see if the result fits with the client's needs and wants and with the project's overall design. Then I put it in the design and then I use it.

Interviewer: Yeah. How do you feel when AI is used for maybe even tweaking your stuff, I would say? Who do you feel is responsible for the final outcome when AI is involved?

Interviewee09: I feel like I am responsible fully because I am the designer and I personally, as I said, the way I use AI is to help me for some time-consuming tasks and some repetitive tasks. So, I consider myself fully responsible for the results of AI and the design in which I use AI. Sometimes, some people can't even tell if I use AI. They may know it, but it's not really noticeable. It shouldn't be. So, yeah, I feel like I am responsible because I decide what I am. I choose which task I need the AI to help me and I decide if I will use that result that AI gave me. So, yeah, I am.

Interviewer: Nowadays, AI has become more famous and companies push their employees to use AI compared to other times, but sometimes people hide it that they use AI or something. How do you feel whenever you presented your work or when you discuss whatever you did with your colleagues or your supervisors? What is the overall environment around it? Would you say that you used AI on this and maybe you didn't?

Interviewee09: So, AI has definitely gradually taken over, I would say, the whole creative industry, but not really. The situation in my company in which I work, it's very open. No one is encouraging to use AI. It's not a must, but I kind of have a free will. I can say that I used it. If someone asks me, it's an open topic. Sometimes I have to discuss with my colleagues, do I really need to use AI? Does this client approve me of using AI? Do they want it, or do they prefer maybe real photos and not generated ones? It's a very open topic. There are no specific rules or formal stuff in my company about it.

Interviewer: So, you have no policies about AI use or what can be fed to the AI user or anything like that?

Interviewee09: No, not really. We don't really have the documents or policies about AI, but if there is a project or a client in which we have to discuss the AI topic, we just discuss, we share. The client knows everything, my colleagues and my company knows it, and mostly that's it. I think it's about our country, maybe, maybe in other countries, AI is more involved in the creative process of companies, but not here yet. It's just starting to come in. So, yeah, we don't have the policies.

Interviewer: what about you? Maybe you have some informal rules for yourself, quote-unquote unwritten rules, maybe that you follow whenever you decide to use an AI tool and which information is maybe safe to use or not?

Interviewee09: Yes, I mostly consider if the AI tool which I am using is safe and secure to work with because most of the work is confidential and maybe we don't have the policies in the company, but every material and every result that we have and we do for our clients is confidential. We don't have a right to send or upload to the outsiders or outside. So, yeah, I consider it safe, but sometimes the client's materials may not be confidential. I'm talking about more like freelance projects, not about the company, so it may not always be the case. And, yeah, and I also consider if the quality which the tool is giving me is reliable because I don't want to lose my time trying and trying and not getting the result that I want. So, yes, as for my personal rules, I kind of consider those.

Interviewer: Perfect. Have these practices changed over time? Because AI, it's kind of new and it's been over, it's been here for a while, but like the way it got so popular, it's been like, I don't know, three, four years that it's taking over the world. And in your experience, have you seen any patterns of change?

Interviewee09: Yes, actually. I actively started using AI the last one year, I would say. So, as I said, at the beginning, when the AI started to be a big thing, it wasn't really used in the workspace or the companies. Yet, I was very skeptical because I didn't want to admit that I needed AI in any aspects of my work. It may have been my homework or the project I'm working with. I didn't want to use AI. But over time, my attitude changed because I saw that AI didn't need to be my whole work. I could use AI to help my work improve and help me work more comfortably, and have more time for myself to save some more time, especially in my industry. It's very comfortable to save time because, yeah, as I said, deadlines are tight. So, yeah, I started experimenting then. I saw different AI tools. I tried some tools there, some images. I also actually tried generating some creative brand designs. I tried to put the creative process to use AI for that. But I saw that it was not what I needed AI to use for. So, yeah, as for now, I discovered that I can use it for some technical tasks, some time-consuming tasks. And, yeah, that's how my attitude towards AI has changed over time. I think it will change in the future because it's developing even faster now. So, yeah, we'll see.

Interviewer: If you do personal work outside of maybe your company, do you feel like your informal personal rules change when you use AI when you're working on a personal project versus your company client project?

Interviewee09: Maybe sometimes. Maybe, yes, because for my personal projects, I am more free in what I use and how I use them. I have more free will in creative process as well as the deadlines as well as like everything. And for paid projects, it's more strict because there are some clients and I have to consider their needs and their reputation as well. And it's a professional responsibility. And for my personal projects, it's just for myself or I am representing my own self so I can decide for my own what I use. So, maybe I can experiment more with AI when I'm working for my personal projects and less for the company projects

Interviewer: Can you maybe give a small example of how you experiment if it's applicable? Do you have anything in your mind?

Interviewee09: For my personal projects, you mean?

Interviewer: Yes

Interviewee09: I, so for example, I can write a prompt about like maybe generating some ideas that AI thinks would be suitable for my project. And I don't mean creating the design systems and creating the whole brand identity, but maybe some elements or design elements maybe sometimes or the, what kind of social media post would be suitable for the given brand book that I give to AI or show AI. So yeah, it just gives me more ideas because I don't really have that tight deadlines and I have more time as well to experiment. So yeah, but when I'm working on a company project, it's hard because first of all, I don't have that much time. And second of all, I don't really need to, I already have decided what my goal is for that company and brand. And yeah, I only just use AI for reframing or finding some stuff or removing objects, some technical stuff.

Interviewer: When delivering a project, how do you decide whether or not to mention the tools involvement to your clients or colleagues?

Interviewee09: Yes, I guess it depends on the type of the project I'm working on. So client maybe may say beforehand, before I start working on their design, that they must know what tools I use. And it doesn't even have to be AI, like sometimes they just want to know what I used, even if it's not AI. And if it is AI, then especially they need to know. But when nobody asks me or nobody tells me, it's totally up to me. So if I maybe need an opinion from my colleague, from other designer, I tell them, like, can you look at this? Is it appropriate? Some friendly advices maybe. And yeah, or maybe if I used AI, like if it's very noticeable, then I, when I'm sending it to the client, maybe I tell them by myself that just so you know, it is AI and this photo, I didn't take this photo from anywhere or I didn't take it by myself. Sometimes, yeah, it depends on the projects. So if I, if they gave me a photo of a child, for example, who is going to school and wearing a red shirt, and I totally changed it, like, it is obvious that I changed it. But I also tell them by myself that it is by this AI tool. So yeah, you should know.

Interviewer: But at the end, I would ask you, maybe there's anything, given what we talked about, you kind of understand what our research area is. Maybe you would like to mention that maybe I haven't asked, you maybe feel it's important about how AI is being developing or how you see AI?

Interviewee09: Yes. So I think AI is developing much, much faster this past one, two years, especially. And at some point, I had this fear that, oh, what if AI replaces my profession? And sometimes, I also do think that because it is scary sometimes, because it's developing so well, and some results are so realistic, even I can't tell the difference between some AI generated images and the ones that were created by designers. And sometimes

it concerns me. And so yeah, I think for now, what we can do is to make the best use of it. And I mean, the work process that I have chosen to integrate AI with me is right, and is about that, because I choose to like use AI for the stuff that I really need to use them on. And I think that it's important to leave the creative process to the humans and to designers, because it is hard to actually replace the human brain and the creative thinking of humans. And as for now, AI is not that developed. So I can say for sure that humans are needed, at least in deciding on what can be replaced by AI and what cannot be. And so that's important as for now. But I don't know, maybe AI develops so much to the level that it can be replaced, this whole graphic design profession may be gone. So that's concerning. But I think it's up to us to decide how we use it, I would say. And as for the confidential and stuff and data saving stuff, that can also be concerning because the internet and the servers can be kind of dangerous. I don't really and actually know as for now, especially when we don't have any official rules or any policies in our company. And it's, I don't know for sure if I can trust the data. So it can also be concerning. Don't trust the data will be secured. Yeah, I don't know for sure. Yeah, I haven't had the situation when my data has been like, spotted outside of my workspace or outside of the company. If I have not given the permission to the tool or to the client or to my colleague to show or put it out of the company, like workspace. Yeah, I haven't had the situation where I have seen or have been exposed to my personal data that I used to create some images in AI, for example, but I cannot be for sure. Yeah, it's so yeah, I, I'm not sure. Maybe it will also be developed in our country, especially. So it's a good thing if we have something to put our trust into, like, I know for sure that my information is safe, then it's a very, very comfortable thing. And I hope to have those official and trustful policies my country more and sooner and in my company, especially. So it would be very comfortable. I would feel much, much more comfortable in using AI in that case. Yeah, that's what I wanted to say.

Interviewer: Thank you so much for your time and your insights into this

Interviewee09: Thank you for having me.

INTERVIEW 10

02/25/2026 | 26 Minutes | Senior UX Designer

Interviewer: Thank you so much for doing this ... the information you will provide as well as like company details will be completely anonymized also your participation is voluntary of course and you can stop the interview at any time, the interview will be recorded and transcribed only used for academic purposes and your identity will be remain confidential uh do you consent to participate in the interview and being recorded. Yes, okay, great, so I will jump right through the questions. Can you briefly describe your role and what kind of creative work that you do?

Interviewee10: Yeah, so I work as a UX designer at a consultancy firm, so I do different assignments at different companies where I do UX jobs, but it could be any type of project. So it could be more research-based, or it could be even just doing UI design, so the more visual aspects, kind of the whole range of the UX field.

Interviewer: Can you walk what type of technology likes are central to your daily work?

Interviewee10: The main tool that I use is Figma, which is a design tool that also has some AI aspects to it. Sometimes I use Adobe, and then of course Microsoft documents and these types of things.

Interviewer: Can you maybe walk me through a recent situation where you used or maybe avoided using Gen AI, and walk me through the steps of using AI for your work?

Interviewee10: So, when I avoided using [it] general?

Interviewer: Either when you used it or maybe avoided using it once and decided, "I cannot use AI for this." And what would you say is included in generative AI? It could be ChatGPT helping you go through data, or generating images, or anything like that, any type of AI that you think you use.

Interviewee10: Yeah, so, in Figma, there are quite a few AI tools to make it easier to generate and expand on already created designs. You can make things into vectors, and things like that, or copy can be auto-generated if it's just a mock-up. So, instead of me having to figure out fake text, it just generates it automatically. So, that's something that I would use. Also, Midjourney to create illustrations or maybe get photos for mock-ups, just to get a sense of what the feel of the design is going to be, would be something that I usually use. I do use ChatGPT a lot for maybe fine-tuning some emails that I will be sending, or summarizing a field of research, or producing or improving text that I need to use for a site or similar. So, a lot in terms

of text generation and text editing, I use AI a lot, or Copilot, to find files or summaries or things like that. I've also been trying a lot of new tools lately, because there are quite a lot of new things coming out in the design field, where it can also generate design. So I'm trying that out to see what it can do for me in my profession, but I haven't used it in an actual case yet.

Interviewer: Maybe what tools? I mean, I know there's a lot being developed every day, but what did you find, the ones you mentioned?

Interviewee10: One that looks really interesting is Google Stitch. Let me think... There are quite more. I've been looking at... I feel like I have a few open here. I'm not sure which ones I'm looking at or how useful they will be, but Recraft is also quite interesting.

Interviewer: Do you think that may be helpful to you in your future work?

Interviewee10: These new tools or just AI in general?

Interviewer: New tools

Interviewee10: I think Google Stitch looks really interesting, and I know I have colleagues who've used Figma Make as well, where you can create really quick prototypes. So then you could potentially do ideation with clients and quickly put out a simple prototype that you can test. So it just kind of speeds up rapid prototyping a lot. Then you can come up with interesting ideas, test them out in a very smooth and quick way. In terms of the design quality, it could maybe be good to use as a boost to get ideas. So far, I think it's pretty good to get ideas, but it didn't look like it was ready for development-type design quality. But I'm sure it's going to become better and better.

Interviewer: How do you decide which tasks are appropriate to delegate to AI, and which are not and should not be uploaded to AI and give data to it?

Interviewee10: Well, any sensitive details, of course, like personal details, I would not upload in any AI unless it's a safe agent that is better to use. But even still, I wouldn't put any data to it. If so, it would have to be anonymized data. So that's the main one where I would avoid using AI for security reasons, obviously. But I don't know, there's not anything at the moment where I would completely trust 100% to AI, I don't think.

Interviewer: But sometimes people use it to get inspiration or some type of thing, and then they move to edit it, rearrange it, I don't know. Do you approach it that way to use it?

Interviewee10: Yeah, for sure, a way to come up with ideas or get a first draft out, or get that type of thing as a kind of stepping stone, I would do.

Interviewer: Also, whenever you get an output and response from AI, what are your personal filters, and what processes do you go through to verify whatever the AI gave you before you consider it ready for use later on?

Interviewee10: Specifically in, like, my creative work?

Interviewer: Yeah, in your work, maybe it should be to come up with some text or maybe some references. I don't know. Sometimes, for me, when I want to use a reference, it comes up with an unusable link or something, so I check that.

Interviewee10: Yeah, I'm just trying to reflect on it. I don't use it so much to produce a fact or look up information that I need to have as facts, if you know what I mean. I'd probably more use it to edit something that I've already written and researched. If I use it as research, then I try to ask for the sources and then double-check the sources. But in my work, I use it more as a way to improve a text, to make it sound more fluent, sound more positive, sound more professional, that type of thing. And with images, I don't necessarily fact-check the images, because it's just a factual image, if that makes sense. It would just be AI-generated for that purpose of being AI-generated, if that makes sense.

Interviewer: So if you have to deliver something, some design to the client, you kind of don't use AI as much in that sense, more like emails and text, that's what you're using.

Interviewee10: Yeah, I mean, for images, I can use generative AI, for example. Let's say I'm going to create a website and I just want to show what it's going to look like. So I will add fake photos that look quite cool. Let's say it's a clothing brand or something like that. So maybe I will create fake product images, for example, or a cool hero image for the landing page to emphasize the design a bit. So that's something where I could use it without fact-checking it, so to speak, or where it would not actually be the final product, but rather just part of the process.

Interviewer: Who do you feel is responsible for the final outcome when AI is involved?

Interviewee10: I mean, if it's a part of my job, then it would be me.

Interviewer: And I know there's some type of stigma about AI. People don't disclose that they used it, or things like that. Maybe how is that process in your company? Do people feel comfortable sharing that they used this tool to create this, or that this is AI-generated, whatever they did?

Interviewee10: I would say that it's quite encouraged to use AI tools. I think the design industry and the tech industry are changing a lot, and a

part of that will be being able to master and apply these tools. So I think, in my field, I wouldn't say that it's frowned upon to talk about AI tools. I would maybe say the opposite.

Interviewer: I will move to another topic, formal and informal rules. You mentioned AI. You mentioned that AI is encouraged in your company. Do you have any policies or formal rules that you should follow regarding AI use for your projects?

Interviewee10: I just meant that in my field, I think it's encouraged, but I don't think I can comment on anything specific to my place of employment, unfortunately, in the interview.

Interviewer: Some informal rules, if you can comment on that, maybe. You mentioned that personal information is not disclosed, but are there some other rules that you have for yourself, or "unwritten rules" that you follow whenever you decide to use AI?

Interviewee10: I don't think I have anything additional, apart from what I mentioned earlier, in terms of putting sensitive data in there and making sure to fact-check if I'm using it for research.

Interviewer: I mean, AI is kind of new, but new and old in a way that's evolving every day. Can you maybe comment on how the practices have changed over time, and maybe what's triggered those changes?

Interviewee10: What do you mean by practices?

Interviewer: Like, practices, how people approach to use AI, maybe, like, three years ago to now

Interviewee10: In, the UX design field, or creative field, or?

Interviewer: In both, in your experience, how you see it, as a user of AI in your work.

Interviewee10: Well, the tools that are coming out are becoming more and more actually useful, whereas in the beginning it was more like a novelty, I suppose. And the more practical tools that are coming out, the more undeniable it becomes that it's going to be a large part of my profession, that AI will be. So in that sense, I feel like maybe the attitude has gone from, "Oh, this is exciting. I wonder what this might be," maybe tested for a bit of fun, to actually being able to use it to bring more value into a project. I would say in the last three to four years, that's the main shift that I can think about.

Interviewer: We have another topic, authorship and trust. When you deliver a project, how do you decide whether or not to mention the tool's involvement to your clients or colleagues? You already talked about it a bit, but can you explore that a little more?

Interviewee10: Good question. I mean, if it's image generation, I think it's always going to be very clear that it's an AI-generated image to a client, and it's quite a fun thing to try out. So I think that's something we can try out within the team and talk about. You'd never want to make it seem as though ChatGPT is just doing all your work and that the product you are producing is just AI, you just press the button, and then it came out. Of course, you want to make it clear that you have put it through a due process and that the product is quality, and you have checked that the quality is there. So in that way, you wouldn't want it to sound as though you just asked ChatGPT to do this job. But the type of projects that I'm working on, that's not really possible. That's not really my delivery, if you know what I mean. It's not possible to just do it with AI. You can use AI as a tool to speed up the process, but not just with AI.

Interviewer: Can you maybe, if it's possible, give an example of it, how?

Interviewee10: So far, if I would create a design for a website or something like that, I have not yet done so with AI. The design that I've delivered so far has been made in a manual process by me, so to speak. Maybe some copy, maybe some images, and things like that will be generated, which would then be clear, and I would be happy to communicate that, if that makes sense.

Interviewer: Okay. I think that's about it on my end. I also want to ask you one last question. You kind of get the sense of what we're mainly researching about, creative professionals and AI. Maybe you can give us a last comment that I didn't ask about and that you think is important on this topic.

Interviewee10: What was your research focus?

Interviewer: How creative professionals utilize AI in their work, and how some companies have formal rules that you should follow, but sometimes those rules are unclear and you cannot follow them, because if you do, it's no use. And maybe one of the rules is not to use ChatGPT, and people still do it. And maybe how it can be avoided that informal rules become formal rules, in a sense. And how people feel about whatever the output is, authorship of whatever AI provides later on. So that's kind of what... yeah. I think, I mean...

Interviewee10: What I would say is that in the last few years, it's starting to pop up, it's starting to become more common. It's slowly coming into the field, but I feel like now it's kind of a pivotal moment where things are really going to change in terms of usage. I'm seeing more and more tools where maybe it's not perfect yet, but I don't think it will take many years before

they will create more perfect designs. Then it's going to be more that the actual design could potentially be AI-generated as well, the visual design. So it will be different. It will be interesting to see how it will change. But right now, it's only a small part of the job, so to speak. But yeah, it would be interesting to see. And I suppose perhaps you guys will maybe share the result with the participants in the end.

Interviewer: of course we can we will send you the the paper

Interviewee10: Yeah, it'll be interesting to see in terms of the policies and things like that as well. I think we are quite AI-forward, but it's also important to have clear rules, like you say. It's interesting to see what your findings are.

Interviewer: So thank you. Maybe one last question: you mentioned that AI will generate better quality as time goes by. What do you think will be the job descriptions that AI cannot replace in your field?

Interviewee10: Maybe, I think for me as a UX designer, it's a lot about having that human empathy and understanding of very complex organizations, culture, internal politics, different stakeholders, and tying that together, and bringing people together as well. It's also about helping people when there's change in the organization. A new system is coming out, or we need to choose a different strategy in the company for one reason or another, and making sure that it's anchored within the whole organization. So it's maybe more those types of things. And then, of course, if you still focus on more visual design and things like that, then maybe it's about being very good at applying the different AI tools to create the design. So partly the more complex understanding of people and culture, and then one niche could maybe be using the AI tools to create design. But I think that can more and more maybe fall into other roles as well. But let's say you're doing a system in healthcare, for example. There are so many complex situations, and people who are stressed, or people who might find something difficult. What's the technology? What are the technology habits of people? All of that you kind of need to gather by talking to people and using your empathy and understanding. It would be hard to replace that with AI, I think, at least for the foreseeable future.

Interviewer: Thank you so much for taking your time and sharing your insights with us.

Interviewee10: Well, good luck, and I hope it goes well. Looking forward to hearing more.

Interviewer: Yes, thank you so much once again. Have a good day. Bye.

INTERVIEW 11

03/01/2026 | 33 Minutes | Lead Product Designer

Interviewer: The information you provide as well as company details will be completely anonymized also your participation is voluntary you can stop the interview at any time the interview will be recorded and transcribed only used for academic purposes and your identity will be will remain confidential do you consent to participate in this interview and being recorded

Interviewee11: Yes, I do

Interviewer: Thank you. Let's start um can you briefly describe your role and the kind of creative work that you do.

Interviewee11: My current role is lead product designer. I am working on an internal tool in my company, but in general, I work with a mobile app and web apps, from basically product statement to delivering high-fidelity flows.

Interviewer: Okay, what tools or techniques are essential to your daily work?

Interviewee11: Ninety percent of the time, I use Figma. If we're talking about AI, I usually use ChatGPT, Claude, or Perplexity, but it's more of a supporting role, as you said. The main reason why I use AI is to write copy. Let's say when I need to present some part of the flow and prepare screens for sharing with stakeholders or people who do not understand the design process very well, I want to make sure that the copy and whatever I'm presenting is very close to reality. One of the tasks I often ask AI to do is to help me find the best copy for the screens I am presenting. The second thing is when I'm at the research stage. Especially when there is not enough knowledge about competitors or user problems, or when I'm in a state where I don't know a lot, I ask AI to create problem statements or user stories for specific use cases. Then I go through these user stories or pain points, and based on my knowledge and feeling, I pick the ones that are most relevant. I either take what AI wrote or refine it myself to make it closer to the case I am working with. Sometimes I have situations when I'm confused. Right now, I'm working on a design system, and there are many components and elements, and some naming is clashing. I feel stuck for a second. I already have this element, so how would I call a similar element with similar behavior? Instead of going into other design systems that are available, I ask AI to refer to names from big design systems and give me some ideas or inspiration. It's more like I need to unblock myself, get some hints, and then

I work with those hints. I also often use it for grammar correction and to make me sound more professional, since I'm not a native speaker. When I write documentation or describe parts of the design work, I put the text I've written in to check for mistakes or simplify it in case I didn't write it very straight to the point. That would be the main key pieces.

Interviewer: Which specific tasks did you hand off to AI, and which tasks do you feel are off limits?

Interviewee11: No specific tasks. I would say that I'm also not a heavy AI user. I don't feel like, at this stage, I can delegate my work and let it complete tasks fully. I use it more as a partner, as I said before, to unblock me, give me inspiration, and showcase things that I forgot or haven't thought about yet. So I would say that all the tasks I mentioned before are what I often do, but it's not fully automated. Are there any tasks I would never use AI for? It's hard to say right now, because the trust for me is still low. I would be suspicious about processing personal data and feeding it with a lot of private information. That's what I'm trying to avoid. I still need to check the outcome myself before submitting something.

Interviewer: Since you mentioned that you check the outcome, what is your personal filter process for verifying it before you consider it ready to send?

Interviewee11: I would say that whenever I initiate a chat with AI, I already have some kind of idea of what I want the outcome to be. If we're talking about copywriting, I feed some information, get a response, and then continue refining it based on my gut feeling and the knowledge I have. If we're talking about app copy, AI can provide responses that are too long or something that doesn't work for specific content. So I match all these things and try to achieve the best outcome, considering the points that are important. It's the same with user stories. As a designer, I already know some pain points, or I can assume them, because problems are not unique, and someone has probably already experienced them. Sometimes I know enough to assume specific problem statements. Then I go through the list that AI provides and think, this is impossible in this scenario, so we remove it and don't continue with it. Then I look at something else and see potential. Maybe it's not a very common use case, but it might happen. So it's more like playing with possibilities, and when the possibility is high enough, I take it to work and continue with it.

Interviewer: Did you have situations where AI provided a hallucination of some sort, like whatever it provided is not existing, for example, for maybe research they will provide links that you know.

Interviewee11: Yeah, I think it happened a few times when it gives you fake links, but I don't usually open them. I read the context first and basically make assumptions compared to the real world. Even if it hallucinated and gave me a fake link with fake data, but the essential thing is possible in reality. I think in creative work or my work, it's something that can be considered, because a lot of my work is assumptions, basically.

Interviewer: How do you ensure that AI-assisted results you deliver still align with specific values or voice of your client?

Interviewee11: Oh, it's a very good question, hard to answer, I think, because I didn't get to this high level of automation. There is still a lot of my input into it, and I just align everything with how I would do it. Is it good enough? Does it sound professional? Is it solid information? I think I'm the main filter right now to make sure that it's correct and has the right voice and way of talking.

Interviewer: At the end, who do you feel is responsible for the final outcome when AI is involved in your work?

Interviewee11: Me. Yes, as I said, I still don't believe right now, and I still think that AI is there to support and inspire, but not replace or do our job for us. And even if the job is delegated to AI, even fully automated, I think that in the end, it's your responsibility to delegate it correctly and make sure that whatever is produced is how you want it to be. You cannot blame AI.

Interviewer: We are moving to more of a formal versus informal rules topic. In your company, do you have any policies in your organization regarding AI use? And if you do, are they unclear, and how do you navigate that uncertainty?

Interviewee11: So, as far as I know, in my company, access to AI tools is very limited, since people are working a lot with clients and a lot with personal information. We have Copilot, but I don't think any other external tools are possible for me. In my case, it's a little bit different, because I am working on a specific product, so they gave us access to other external tools we can use. But of course, I think it's an unwritten rule that you're not supposed to provide private information there, and maybe even when you prompt something, you should remove names, real names, real data, and replace it with something else. Besides privacy rules, that's mainly it.

Interviewer: Do you have any other personal rules or habits when you use AI?

Interviewee11: Personally or still like work related?

Interviewer: We can talk about both

Interviewee11: I think when I use AI for personal use, I can be more open and less careful, and maybe sometimes drop some information where I'm like, okay, it doesn't matter, but it matters. With work, you're more strict and pay more attention. But I think the main rule is just don't give your passwords and something that can be used against you.

Interviewer: Have there been situations where AI use felt unclear or maybe uncomfortable to talk about at work?

Interviewee11: Can you explain more? I'm not sure I understand the question?

Interviewer: Sometimes people don't feel uncomfortable to say that you used ai for your work or

Interviewee11: No, I think in my team, my manager wants us to use AI and explore new tools and see what other cool stuff we can do with it. So in my team, we talk a lot about AI, and I know that people explore a lot and try different tools. I've never personally felt like it's bad to say or uncomfortable to say that I did it with AI. I think it's the opposite, cool, you found a way to use it.

Interviewer: Yes, AI has been around for a long time, but it has had a boom over maybe the last five or four years. In your experience, how have these practices changed over time, and what triggered those changes?

Interviewee11: Absolutely. I think I've been using it for two years. You definitely see it more, and people who are more advanced are doing all these cool things. They automate a lot and delegate a lot, and it's great. If we're talking about the work aspect, it helps you save energy and time doing manager work or some boring stuff, which before took a lot of time. The same in the creative area, it helps you ideate more and find more inspiration. I think now it's getting more and more popular, and I don't know if it's ever going to stop.

Interviewer: Whenever you use AI on a project, how do you deliver that project to your client? Do you mention that in some aspects AI was used, or do you not mention it?

Interviewee11: So I don't work for external clients. My client is someone in my organization, because it's an internal tool. It depends on the use case. Sometimes, if it's obvious information or not interesting, I avoid mentioning it because I don't think it brings any value. But sometimes it's very valuable to say, I ran it through AI, or I did market research with AI and these are the results that it showed, and they seem reasonable. In that case, I mention that some part of the work has been done together with AI.

Interviewer: If it's possible, can you give us a more specific example of when you avoided mentioning it and when you mentioned it?

Interviewee11: Hard, yeah, let me think. I can maybe give you an example not from my current role, but from a company I worked at previously. I don't remember trying to avoid mentioning using AI. There was a use case where I needed to do some research and didn't have access to real users at the moment. The research was very country-specific. It was about mobile operator users in the U.S., and I needed some data on what people are struggling with, how often people reach out to support, how often people change operators, and things like this. So I used AI to give me some information. Based on this information, if a percentage was high and important, it was phrased into a problem. Then, when I created a design or showcased design directions or flows, the ways we could approach the problem, I used this information and said that it was provided by AI. Obviously, everyone knew that we didn't interview the whole country and didn't have those users. Based on this information, we could assume that this would be the right way of doing things, or one of the ways of doing things. It was always taken well, and it felt reliable. This would be an example of mentioning it.

Interviewer: Yeah, perfect example, thank you. We are kind of moving to authorship and trust. How do you determine if you have enough personal ownership of a piece of work to put your name on it after using AI?

Interviewee11: I would call it 100 percent personal ownership. Maybe it's not correct, but I still feel like it wasn't produced by AI only, because I initiated it and gave it direction. This is how I feel. Of course, I understand that it's not always true, but I would still call it my work. In a case where AI provided the core idea, but I or someone else performed all of the refinements, I would still say it's the person's work. Because whatever AI gives me, I don't know what's behind it. If it were a real person who contributed to this work and provided me with this information because they did research or something else, then it would be shared work, of course. But when it's AI, I don't know if there is one real person behind it, or multiple people, or millions of sources that the information is gathered from. It's hard to find who did that. I also understand that it's not that AI produced it in the human sense. It found it, it didn't create the information in the way a person does. So I wouldn't say that it is shared authorship.

Interviewer: Have you ever felt that using AI for a specific task made you feel separated from your craft or like your skills were degrading in a way?

Interviewee11: No, not at the moment, and I think the reason for that is because I do not delegate a lot and try to control these things. I wouldn't say that my skills are growing, to be honest, and I feel like it's very neutral. It's not going down. I would say that it stays the same.

Interviewer: Since we are seeing this progression of AI and everybody is being so excited about it, and you use it for assistance, do you feel that this role will change in the future as AI improves and progresses? Will it take more of your role or something?

Interviewee11: Yes, I think so. Honestly, it also depends a lot on personality. I am not the one who is always exploring new AI tools, but I'm sure there are people who do that. I would like to do it more. I would like to delegate more and somehow set up the process so that the outcome gets better and closer to what I want without me always controlling it. That would be my wish. I mean, we're all feeding it at the moment, so I hope it will get better and better, but it's also scary.

Interviewer: Do you feel it maybe take over too much tasks at some point ?

Interviewee11: Not for me, I would say not enough, but I think I am the problem here. It could be, but I also don't believe that it would be enough to call the work done.

Interviewer: What do you mean you are the problem?

Interviewee11: As I said, you can write a great prompt and ask AI to produce something, and take this outcome and present it straight away. I am lazy to write ideal prompts and hope that the outcome will be great, and I'm also maybe too controlling to just take the outcome and present it somewhere. I feel like I still need to put it through my brain and add my personal input into it before showing it to anybody else. I don't think there have been any tasks I've done where I just copied and pasted and showed it. It is because I don't trust it enough. I definitely need to read through it and understand it. It's also because I haven't managed how to add my personality into it, if it makes sense. So I do it afterwards.

Interviewer: You can understand our research topic. It's about the decision process behind what tasks to delegate to AI, formal versus informal rules, authorship, and problems. During this interview, maybe I haven't talked about anything that you deem important to mention in this study?

Interviewee11: Let me think. I think, of course, it's very much a personal decision what to delegate or not. If I think about it, I would delegate something that doesn't have a direct impact on your work or outcome, like booking meetings. But that's not really creative work. With creative work,

it's a bit harder, because I don't think or I don't see that AI is at the point where it can create a great creative outcome without any changes afterwards from the human side

Interviewer: This is it on my end. Thank you so much for taking the time and participating. The responses are very valuable and will be used greatly.

Interviewee11: I hope it's helpful. I'm not a very experienced user, but I hope it helps.

Interviewer: It will help. Thank you so much.

INTERVIEW 12

03/03/2026 | 25 Minutes | UX Designer

Interviewer: Thank you so much for agreeing to do this. First of all, I would like to inform you that the information you provide, as well as the company details, will be completely anonymized. Also, your participation is voluntary. You can stop the interview at any time. The interview will be recorded and transcribed, only used for academic purposes, and your identity will remain confidential. Do you consent to participate in this interview and being recorded?

Interviewee12: Greetings, and I do consent and agree to the interview.

Interviewer: Can you briefly describe your role and the kind of creative work that you do?

Interviewee12: My name is [Name] and I'm a UX designer for over seven to eight years already. I specialize mainly in application and website interface experiences, and the technologies I use mainly are Figma, Workflow, Framer, and Realm AI.

Interviewer: As you already mentioned, are there any other tools or technologies that are maybe central to your daily work?

Interviewee12: Those four are the main tools out of my toolkit, but other than those, I use Framer, I use random chatbots to just interact with, and some creative tools.

Interviewer: Can you maybe walk me through a recent situation where you used generative AI?

Interviewee12: One of my recent projects, which is essentially an educational platform, I let Perplexity AI handle initial conceptualizing, basic architecture, and structure. Obviously, it was under my supervision, making sure everything is aligned with the client's requirements and needs. After conceptualizing, I let myself handle the rest — meaning the designing in Figma, componentizing, and so on.

Interviewer: Maybe you can also walk me through a situation where you decided to avoid using gen AI?

Interviewee12: To be honest, I've never avoided it. Once we came to this AI era, I always try to incorporate AI into my workflow, because I think by now it's almost essential, and it's such a helping hand that I did not have a case when I did not use AI in a certain project.

Interviewer: Are there any specific tasks that you hand off to AI, and maybe some that are off-limits for AI?

Interviewee12: It depends on the project, but as a basic structure goes, the more basic side of the design — which is basic analysis while framing and even component distribution — can be handled by AI. This cuts a lot of time for me and gives me an edge to handle the technical part as a designer, which is done by me in Figma as the end result.

Interviewer: How do you decide which tasks are appropriate to delegate to gen AI, and which are not?

Interviewee12: As UX designers, we have to know and be aware of best practices that exist in the industry. As we build this information, it becomes very easy to validate and reorganize the prompts that we give to AI. As I mentioned, It would be just basic structuring, information architecture, prompting, conceptualizing, and then merging with my own thoughts with the output, and then going to the final outcome. Obviously, it also depends on the inner phases of the project, the longevity, and the client's feedback, but those can be nurtured to the results.

Interviewer: If it's okay with you, maybe you can share a specific example?

Interviewee12: On the project that I mentioned, I assigned Perplexity, prompted by me — since I knew the structure and had a brief, I prompted it to architect the basic conceptual idea of the website and provide AI-generated UX copy text, images, etc. So, by the time I started the project, I already had a pre-made template to tackle with, and it really made the work very easy for me.

Interviewer: Are there any tasks you would consider to never use AI for, and why?

Interviewee12: I guess that would be more the technical part, the part that I do in Figma, which AI can do, obviously, manually, but I would not let it design some very unique or confidential or specific requirements that are nurtured to clients' needs, and something that's more sensitive, I would say.

Interviewer: Once AI generates an output, what is your personal filter process for verifying it before you consider it ready?

Interviewee12: So I will go back to the point that I mentioned, is that we already have experience as designers, we have information, we have knowledge about best practices that exist in the industries. That's the first point, and of course, after this information is processed and given to AI, it's very easy for us to validate generated output and align it for our needs or clients' needs as well. The second point is that we also have our own research insights that add up to what we've prompted AI, so at the end of

the day, it's just a hybrid information organization that helps me to move forward.

Interviewer: Maybe you can describe a time when an AI tool provided a hallucination or a flawed result, and how you handled that and maybe adjusted your workflow?

Interviewee12: So I have kind of different take on this. I believe if AI is prompted correctly, even the not-so-much-desired output can be rendered useful and set a correct path for us, so even the misinformation can lead to the right answers. But to answer the question in general, yes, I've had a few errors that came from the output that I didn't utilize, but it can be worked through, it can be reprompted, obviously. That's the beauty of AI, right? You can make it do whatever you want, basically, and align to your needs.

Interviewer: But it did provide hallucinations, even though maybe your prompt was very detailed, but some hallucinations do occur, so to say?

Interviewee12: So, for example, there was one case when I was structuring a design system for a certain project, and I've had specific requirements for AI to manage my components, and it totally outputs the wrong color system for me, from what I prompted, and wrong typography system, which was not so good. So I then re-prompted it once again, and at the end, I, of course, got the final result, but I've encountered a few errors, yes.

Interviewer: How do you ensure that the AI-assisted results you deliver still align with the specific values or voice of your client?

Interviewee12: Well, at the end of the day, the output is corrected to our client's needs and requirements, right, with the insights we as creatives possess. Of course, further feedback from the client is taken into consideration during that process as well, so there's lots of validation levels to that, but I wouldn't say that it's hard or a complex process.

Interviewer: How do you decide when AI output needs maybe correction, rewriting, or even reduction?

Interviewee12: So, it once again depends on the project, it depends on the flow, it depends on the process, how the feedback is going back and forth, how the interaction is going with the client or the organization. Mostly it's feedback-based, because with the AI, I mainly have a general structure for what I need to conceptualize, and then I leverage from that within utilizing the client's feedback, my own feedback, and so on and so on.

Interviewer: At the end, who do you think is responsible for the final outcome when AI is involved in the final product?

Interviewee12: So, I look at this process as me and AI being basically two sides of one, two personalities of one entity, that has one goal only, is to basically deliver a high-end product, and the beauty of it is that utilizing both human and AI factors, which makes us designers even more powerful. In my opinion, I think that AI is our assistant at its core, and it becomes part of us as a whole as the project goes on.

Interviewer: Are there maybe any formal rules in your company about how you should use AI? And if there are policies that are unclear or maybe absent, how do you navigate that uncertainty?

Interviewee12: I would say no, because I did not have a scenario where I encountered or had to tackle with any legal issues or legal complexities, because once again, the use of AI from the starting time of the project is really simple and general and basic. So there's no need to validate any legal documentation within that. I would say I did not have that case in my career.

Interviewer: It could also be legal, but are there any, not laws, but principles that your company says, okay, you can use AI on this, but never use AI on this? Are there any regulations?

Interviewee12: No, I would say no.

Interviewer: Do you have any types of informal rules, unwritten rules you follow whenever you use AI?

Interviewee12: Only the most important rule, I think, is that I would assume is not to share with AI, unless it's necessary, of course, is the personal details of the client or organization that can be confidential and case sensitive. That's the point I would say.

Interviewer: Have there been any situations where AI use felt unclear or uncomfortable to talk about at work?

Interviewee12: I would say no.

Interviewer: So the AI, talking about AI in your environment is pretty open, and colleagues—

Interviewee12: Yes, we are in a tech environment, obviously. So it's pretty much everything we talk about nowadays is AI, basically.

Interviewer: Yes, but sometimes people have a very negative, even in tech, negative attitude towards AI. They think that it's taking over our jobs and stuff like that. So—

Interviewee12: I completely disagree with that opinion of thinking that. I don't think AI is our competition. I think it's part of us, basically. As humans, we create AI to assist us and be our right hand, let's say, in quotes.

My opinion is a bit different. And as for company goals, I've just had discussions with internal designers, my colleagues, and of course there are differences, but I personally, from my colleagues, I didn't hear the opinion coming within our discussions that it's taken our job, et cetera. I would say it's vice versa.

Interviewer: Vice versa, you mean as in it's helping you to keep your job?

Interviewee12: Not to keep our job, but it's a really, really good thing to have assisting within your workflow and within your projects. I think it's not only good, but awesome to have AI assisting you during your process of designing or thinking even, because it cuts lots of time and it gives us lots of edge. It basically, I think it makes us really super designers, because we are becoming very fast, initiating our process, our thinking structure expands, our field of view expands with the help of AI. So I would say it's totally beneficial.

Interviewer: AI has been introduced, the boom of AI has been over maybe five years, four years. Do you notice any changes compared to when it was first introduced to now, as AI is developing and evolving, of course. What were the practices of its use and how they changed, and what triggered those changes?

Interviewee12: I would say, as general knowledge of AI grows, how companies and organizations try to incorporate it and advance, because since we know that AI is being trained every day, even by now, and lots of finances are put into it, I see the difference between five years ago and now. It's more capable, it's faster, it has more nurtured fields of perspective that you can utilize AI. For example, five years ago, you could not have insights from any other model that you can have right now, because you can have nurtured outputs. Now, for example, if I want to have some insights or some structure based solely on application design as opposed to web design, it can provide different practices better, and it can think better, it can think faster, and so on and so on.

Interviewer: Do your personal rules for using AI change when maybe you're working on a personal project versus a client project?

Interviewee12: Mostly, I would say no, unless there is a very specific set of requirements per client or project. I would say no. 95% of the time, no.

Interviewer: Whenever you use AI on a project, how do you decide that you mention it, or say that this final outcome has some AI input in it, or you decide not to mention it at all to your colleagues or to your clients or management?

Interviewee12: I try to always mention it because, as I mentioned, I think it's part of my workflow. It's one of the toolkits that I can use alongside. It's similar for me as using Figma for me to design. I use AI to conceptualize, to structure, to architecture, et cetera. Even with clients, I do mention it. I will provide you with the specific case where I did mention some scenarios where I did include what AIs I used and how I used it, and I gave that information to clients. As it goes with my colleagues, we always have discussions. Whenever we utilize AI, we always share insights with each other — what we used it for, what was our purpose, how was the output, and so on and so on. It's a pretty active topic of our discussions, mostly with colleagues, but with clients as well sometimes.

Interviewer: Were there situations where you opted not to mention it to the client?

Interviewee12: There were situations. If I did not use it to the extent where I needed to involve it into creating a system, into creating some type of component or design system or layout in the technical part, I mainly don't mention it that it's used for the conceptualizing and prompting. I also use AI in Figma to populate content in the web pages, and data and the dummy text. I always mention that with them, that this is AI generated and we can elevate on that.

Interviewer: Do you discuss AI use rules or boundaries within the AI use with colleagues? Do you have a situation where a client's attitude is like, okay, don't use AI, or use as minimum AI as possible?

Interviewee12: No, to be honest, I didn't have that example or scenario in my career. Everyone is open to AI use.

Interviewer: Everyone is open to AI use.

Interviewee12: Everyone knows it's good, right? Everyone knows it makes our process faster, and especially people in our field, everyone already has the awareness that AI is a good thing. Of course, some very individual people, but I would say I didn't have that case.

Interviewer: Whenever you have a final project, how do you determine if you have enough personal ownership over your piece of work that you put your name on it after using AI?

Interviewee12: So I think to determine that is really simple, at least for me, because first, point number one is that I initiate the process, right? I use AI, I prompt it, I activate it, let's say, in quotes. And the second point is that the end product, which is output to developers or the client, is made by me, let's assume in Figma, which is all by hand drawn, handmade. So I

totally assume the involvement of myself 100% in the project and the ownership as well.

Interviewer: In the case when the core idea is provided by the AI, maybe of a design or something, and you performed the refinements afterwards, who do you feel still owns the final result?

Interviewee12: I would have the same answer to that as well. Basically, I think that AI and me are two parts of one personality, one workflow, one entity that have the same goal. So no, I didn't have that feeling yet.

Interviewer: Have you ever felt that using AI for a specific task made you feel separated from your craft, or your skills were degrading?

Interviewee12: No, to be honest. Other way around, I think that in some cases, AI kind of boosted my skills in some areas. Never had that feeling, never had that vibe. My philosophy is that, again, I will underline it once again, that AI is, I think at least, that it's our companion, not our competitor, and part of our workflow.

Interviewer: Nowadays, you see AI as your friend and a companion, a work buddy. But as AI is developing and becoming stronger and more accurate, do you feel that it could maybe take over your job or other jobs in the future?

Interviewee12: So I think that first and foremost, the human structures that us as human beings possess and our brain activity, all that stuff, I think that's the most important part and irreplaceable part that no tech can replace and is crucial to any job or any workflow. So I don't think it can or will overtake jobs, no matter how powerful it is, unless we are 2,000 years into the future where everything is AI automated. So I don't think right now it poses any risks for people to be afraid or scared that they will lose their jobs because of AI. I read some threads, and yes, I'm aware of some information that it did happen in some areas and cases, but still, I don't think that it will cost the jobs, especially in our field, in the digital field.

Interviewer: I will say whatever other people told me is that sometimes people still accept flawed results that AI gives them, but it's still a result and they use it. What's your perspective on it?

Interviewee12: My perspective on that would be that I kind of agree with those people. Any output of the AI can be helpful and used for our own good. I would say my opinion is natural towards that, but it depends as well what kind of output it is, right? What kind of topic it is, what stake it is, or whatever field we are talking about.

Interviewer: Maybe marketing, and they put it out, a design which you can see it's clearly AI, and it's not good. For example, it has six fingers on the hand.

Interviewee12: AI image generation is always a meme at this point, right? We see lots of memes, outputs, some random stuff. But I still think it can be useful. And also, the most powerful part about AI is that it can be trained. It can be trained based on those outputs as well. So I don't think it's a bad thing for it to make errors because it's still growing, still a child at this point.

Interviewer: You kind of understand the overall idea of our research topic — the decision process behind what tasks to delegate to AI, informal versus formal rules, and how to navigate the questions about authorship and trust towards AI. Do you feel like there were any topics not discussed in our conversation that you seem are important to mention and include in our study?

Interviewee12: At this point, I would say no, because I think we discussed the main core parts that can be associated with AI and its capabilities. So right now I would say no, I don't have any remarks.

Interviewer: Okay, great. Thank you so much for your time and insights regarding this topic.

Interviewee12: Thank you so much for a great interview.

INTERVIEW 13

03/04/2026 | 30 Minutes | Game Artist

Interviewer: Thank you [Interviewee13's Name] for doing this. The information you provide as well as company details will become completely anonymized. Also, your participation is voluntary. You can stop the interview at any time. The interview will be recorded and transcribed only used for academic purposes and your identity will remain confidential. Do you consent to participate in this interview and being recorded?

Interviewee13: Yes, I do.

Interviewer: Can you briefly describe your role and the kind of creative work that you do?

Interviewee13: So, I am a game artist and I draw game icons or even backgrounds, assets, everything that requires video games to have.

Interviewer: What types of tools or technology are central to your daily work?

Interviewee13: Well, as an artist, I mostly work and use Adobe Photoshop, sometimes Illustrator. And also, I do use a lot of AI, and for AI, I use mostly Midjourney on Discord. And sometimes, when I need to write a prompt for Midjourney, I use Google Gemini or even ChatGPT.

Interviewer: Can you maybe walk me through a recent situation where you used generative AI?

Interviewee13: It's not really recent. I always use AI because when I have to do a game, first of all, I need a concept and AI is very big help for it because it draws the concepts and the perspective for me, which really helps. And I save up a lot of time for that. So, recent, it's never recent. It's always. For example, I'm doing something now, I'm drawing a game and I still use AI.

Interviewer: Was there a time where you deliberately avoided using AI? Like, you decided not to use it for a specific task?

Interviewee13: When I'm working for corporate, I usually always use AI, but I also do my personal work as a freelancer. So, I never use AI on that because it actually doesn't make sense because I do those illustrations or drawings specifically for myself. So, I don't really need AI when I do my personal work. I never use AI.

Interviewer: How do you decide which tasks are appropriate to delegate to gen AI and which are not?

Interviewee13: Well, I think it depends on tasks. If it's more interesting to do and more creative to do, I think I use less AI. But if it's something

that needs to be done, for example, in a short time and it's for corporate or something that's been done before and it needs to be done fast, then I do use AI.

Interviewer: Was there any situation where a task needed to be done, but it was too complicated or difficult for AI to do it?

Interviewee13: Yes. I mean, when I need a more polished look, AI never does the polished work. So, when AI does something, then I do the polishing. So, sometimes when I write a prompt, AI doesn't understand what I mean. Even though I'm silver spoon feeding it the way it should be done, it still doesn't do the work. So, that's when I come in and that's when I do the rest of it. So, it's not always really helpful, but it sometimes gets a little job done. It's still helpful.

Interviewer: Are there tasks that you maybe never use AI for?

Interviewee13: Yes. That's what I said. When I do something for myself, my personal work, I never use AI.

Interviewer: But not in corporate?

Interviewee13: No, not in corporate, no.

Interviewer: Once AI maybe generates an output, what is your personal filter process for verifying it before you consider it is ready? What is your personal filter that you go through when AI gives you an output. It gave you a picture, for example.. What do you look for it that you say, okay, this is fine, I will use this and move on?

Interviewee13: I think it depends on the task or what I'm doing. As I said, it never does the exact thing that I want. So, I have to finish it. But it depends on what I do.

Interviewer: Maybe can you give us a little example if you can?

Interviewee13: For example, right now, I needed to draw a footballer in a certain perspective. And I did give AI the references, the perspective that I wanted. But it didn't give me the exact thing that I wanted. So now, I have to do all the work. But the things that it drew me are still helpful. I use them, but I kind of make it into a perspective that I want.

Interviewer: Have you ever had a time when AI provided a hallucination or made a big mistake? Like a flawed result, for example, six fingers on a footballer or something?

Interviewee13: It always does that. But it was more in the past. One year ago, AI did such things. But I think it updated and evolved into drawing better things. AI also became a more good artist than it was. It's evolving into something better.

Interviewer: How do you ensure that AI-assisted results you deliver still align with the values that you have or the voice of the client?

Interviewee13: How I ensure?

Interviewer: Ensure, yes

Interviewee13: I just look at the picture and that's when I know. This is what they want. Or if it's not, then I'm going to work on it and make it better and make it the way the client wants it.

Interviewer: Who do you feel is responsible for the final outcome when AI is involved? The final product, who is responsible for it?

Interviewee13: The final product, who is responsible for it? Me. I'm still in charge.

Interviewer: Do you feel pressured to mention AI was used in your work or you prefer not to say it at all?

Interviewee13: No, I'm not pressured. And also, this depends on the task. It's not embarrassing where I work that we use AI because everyone uses AI and we all need AI. It's an essential tool. It's working in Photoshop or other things. So it's not embarrassing at all because when the product needs to be done faster, we all use AI. So there's nothing embarrassing about it. But as I said, I never use AI in my personal work. And I think I would never use it because it's embarrassing for me personally to use it in my personal work because that's the field that I'm creative. So I don't need creativity from AI.

Interviewer: In your company, are there any formal rules or guidelines regarding AI use that maybe you have a list of? Okay, you can use AI for this or don't use AI for that.

Interviewee13: No. I can use AI for everything. If it makes my work go faster or more. We use AI as long as we need it, as much as we need it. There's no guidelines or rules about using it.

Interviewer: Do you maybe have your personal unwritten rules you follow when you decide to use AI and you decide it is safe for your work data to use it?

Interviewee13: No, not really. I really want to give you a longer answer, but there's no longer answer. No.

Interviewer: Have there been maybe a situation where AI use felt maybe unclear or uncomfortable to talk about at work or within a client?

Interviewee13: No. Also no. I think four years ago when AI was the new thing, I think it was more embarrassing to say that we use AI. But now it's not embarrassing. In corporate life, no.

Interviewer: As you mentioned, four years ago AI was like a new thing. Over the five years, and practices around it change from four years ago to now. Can you maybe comment on how they changed and maybe what triggered these changes?

Interviewee13: Well, for example, AI for an artist back then — to use AI was saying that you're not good enough. So AI is doing the thing. Because when I started using AI and shareholders were like, oh my God, this picture is amazing, how did you draw it? And I was embarrassed to tell them that, no, it wasn't me, the AI did it. But when everyone started — to be honest, the use of AI was the corporate idea because it will help us make the games faster. So use it, don't be embarrassed to use it. So we were like, okay, let's use AI. But before that, sometimes AI does work better to draw realistic things, and I kind of was really embarrassed to say that it wasn't me. But also, AI didn't draw well — it did draw more realistic things in a good way, but it still wasn't evolved as it is now, because sometimes it drew six fingers and sometimes the parts of it didn't have a logic. For example, if I want an apple, the leaf would be in the part of the apple that didn't make sense. But AI evolved and the perspective of other people also changed on using AI. People are more open to it right now.

Interviewer: As you mentioned, you were encouraged by your company to use AI and they can deliver good quality pictures and work, but sometimes it's not as good. I've received answers that sometimes companies do not care if the quality is as good and they push the AI picture still. Is this the case for you or how do you handle that?

Interviewee13: No, my company pushes me to use it, but it doesn't push me to give a low quality product. I still, as I mentioned, I still work on it after I use it because it still doesn't give me the polished look. So I'm the one who's polishing it to be a good quality game. I still use it, but at the end of the day, my main goal is to give a good quality product.

Interviewer: You already mentioned that you don't use AI for your personal project, but that personal project is not for your corporate company, but for someone, but also it's a paid project. Does your rule change for using AI or no?

Interviewee13: You know, if I really get stuck on something, then maybe I will use it. But I don't think that I will ever use AI on my personal work, even if it was for a big project, because I think my personal work has more soul. And that's why I'm doing it — because the one who hired me for this project needs something that I draw. He or she likes the way I draw. So I think there is no sense in me using AI because then it won't be the same.

Interviewer: Have you ever decided to opt out or not use a specific AI tool because of concerns about its legal status or how it uses data?

Interviewee13: No, because I usually use AI that is safe. I don't think in real life if it's safe or not, but I use what everyone uses. I use Google Gemini, I use ChatGPT, and I use Discord with Midjourney. That's the data that I use. And I think I will never know if they use my data or not. I mean, it's out of my hands. I will never know that. I don't worry about such things.

Interviewer: Do you have corporate AI incorporated in your work? Some companies have Copilot or even Google Gemini incorporated to their work and all of the information of their company fed to that AI. Do you have anything like that in your work?

Interviewee13: Yes

Interviewer: Do you feel it is helpful? Maybe because it has all of your data, does it give you better outputs than maybe Gemini or ChatGPT?

Interviewee13: To be honest, I think they still know my data and things that I like and things that I want, because when you talk to them, they just know you, right? So it doesn't make a lot of difference, to be honest. There is no difference. Every AI that I use, they all know me.

Interviewer: You discussed that you discuss AI use around your colleagues very freely and it's a safe space. But what about maybe your clients, whenever you maybe have an interaction with a client or you present a project to a client? Do you feel comfortable or safe enough that you will say, okay, this was partly done by AI but then refined by me?

Interviewee13: No, I don't feel embarrassed. I will say if I use AI. With clients on personal work, I don't think I will be embarrassed, because it's not embarrassing anymore. It's a tool that you use that makes your work easier

Interviewer: Did you have any situation where the client was like, okay, don't use AI on this?

Interviewee13: No, I didn't have this experience. But I think if someone hired me for my personal work, I do think that they would have a problem with me using AI. And I would also have a problem with me using AI.

Interviewer: How do you determine if you have enough personal ownership of a piece of work when you put your name on it after using AI in your corporate world? because you don't use it for your personal.

Interviewee13: Yes. I feel this ownership because I do a lot of work after it gives me the drawing or something. I mean, it's not the same. I still make the difference. Without me, it wouldn't be polished. It wouldn't be done. So

I don't feel like I don't have ownership over something that I do, even if it's AI.

Interviewer: If you had a situation that AI provided the core idea of the project, it started and then you performed all of the refinements. Who do you feel at the end owns the result then?

Interviewee13: I think it's more of a collaboration, but I still think I am there because even AI won't do anything if I won't give it an idea, the prompt, and still the creative thing happens here and not in there. So AI just gives me a concept look of what I'm thinking. So I still think that the main idea still comes from me.

Interviewer: Have you ever felt that using AI for a specific task made you feel separated from your craft or maybe your skills were degrading a bit because you use AI?

Interviewee13: Sometimes. It happens sometimes. I felt it. But after time you get used to it. It's not degrading. You are just doing your job. You get used to it, you don't look at it as downgrading. It's I'm the architect and AI is just the worker. It just helps me to get it done, to put brick by brick as a worker.

Interviewer: Since you are a more experienced professional and you had experience working in the world where AI was not introduced and you refined your skills during that, and now you use AI as a tool. How do you feel when for junior people, new people who come into this world, will AI be more of a helping hand and will not help them develop their skills better in a sense?

Interviewee13: I think it will happen the way you look at it. For example, I look at it as my helper and a tool. And I think the juniors should also look at it as a tool because it would really give — I mean, it also depends on what you are working on. Sometimes it helps. And as I said, for my personal work, I don't use AI. I also encourage artists to not always use AI and to work on themselves in their own way. But you can use AI as your teacher also. I think you should use AI in a healthy way. Not in a toxic way

Interviewer: How do you feel or think AI will change your professional life in the next five or ten years?

Interviewee13: To be honest, I don't know. I think the way I'm using it now, I will be using it also in ten years. If there is a task that I don't really feel connected to, of course, I will use AI and make it, do it for me. But if there will be something I'm interested in and it's more in a creative field, of course, I'm going to do it by myself. I really hope that in the future it will

also be like this — AI will just be the tool that I will use if I don't feel creative or myself.

Interviewer: Do you feel that maybe it will take over some of the jobs in the future?

Interviewee13: Yes, I think. But also it will take the jobs that are not creative. I really believe that and I see that because, for example, I have a lot of other artists on my social media and I always see their work. I really don't think that I could do such things that they do. That's a creative field that I don't think AI could replace. AI is replacing the basic things — as I said, the worker does, to put brick on brick. That's what AI does. AI will never be an architect. So I don't think it will replace the creativity that happens in creative minds.

Interviewer: You kind of have an overall idea what we are researching about. It's the decision making process behind what tasks to give to AI and formal versus informal rules. Do you feel like we covered all of the topics? Or are there any topics that you feel should be mentioned regarding AI use and how AI is around us?

Interviewee13: No, I think every question did all the work. Also, a lot of questions were kind of — I won't say the same, but I gave a lot of same answers to different questions. So I think the questions were good.

Interviewer: Thank you so much. It's the end of me on the questions. Thank you so much for taking the part in this interview.

Interviewee13: No problem. I hope I was helpful and my answers made sense

Interviewer: Your insights will be greatly used. Thank you

INTERVIEW 14

03/03/2026 | 39 Minutes | Accessibility Lead

Interviewer: Okay. I just want to inform you that the information you provide as well as company details will be completely anonymized. Also your participation is voluntary. You can stop the interview at any time. The interview will be recorded and transcribed, only used for academic purposes, and your identity will remain confidential. Do you consent to participate in the interview and being recorded?

Interviewee14: Yes, yes.

Interviewer: Let's get right to it then. Can you briefly describe your role and the kind of creative work that you do?

Interviewee14: Yes. I'm actually not sure how creative my work is. I guess some aspect of it are creative, is creative. My title is accessibility lead, and what that basically means is that I'm trying to define within my department, which is what we call group IT. It's the IT department of [Company]. What I'm doing here is I'm trying to define what standards we follow, what regulations to look out for. I also write guidelines for different roles. But there's also a technical side where right now I'm not doing much hands-on work besides me auditing applications, our websites, trying to see what the issue we did and doing a report that I send over to the development team. But before I used to develop myself and take care of the technical side of accessibility.

Interviewer: Okay. But in your area of work, what types of tools and technologies are central to your daily work?

Interviewee14: Yes. Of course we have Copilot at my company, but I'm not gonna lie that of course I use ChatGPT also sometimes, because I purchased the Pro premium subscription. What else. Very boring tools actually. PowerPoint, Excel, horrible. Figma not so much because I'm not really a designer, but FigJam I use to ideate or when I write my guidelines. I prefer to have everything in FigJam because it looks more fun and not so dry, like Microsoft Word or whatever.

Interviewer: Maybe can you walk me through a recent situation where you used generative AI or ChatGPT or anything?

Interviewee14: Yes. Ten minutes ago to answer an email. I mean I do use it a lot for emails. Please make this politically correct. Please make this sound more polite. How can I make this sound more pushy or more firm. So I usually have the message. I write the message and I need help with the tone. I think it really helps with this fine line of what is not too aggressive

but still firm. Firm and not rude at the same time. Formal enough but not too formal. What else. This is again ten minutes ago. But yesterday I actually used it to walk me through something in Excel. Let's say I want to do some stuff in Excel. I have these big spreadsheets and I want to use some data and do little charts and whatnot. I'm not too good at Excel because I've never used it and it's a very steep learning curve I feel. So I use it to guide me step by step, like completely step by step. Like okay click here, click there, you have to go there, in this sheet you do this. So I did this yesterday the whole day. So it's kind of like an assistant

Interviewer: Maybe you can also walk me through a time when you deliberately didn't decide to use AI, chose okay I have to do this myself.

Interviewee14: Yes. I would say it's more like when it comes to my work I never really decide not to use it. Of course if I'm going to put an email thread into ChatGPT, which is something I'm not really supposed to use, then I go through the thread and I remove the family names or take out anything sensitive, personal data. But I would say more in my personal life. When I am like okay I have some uncomfortable situation or I have some conflict with a friend or whatever and it happened that I need to reply to this message. And I'm like oh I can ask ChatGPT. And then I'm like okay I cannot do this. I cannot let it go to this point that I ask an AI agent to answer a friend.

Interviewer: Maybe in your work area, how do you decide when a task is too complex to be left to an AI tool, that AI cannot handle doing this?

Interviewee14: Well I don't. I always feel like it's a fact that it knows more than me. So for what I use it is to give me ideas or give me some pointers. I don't really feel like this is too complex of a task or a job to ask AI to do it. Maybe I'm more aware of the limitations of AI. Maybe I can give you an example. I work at this very big organization, so a lot of people work in silos. Sometimes you're in a meeting and it turns out that in another part of the organization someone is doing almost the exact same thing as you.When it comes to accessibility and testing websites and applications, there are very good automated tools. But they can catch maybe 40 percent of issues and the rest you have to manually check. Because I have to check with different browsers, use the screen reader and manually click through a site. There are things that I need to evaluate as a human. And even me as a human, I don't have a disability, so my judgment could also be wrong. Not to mention AI's judgment. And I was in this meeting and I hear that in another department they're working on this tool that can do audits. They

were claiming that this tool built with AI could test six out of eight applications only with this tool. They said they didn't need manual touch. And I was like I'm very skeptical with all due respect to you guys, but I really don't think that is possible. It's common sense, because if this would be possible today, it would already exist. A leader in this industry would have already created this tool and would be selling it. So I feel like I can still judge within my area what is feasible with AI and what is too ambitious and not really possible today.

Interviewer: Did you have the chance to check that AI tool that you mentioned are they as good as they described?

Interviewee14: Not yet. I'm going to have a meeting actually today in the afternoon to see the magical tool and try to go into this meeting with an open mind but also have the right questions.

Interviewer: Maybe once AI generates an output, what is your personal filter process for verifying it before you consider it ready? How do you review it and verify it before using it?

Interviewee14: To be really fair, sometimes I verify. I'm the verifier. Because for example when I do my audits there are so many success criteria, so sometimes I'm unsure. So I just go to ChatGPT and ask, is this scenario a violation of this criteria? And then it can say yes it is. But in fact if I really think about it I know that it's not really because I have the bigger picture. So I would say I am the one that verifies it. Probably I miss certain things because I feel like even if I google it you get an AI summary when you google. So it's like how do you even verify.

Interviewer: You mentioned that it sometimes gives you an incorrect answer. Maybe can you describe a time when an AI tool provided a hallucination or a flawed result, and then how did you adjust your workflow afterwards?

Interviewee14: Let me think. Oh yes, with the Excel sheets. Sometimes they think that I'm working on one sheet while in reality I'm working on another sheet. Then I'm like the way I adjust it is to be very honest with you sometimes I get very pissed and I'm like hello, we're not working on this sheet, we're working on this other sheet. So sometimes it turns into this angry conversation. I don't treat my AI agents well unfortunately. So I think if they ever gain consciousness or get a body I'm going to be the first to be targeted because I can get very frustrated. It's a good channel for me to ventilate a bit.

Interviewer: Whenever you deliver your work, how do you ensure that the AI-assisted results you deliver still align with the specific values or voice of your client?

Interviewee14: For example if I'm writing guidelines now for the social media team, what I did when I started to work on it I put in all the information. So all the writing guidelines of [Company Name], all the tools that they use, the limitations of their tools, all this information. Then I know that what is written is in line with the guidelines of [Company Name]. And I know that my agent has the whole picture and what tools we are talking about. So it doesn't freestyle and give advice that is not really relevant to my group of people.

Interviewer: Maybe if it's easier you can give a more concrete example, if you can disclose it

Interviewee14: Can you just repeat the question one more time?

Interviewer: How do you ensure that AI-assisted results still align with the specific values of your work and of your client?

Interviewee14: Well again I always try to do the first draft by myself. And I will prompt and review until I get the result that I'm happy with. For me it's a process and ultimately I only copy content out of the AI's output that I'm happy with. So it's just a gut feeling or my judgment.

Interviewer: Who do you feel is responsible for the final outcome when AI is involved in your work?

Interviewee14: I think it's me. I think it's me because maybe I'm just using a tool, but ultimately I decide to take the output and make thousands of people use it.

Interviewer: In the next part of the interview we'll talk more about formal versus informal rules in your company or in your daily work. Are there any formal rules or policies in your organization regarding AI use?

Interviewee14: To be very honest with you I think there are. Have I read them ever? Never. Never read them. Even in my previous company I've never read it. Because to be fair I know that it's more common sense. I know that I'm not supposed to put in personal data, sensitive information, and so on. So I try to avoid that. But I never really looked for the policy. I'm maybe not a good example. And to be fair I feel like even at this company and my previous company, which was also a big organization, I used to work at Ericsson. The tools that you get, the chatbots that these companies develop, they're just not good. Even if it's tied to their database and it should know everything. To give you an example, we have a chatbot that is a super assistant. Completely useless. I was looking for something very

basic which I knew exists in a document. It's a list of all the acronyms used in the company. I went to the chatbot and asked what this acronym means or give me a list of acronyms used at the company. It said sorry I have no information. So I had to go to the file myself and find the information. So yes, I'm not really using any AI features of my company.

Interviewer: What maybe unwritten rules, you mentioned some like data protection? Maybe you can expand on that, that what unwritten rules do you follow to decide if a new AI tool is safe to for your work?

Interviewee14: To be honest with you, I'm think I'm not a good example I like to stick to what I already know. So when ChatGPT first came out as like, This is it, This is my tool, and I've been using it ever since. Like, I'm not saying I haven't tried like, Gemini, or Copilot, because I have access to but I'm not like a big I'm not experimenting a lot, and I still feel like, for me, ChatGPT is kind of like, maybe I'm wrong, this is my judgment. But since it was the first AI agent that came out, I still have this picture in my head that this is the best and there's no point of me experimenting with anything. So that's why I cannot really tell you about how I judgem new AI tools, becuse I don't.

Interviewer: Do you have other unwritten rules that, when you feed something to to AI, that okay, I should not give this information, or I shouldn't do let AI do this work, besides, like, data protection and anything like that.

Interviewee14: Let me think. I don't give it files for example. But I don't give it files because I know that it's very bad at reading files or writing anything in a file. You cannot do calculations in Excel and then get back a perfect file for you, so dont' do that. So it's more because it's not capable of doing it. Not because I wouldn't do it. The only real thing is sensitive data, personal data. But what I work with is not really sensitive. I don't work in finance or I don't work in HR. So I don't have to deal with a lot of sensitive data.

Interviewer: So, you don't have a big filter process.

Interviewee14: No, no, maybe I should, but. I don't. I don't. I must say, I don't.

Interviewer: Have there been situations where AI use felt unclear or uncomfortable to talk about at work?

Interviewee14: When I felt uncomfortable to talk about AI?

Interviewer: Yes, as you mentioned, that the chatbots at your workplace is bad, I would assume everybody, or majorities, thinks that. And have you felt uncomfortable to talk that maybe you use other AI tools besides the ones you have implemented, or even talk about your your own,

like, maybe talk about, like, have you talked about your own and say that how bad it is and how you

Interviewee14: So I did, but I think I did mostly in a safe space, you know, with like-minded people, my colleagues that I know share my opinion. I also got to know that whatever input I put into our chatbot in the company, they have access to, they see it. So I mean, I again never used it for anything sensitive, other than work related and very basic questions. But since I know this, I feel very unempowered, because I'm like, okay, they see my input. So a lot of times I write useless thank you for nothing. I'm trying to send the message that this is not working. When I feel uncomfortable, it's not really uncomfortable. It's more that I feel that AI these days is a bit like lipstick on a pig, you know. We cannot even build software that is accessible, that is usable, that is good quality, and then let's put AI on it. What are we doing, you know? And you cannot say this to your management, like I think this is bullshit and we should just build good software first before we put AI on it. And even with simple things, you know, we have a database where you can search for all the applications that are used in the company. And this database tool has a filter which is powered by AI. That is fantastic, most useless thing ever again. So it's like we do it, but we don't do it properly, you know. Yes. So my frustration mostly comes from this, that I feel we just have to use AI because every other company uses AI and that's what sells these days. And I'd like to point this out or be more vocal about it, but you can't always do that.

Interviewer: How about the tools that, for example, ChatGPT, do you talk? Talk about that. Maybe you used ChatGPT to fine tune this work or anything like that. Do you feel comfortable of talking about?

Interviewee14: I'm not. I never said I use ChatGPT Because I know that it's not approved in my company. So yes, I tell these two colleagues or people that I trust, you know, but I would not tell this to my manager. However, I think he also does it. So it's like, I think we all do, you know, but I just make sure I say copilot. But I feel like people are very open about saying, like, Oh, I did this with copilot,

Interviewer: Because copilot is, like, integrated in your work. Is it, wherever you fit to copilot? Does it stay anonymous in a way? Do they have access? If you know,

Interviewee14: I don't know. I hope they do. But again, I never, I don't, I don't write anything personally to Copilot. Like, I really keep, keep it separate, like, separate work from separate everything, because I don't trust large corporations.

Interviewer: Since AI is, like a very big subject right now everywhere, and it's has been like, maybe for like five years this big. Have you noticed any changes, like throughout the years, from when it first was introduced, and then now have the practices of using AI changed over time, and maybe what triggered those changes?

Interviewee14: I feel like, which I guess is like a natural part of any new technology and how it evolves. I feel that we are more open about using AI? I think in the early stages, we were very, shy about using AI, or we wanted to, if we wrote text with AI, we did everything not to make it look like it's written by AI, you know, remove like certain words or certain like, apostrophes or not apostrophes, like there and mdash and whatever, like these things, you know, but I feel like now we're much more like it's part of our life, and it's we all do it. What was the question again?

Interviewer: Have you noticed? Like, how the practices around AI use changed, and maybe what triggered those changes?

Interviewee14: Yeah, we're more open about it, because I think now it's like, really it has become part of our life. Yeah, this is what comes to my mind. Maybe

Interviewer: In you work environment, do you discuss AI use rules or boundaries with colleagues or clients as well?

Interviewee14: I mean, we, I guess we do discuss it casually. I cannot recall a specific conversation. What I see happening, or I noticed that if we do some kind of ideation or whatever, and if someone shares something they say, like, oh, this. I just did this with Copilot to see, like, to get an idea, you know, so,

Interviewer: Now we are more talking about like authorship owner and trusting. AI, how do you determine if you have like, personal ownership over a piece of work to put your name on it after using AI.

Interviewee14: I'm not sure I understand the question exactly.

Interviewer: For example, for people of creative work, whenever they maybe use AI on a piece of, I know, a design or graphic design, how, how comfortable they feel like, if they use 50% of AI to do something, how they feel that they own it at the end, whenever it was like 50% AI, 50% them, or like similar.

Interviewee14: I feel. Yeah, yeah, I think it's for me. It's more like, if it's like, let's say I do a lot of guidelines and this type of things or trainings, and then I feel like, if I read the content and it resonates, you know, it feels like, Yes, this is my voice, and this is how I would write this. And these are words I would use, because, again, I try to not use words that I don't know

or I don't have in my vocabulary, or at least I don't look up and see like, oh yeah, this makes sense here. Yes. I need to double check. I really need to make sure that this sounds like me, and I need to read every single part of it and reread again and be like, okay, this resonates and this is my content. Does it make sense?

Interviewer: Yes, it makes sense. If maybe in the case when AI provided the core ideas but she performed all of the refinement, who do you feel owns the results still?

Interviewee14: Me. I feel like I do, because I feel like AI is only as good as I am, what I put in it and how I guide it. So ultimately it's my brainchild to a certain extent. But of course I feel like everything these days you can put to everything that, oh, powered by AI. Every single email I could put a little thing that this is powered by AI, even if I know that this email doesn't make sense or it's not important or it's just a very casual thing. I like to double, triple check the grammar with AI because English is not my first language, and I don't know, it's maybe also my OCD or my perfectionism. I need to make sure that it's properly written.

Interviewer: Have you ever felt that using AI for a specific task made you feel separated from your work or your skills were degrading?

Interviewee14: That it degrades my skill? Yes, absolutely. I think now, in my previous job, I was more in a hybrid role. I was working with accessibility, but I was also writing code hands-on. Now I'm only working with accessibility. I'm more with strategy and governance and these type of things. But when I was developing, I remember that when AI came out it really, really reduced the amount of effort I put into thinking. So you do get lazy, very lazy. You get very used to it. So in that way, yes. And I do feel like I don't think it's going to take jobs or whatever. However, I do think that if I would have to start as a junior front-end developer today, I don't know if I could get a job. I don't know how people do it. I think it's very difficult because I remember that the tasks I used to do as a junior, six years ago at my small digital agency, were things that AI does in two seconds. So yes, it makes you lazy.

Interviewer: When delivering a project, how do you decide whether or not to mention the AI's involvement to maybe your clients or your colleagues?

Interviewee14: I don't. You don't really mention it, because I feel like it's such an obvious fact. I mean, I hope they don't think that everything is written by me by my hands. Also we work with such a high pace now. If I would have to sit and write pages and pages and pages of guidelines

to a certain group of people, that would take me weeks and weeks. Even now it takes weeks with all the iterations and all the things we have with the stakeholders. But it could take months if I would have to sit down and write and do my research and read articles on Google, then come back and try to rephrase it or reference. So I'm just hoping we're all aware of everyone using AI.

Interviewer: Yes. This was it on my end. Maybe you kind of have the idea of what we are researching. Maybe you have any comments or topics we haven't discussed and you think are important to be mentioned. Is there something you are missing?

Interviewee14: I don't know, Is there something you are missing?

Interviewer: No, on my end no. From your personal perspective

Interviewee14: Was this detailed enough?

Interviewer: No, it was really detailed. Thank you so much. Maybe do you feel there is any topic, the decision process behind what tasks to delegate to AI, formal versus informal rules, and authorship of it all at the end?

Interviewee14: No, I think I said what I wanted to say. Just as a closing thought, I think that we do use AI almost for everything. Maybe there are people out there that are better than me and they really try to force themselves not to rely on it so much. But me personally, at this point it feels like a third leg. A 24/7 assistant for me to ask anything and to know that it's there for me.

Interviewer: Yes, that's it. Thank you so much for taking the time and doing this.

Interviewee14: Thank you. I don't know what is going to be the outcome or the result, if I can see it.

Interviewer: We will write a thesis, esearch paper and the result will be discussed there. If you would like, we can send it to you

Interviewee14: when you defend your thesis yes okay well but these things are broadcasted online. All right, my friend did uh my thesis with kth and i remember she invited us to watch it

Interviewer: I'm not sure, to be honest.

Interviewee14: Anyway, if there's anything to share, please share. I'm curious to read the result. And yes, I hope this helped and I wish you good luck.

Interviewer: Thank you so much once again.

Interviewee14: Thank you. Have a good day.

INTERVIEW 15

03/05/2026 | 29 Minutes | Animator

Interviewer: Hi [Interviewee15's Name], thank you for doing this. Before we start, I just want to say to you that the information you provide, as well as company details, will be completely anonymized. Also, your participation is voluntary. You can stop the interview at any time. The interview will be recorded and transcribed, only used for academic purposes, and your identity will remain confidential. Do you consent to participate in this interview and being recorded?

Interviewee15: Yes

Interviewer: Thank you. Can you briefly describe your role and the kind of creative work that you do?

Interviewee15: I'm the animator and I work in a gaming company, so I do animations for slots and mix games and so on. After designers provide designs, then I have to make animations.

Interviewer: What types of tools or technologies are central for your work?

Interviewee15: Before AI, we used to work in a program called Spine2D, and we had to animate it frame by frame and so on. Now, sometimes we try to make our work easier and faster by using Kling AI, which does not 100% work, I guess, because I don't know, maybe in the future it will work better. But right now, it's not going to make it as easy as it seems from afar. You have to edit it so many times and so on, and you don't have much access.

Interviewer: Maybe can you walk me through a recent situation where you used generative AI?

Interviewee15: There was a game where we had to animate the tiger, which had so many poses. It had idle when it was just standing and waiting, and then it had to have emotions. It had to be happy and sometimes mad and sometimes angry and sometimes sad. The AI does not quite understand what you need anyway. After we generated the happy pose and angry and so on, then it would not make one full animation out of it. It was parts which you could not add after one another. Then we had to add extra effects and lights and stuff like that to make it work. Also, it's not that creative. When you want to animate, when you're not using the AI, you have to think what would the animal do, and you have to read and you have to watch videos to see how they react and what kind of moves they have. In AI, you just have to type something and whatever it does, it does. You don't really participate in making it.

Interviewer: Was there any recent situation where you decided not to use AI, you deliberately avoided it?

Interviewee15: Yes, when I have time. It still makes something a little faster, but not cooler at all. Sometimes, when I have time, I always enjoy making it frame by frame again because I love what I do. It's as if everybody can just sit and type the script, one sentence of "make this tiger angry" or something. But I still believe that if I do it by my hand, frame by frame, it will be cooler at this point. I don't know what will be in the future, but right now it is what it is.

Interviewer: How do you decide which tasks are appropriate to delegate to AI and which are not?

Interviewee15: I only decide it by time, how the deadlines are tight or not. When deadlines are really tight, then I try to make it easier and make little tasks used by AI, if I have to rotate something or something easy like that. But in huge animations, it's not working. Besides, if you love what I do, you still prefer to do it by yourself, if you know what I mean.

Interviewer: By huge animations, do you mean the tiger example, giving different emotions to the animal?

Interviewee15: Yes, yes. It will be much cooler if we had enough time to do it by hand, everything by hand, and it will be smoother and cooler. But it is what it is. Now we have so many effects and lights to hide those bad things that AI did.

Interviewer: Once AI generates an output, what is your personal filter process to verify that it is ready to be used?

Interviewee15: I don't know. When the other people confirm that it [the AI output] looks good, then I have to download it, then I have to take it in AfterEffects and erase the backgrounds and stuff like that. I mean, it still has a lot of work. After you confirm that this is good, what AI did, then you still have lots of work. So when someone says that we will be replaced by AI and animators won't be needed, I don't agree. No, never.

Interviewer: Maybe can you describe a time when an AI tool provided a hallucination or an extremely flawed result?

Interviewee15: Yes, it happens all the time. It happens all the time. You have to rewrite the same sentence sometimes and wait and wait and wait, and one out of ten maybe works. It happens all the time. It does not understand the brief quite as you want results to be. So I don't know how it is for designers, and they use it when some people who paint in our company, they actually use it a lot, but still then they have to do by hand

some stuff. I mean, we are not replaced and it's not making it as easier as it seems from far away, I guess

Interviewer: How do you ensure that the AI-assisted results you deliver still align with the specific values or voice of your client?

Interviewee15: Oh, I don't quite get the question. Sorry. What do you mean?

Interviewer: Whatever the views of a client are, and your signature or the voice of your work, how do you make sure that whatever AI helped you produce still corresponds to your voice or the voice of a client?

Interviewee15: Yes, there is no way to get it until you try so many versions, I guess. The only way is that you try many times and some of them work. We did that on this recent project which I did not finish yet. There were hundreds of versions of Happy Tiger, and then they chose one. They said it's not quite what we wanted, but because we don't have time, let's leave this. But when you do it by your hand, you have so many options to change little details. AI-generated results will not give you those access to details, which is very important in animation.

Interviewer: In your personal opinion, whenever you say you had hundreds of versions of a Happy Tiger and it is time-consuming, would it have been quicker if you had done it from scratch?

Interviewee15: No, still no, because it's so much easier to try hundreds of versions by only entering the same sentence and it provides you versions. But when you have to do it frame by frame, it takes lots of time. Also, the artist enjoys it a lot, I guess.

Interviewer: Who do you feel is responsible for the final outcome when AI is involved?

Interviewee15: Still the artist, I guess. Because when something comes under your name, then you care it to be cool. You try to work a lot on it after generating the video. Then you have to do a lot of work to make it look cool. Because it still says that you did it, then you care how it looks. In my case, it's like that.

Interviewer: Now we're going to talk more about formal and informal rules within your company and yourself. Are there any formal rules or policies in your organization that you must follow regarding AI use?

Interviewee15: No, not really. Not that I know.

Interviewer: Do you have any like unwritten rules for yourself that you must follow that, okay, I will use AI for this, but for this specific task, I will not?

Interviewee15: No. When something is my personal project outside my work, for example 3D videos that I work on, when I sit and do something for myself to enjoy, I never use it. Of course, I enjoy doing it myself and testing many things and physics and stuff in 3D. The program that I use is Cinema 4D. I think it is irreplaceable by AI because I enjoy testing things there. In my personal work, something that I share on my page to talk to clients and so on, I never use AI. Because when artists create something, you can feel who did it. Everybody has their own soul. When you do it by AI, you cannot distinguish who did it. It's all the same. It does not matter who writes the script.

Interviewer: You don't have those unwritten rules in your corporate environment?

Interviewee15: No, we don't.

Interviewer: Are there any regulations about data use or personal privacy regarding animation work?

Interviewee15: We cannot share our work anywhere outside the websites that our company has. I do not have permission to use those animations in my personal resume, CV, or portfolio. Besides that, nothing. I don't think there is anything else.

Interviewer: Do you personally have any habits or unwritten guidelines when using AI?

Interviewee15: No, not really. I'm only oriented on the results I get and how fast it works. That's okay. I don't have expectations. I'm not in love with it yet. I don't really enjoy it.

Interviewer: AI has been around maybe five years. From year one to now, it's developed a lot and can do much more. Do you notice any major changes over time that happened over maybe these five years, and maybe what triggered those changes regarding AI and its place in our work?

Interviewee15: don't know exactly what big changes, but recently people think you can do everything by yourself. I mean, some people think that you don't need a designer, you don't need a painter, you don't need an animator. You can replace everybody by AI, but I don't think that will happen ever. Even if the AI will get faster and better, and even if it gives us better results, still there will be people like us very much needed, I think. Someone who will end this generated video and make it prettier and so on.

Interviewer: I've heard from other interviewers that whenever clients receive their project or whatever, it's AI generated and the quality is not good, but because this is so much cheaper and quicker they still accept it or use it for the future. What is your opinion about that?

Interviewee15: Of course, I don't like it because it's killing really cool artists. I met someone who drew Simba the Lion King and stuff like that, and he's a really huge artist. He said the same: this profession won't go if we won't let it go. I mean, if some people, for someone who has no passion for this profession and they only decide to just generate videos, and there are some people who really love what they do in frame by frame and so on. Of course there will be huge difference in quality and in everything, because still when someone does it by themselves and when someone enjoys doing this video, of course it will be always cooler, much cooler. So the clients, I don't like it when they prefer something cheaper, because someone who does that puts a lot of effort in it and it cannot be cheap. It just can't be cheap because it takes lots of work and lots of thinking and searching some stuff and trying, and it takes so much time and effort, and it just can't be cheap. Of course cheap won't be cool, at least.

Interviewer: Do you have a situation where in your corporate world clients ask you not to use AI or to use AI, deliberately use AI? Have there been any situations?

Interviewee15: Yes, in creative agencies when they think of something, the brief, they only use AI for reference, to show someone that this is reference. Do you like it? And then they make it by hand, because I mean you can easily distinguish when something is generated or handmade. And I really still hope that handmade stuff will get more priced than it is today. And in music too, in music industry, I think AI killed it, just simply killed it. No one does anything anymore.

Interviewer: Do you sometimes feel like you have to, maybe a few years ago or even now, that you have to not mention that AI was used in creating this work when you're delivering the project to the clients?

Interviewee15: I don't hear anymore, It's noisy.

Interviewer: Can you hear me now?

Interviewee15: Yes, but the mic is making noises and I don't quite understand.

Interviewer: Is it better maybe now?

Interviewee15: Not really, but I'll try to understand

Interviewer: I'll try to speak slower maybe. Okay. Have you ever decided not to mention that AI was used in your final project when delivering it to the client?

Interviewee15: No, no, never, never. If I use it, I always say that it's generated. This is what I think, always.

Interviewer: Have you ever decided not to use a specific AI tool because of concern about how it's training data or legal status of that specific tool?

Interviewee15: No, not really. It can get better. I don't have any problems with that [training data]. If it helps to solve problems and if it will be cooler in the future, I don't know, it would happen anyways, I guess. We have to adapt to it. It doesn't mean that I like it and it doesn't mean that it's cool, but I think we have to. This is why I started using AI actually, because I had no choice. You use it or you will just be slower than others. But still in personal works I have so much time that when I do something I don't have deadlines, that I can finish in one month or ten months, and then I don't use AI. But in work, I mean you have to adapt. People use it, then you have to find some way to use it. I think so.

Interviewer: Do you discuss AI rules within your colleagues or even clients? Do clients say that use AI on this or don't use AI on this?

Interviewee15: No, not really. No. I decided to use it in the process.

Interviewer: How do you determine if you have enough personal ownership over a piece of work that you put your name on it after using AI?

Interviewee15: If I fully make it in AI, then I will not have that sense. But still, when I use it, I don't have it. It's not mine. It feels like it's not mine. I don't love it as much as something that I create on my own.

Interviewer: So if AI is used in the project, you don't feel comfortable putting your name on it?

Interviewee15: Yes. I don't know. It's really uncomfortable. And I would say that this is generated. I would always describe it as generated. But not uncomfortable, because we don't really have a choice. It will be used a lot, I guess.

Interviewer: I don't know if it happens in your profession, but if AI provides the core idea but you perform the refinements afterwards, who do you feel owns the result?

Interviewee15: I would just say that something that it sticks together by many works that someone else did and uploaded and stuff like that. It [AI] does not just create something. It just puts so many works together. So whoever did it, they own it, I guess. It's not me, definitely. Because everybody can just write their one sentence in English language that speaks this, and anybody can do that. But to make something out of it, then after you get something generated and then you have to work a lot on it, then maybe you need good animators. I don't know, because it's not quite helping yet. It only helps on details, as I said.

Interviewer: Have you ever felt that using AI for a specific task made you feel separated from your work or that your skills were degrading?

Interviewee15: Yes, it does, actually. I don't know. I have not really thought about it. It separates you because you don't have as much power on it. If you want to change something, you just can't. Then you think other ways with effects and lights, as I said about the tiger game. Then you have to think other ways to hide those effects, or whatever it's called, those bad things, bad stuff. You don't really have so much power to change details. And animation is little details. It is what makes your work cooler than other works. Little details. And if you are oriented on little details, then you're cool. But it's not like that. It's not a huge picture. It makes something a little faster, but not cooler.

Interviewer: How do you think AI will change your profession maybe in the next five to ten years? Do you feel it changing that much?

Interviewee15: I don't know actually if it changes. Because I think as the time will pass, handmade stuff will be more priced and it will be cooler. And the artist who does everything by themselves and not using AI will be even cooler. I think so. But I don't know. It depends on companies. My company does not really care if some animations will be so cool or something, because it's notorious about it. It's a big product. It's to be cool at the end of the day and it has to be small in sizes and stuff like that. But when someone does commercial, for example, or animation like cartoon movie or something, of course then I think they won't be using that much AI. And handmade stuff will get cooler, I guess so, just like it was earlier.

Interviewer: How do you feel, you've been in this industry for a while and you've been working before AI and after AI. How do you feel when a junior position in your role will come into this industry? Will their skills be as good as it would have been if they were doing everything from scratch? Or with the help of AI could they become good animators?

Interviewee15: Actually it's a good question, because I think it depends on whatever will be produced in the future. If someone will only know how to generate something and then they will need to change a little stuff or something, then they won't be able to do that. But I'm very skilled, because when I started doing this there really was not AI involved in anything and I did everything by myself. So I can find many more solutions than they can, I guess. But it depends whatever briefs will be. Maybe someone won't care about animation that much and priorities will be only time. And of course someone who works like that all the time will do something faster. But I don't think that it will be cooler. My work will always have soul, because I

have passion for this profession. And when I do something, I enjoy it a lot. And when you look at that, you will get that feeling. But when someone generates it, I don't know how can you enjoy it as much as I do. I just don't get it.

Interviewer: So what roles do you think humans should always keep in the creative process?

Interviewee15: I don't know. Maybe this creative process from scratch, just when you sit and when you talk to someone about these ideas and solutions and stuff like that. I don't think that we need to keep just sitting in front of computer and type versions. Because when you talk to other artists and share something with them and ask questions and stuff like that, you understand so many cool stuff and you discover some things that you have not imagined before. And this creative process, I think it should stay definitely. Yes.

Interviewer: It's almost all of my questions. One last thing. You kind of have the sense of what we're researching about. It's the decision process behind what tasks to give AI, formal versus informal rules, and how to navigate the questions regarding the authorship whenever AI is used in the creative process. Do you feel that we covered every important topic in this interview, or do you feel something should be mentioned and included in the research? Maybe your last comment.

Interviewee15: No, we almost talked about everything. Just music industry is a very good example for me, because I think that AI really killed it. Because no one does music and everybody just opens the laptop and puts the samples one after another, and it does not give you any feeling. And I don't want the same to happen to the painters and to the animators. I want us to keep our work. I mean, we have to adapt, we have to use AI, but still I don't want it to kill this whole creative process. I want it to stay the way it is right now. If it will make our work easier, okay, use it. But still there should be some stuff left that is handmade, because it's still so much cooler than generated.

Interviewer: So it should stay as an assistant, not as a maker from scratch.

Interviewee15: Yes, yes, yes. This is what I wish. Let's see.

Interviewer: Do you feel it might change in the future, or is it changing?

Interviewee15: I think that when it was COVID and Meta was activated and stuff like that, people were more interested in it. But I think that they were more interested in it, but not lately, I guess so. Because it did not give as much as they were expecting, maybe, or I don't know. But when there

was COVID, I remember that everyone was talking about AI and about generating stuff. And everyone thought that they could be a graphic designer now. And everyone started generating and started uploading and stuff like that. But then those people lost interest and they went back to their professions. And some people stayed.

Interviewer: Thank you so much for your insights. It will be very helpful for our research. Thank you for taking the time.

Interviewee15: Thank you so much.

INTERVIEW 16

03/10/2026 | 33 Minutes | UI/UX Designer

Interviewer: Hi! Thank you for agreeing to do this and taking the time out of your schedule. I just want to inform you that the information you provide as well as company details will be completely anonymized. Also, your participation is voluntary. You can stop the interview at any time. The interview will be recorded and transcribed only used for academic purposes and your identity will remain confidential. Do you consent to participate in this interview and being recorded?

Interviewee16: Sure, sure, and happy to help

Interviewer: Can you briefly describe your role and the kind of creative work that you do?

Interviewee16: So I'm a UI UX designer and my job is to create digital interfaces that are easy for people to use. Basically, it's not about making things look pretty, and it's about the oral experience and finding ways to solve user problems. And when it comes to AI, I use it as a helpful tool in my process. It helps me to speed up my routine tasks, organizing information, generating texts, doing initial design research, or optimizing design systems. And overall it's a huge time saver in my creative work.

Interviewer: Can you maybe walk me through what types of technologies or tools are central for your daily work?

Interviewee16: I've used different tools but lately Figma has become my main one. I used to jump between different ones, and Figma tends to be flexible and easy to use, and I do almost everything there now actually. So there are times when I need some other software — traditionally I worked on Photoshop or Illustrator for complex graphics and detailed illustrations, but it happens quite rarely lately. Figma is quite good at prototyping as well, because of that I hardly ever need any extra tools honestly in my workflow, and it's more than enough for both building and design and showing others how it's supposed to work.

Interviewer: Can you maybe walk me through a recent situation where you used or deliberately avoided using generative AI?

Interviewee16: So I mostly use it to generate texts, which makes the design feel more real, and I will just ask AI to write actual texts adapted to a specific audience instead of just using generic placeholders. I also use it to generate unique images to bring the design to life. I intentionally stay away from AI only when I'm working on the page structure and visual layout. So that part I think is not good because it does always standardize some things

and I always prefer to build the initial skeleton and the core idea myself, so it can iterate on my idea and not give me just a standard template. For inspiration I also check out other creative platforms, always work from real designers, and I also find much more interesting solutions there than what AI could offer in many cases.

Interviewer: How do you decide which tasks are appropriate to delegate to gen AI and which are not?

Interviewee16: I would say it's simple for me. I let AI do the heavy grunt work just to save time, and so I keep all the parts that require thinking things through, the strategic design, all of that.

Interviewer: Maybe can you elaborate on the grunt work?

Interviewee16: As I mentioned, generating the texts, generating the standard pages and placeholders, which are mostly in templates just blank or some random words. So it's much better to have something realistic that is relevant for the specific situation and audience, and it also helps you imagine the whole design much better.

Interviewer: Once AI generates an output, what is your personal filter process to verify it before you consider it ready? How do you review it or verify it before using it?

Interviewee16: Personally, at least for now, I think that the output that I get from AI is never a finished product, and my years of experience in this field are what really help me filter out the bad advice from the good. There are times when I'm stuck for ideas and AI can give me a spark where I can go, hey, this is actually a good point, and I can start to work much more effectively if I get that spark. But the main issue is still that AI doesn't understand the unique character of the specific brand I'm representing and I'm working on, so it often gives suggestions but they just do not fit the project. So I would say getting the context into the AI as much as you can helps it to become a more polished product, but I would still never view AI's output as a finished product. So I would have to refine it, contextualize it within my context, and make sure that it's right for my specific audience and purpose.

Interviewer: Can you describe a time when an AI tool provided maybe a "hallucination" or a flawed result? How did you maybe adjust your workflow according to that?

Interviewee16: So initially when I was using it and the tools weren't so developed, it happened a lot and I also got discouraged at some point to use them for a while. But then it got better and I also got better in providing more context. These instances have been much less frequent in specific

cases. So as I said, I always check the outputs AI gives me, so in case it happened I would just prompt it with new context which would help it to understand what the problem was and give back an improved answer. So it just added some extra steps but nothing that produced any problem.

Interviewer: How do you ensure that the AI-assisted results you deliver still align with the specific values or maybe voice of your client?

Interviewee16: I think every client is the same for AI unless you give it detailed context about the client, which in many cases is not possible because of some confidentiality issues. And so this is why I try to explain the specific personality and get the answers that actually make sense. And just to clarify again, I never use the output as it is, I always refine on it and get it tailored for each specific client.

Interviewer: So you use whatever it gives you and then you apply the voice of the client afterwards?

Interviewee16: So it depends on how much context I can give about the client. It's a mix. In the beginning I can give some tips about the personality of the client and it can make some adjustments, but it's never enough. So once it gives me the output I also add the voice of the client myself.

Interviewer: How do you feel, at the end, who is responsible for the final outcome when AI is involved in your work?

Interviewee16: I would say 100 percent me. I view AI as just another tool, like Photoshop, Illustrator, and any other tool that has existed so far. It just helps you get things done much faster than before. AI, I would say for now at least, it's not at a level that you can just give it an entire project and let it do it. It's still just a tool that you use and you speed up your work.

Interviewer: Now we're going to move on to more different subjects, for example formal versus informal rules in your organization or maybe to yourself. First let's start with formal rules. Are there any formal rules or policies in your organization regarding AI use?

Interviewee16: No, not really honestly. We haven't yet seen the need — the organization hasn't seen the need to establish this type of formal rules yet. And just some unwritten rules that we have within the organization, it's not communicated through the management or anything, but as we discuss about these issues we all say that we should just never copy paste — not only as a designer myself but all the other people in the company use it — and no one should treat its final output as it is without reviewing. So that's the main thing that we have. And I wouldn't say that it is at the point, in terms of UI/UX for sure, where we need a set of rules, because I don't see any risky way to use AI given that you review its work. Of course, one thing

that's not so obvious that it doesn't need to have a rule is that you shouldn't put sensitive client information into it, and myself I never use real data. If I need to fill the layouts with something I use some placeholders, so I don't upload real data to it.

Interviewer: As you mentioned, policies are absent or unclear. How do you navigate that uncertainty, if you can call that uncertainty?

Interviewee16: I wouldn't say it's uncertainty. I would say there is just no need to have strictly defined rules about it. I would say my colleagues and I also have the same understanding, so it's not like I have my own set of rules that I'm adhering to and some other colleagues are using it to copy paste. No, it's a company culture and understanding we have — it's just a tool, we use it to speed up our work, we are responsible for the output, everything that I've been saying. But it doesn't actually create any uncertainty.

Interviewer: As you mentioned that you should not give personal private details to AI, do you have any other unwritten rules that you follow whenever you decide to follow, and if any new AI tool is safe to work with?

Interviewee16: Yeah, let me think about something that I haven't said yet. Some things that maybe I go the extra mile on, but maybe that's just me. Sometimes when I upload some screenshots that I need to give to it, I use blurring techniques to blur a brand name or logo if I don't want the AI to see it, and in most cases I don't. So that's something that maybe some other people wouldn't be doing, but I prefer to be safe with my data and sensitive information.

Interviewer: Do you follow any personal rules or maybe habits when using AI besides that?

Interviewee16: Just trying to imagine some other instances that I've been using AI. I would just say in terms of creativity, I've seen myself a lot of times where I'm stuck, and just some chit-chatting with AI and going back and forth about something could unlock my mind. And it's become a habit in a sense that it makes it easier to start a project. Instead of starting there and having a one hour thinking session, you start it with just one simple message to AI, and so it's more easy to get into the creative state when you go back and forth with AI because it's your thinking companion. So I think that's a new workflow that I have acquired since the AI tools proliferated — that I can just talk to it, suggest some ideas, and see, first of all, unlock my own stuck mind in many cases, but in other cases it could also provide some direction to go to.

Interviewer: Since AI is so, as you mentioned, used between your colleagues all around the organization, have there been any situations where AI use felt unclear or uncomfortable to talk about in your work?

Interviewee16: I wouldn't say it's uncomfortable. We are quite open in our workplace. We don't have a need to hide that we're using AI or something. As I said, we use it as a tool, not some cheating device that we can use and get our work done, because it's not still capable to do the job you have. And I would say it's interesting to sometimes share within each other how we have been using these things, but nothing uncomfortable.

Interviewer: Have these practices changed over time, and maybe what triggered those changes? Because AI has been actively around us for five years, but it's been developed before that. Five years is when the boom happened, I would say. Have you noticed any changes from the start to now?

Interviewee16: I would say I was a bit skeptical in the beginning, because of course it was interesting to see how it was behaving, but I didn't see any applications to my actual work in the beginning. So it was just a chatbot that you could talk to and speed up the Google search process, I would say. But as time passed by it became clear that it could be useful for my use cases as well, generating text, being your thought companion, and things like that. And after I realized that, maybe one key thing that has changed is the time that it has been saving me. So initially it wasn't saving much time honestly, because you needed to go so much back and forth to get exactly what you needed, or maybe have a half finished product that you still had to work a lot on instead of just reviewing and adding the specific elements. But more recently, I would say for 2025 and later in the year especially, and with Figma actively integrating the AI tools, it's been so much easier to use. Again, it's a habit already, so it's getting easier and easier to use every time, and I would say it's saving more time because it's gotten better and I now know better how to use it.

Interviewer: Have you ever decided to maybe opt out, not to use a specific AI tool because of concerns about its training data or legal status?

Interviewee16: Yeah, actually that happens just now, not in a professional setting, because I'm using ChatGPT, the most basic paid version, for my personal thing — to speed up my Googling process, to generate some images, things like that. And I've been quite not happy with the strategy that the company is applying right now, as they committed to become a new contractor of Pentagon, even though they are potentially asking for

surveillance of U.S. citizens. And I think the company is not taking seriously enough the dangers that AI might have in case it's not used properly. So I just switched to Claude this weekend. And I also have a Gemini assistant in-app for the free version. But professionally, as I said, I use Figma and I haven't had any frustration to opt out from it.

Interviewer: So it's a recent development. Before that you were using ChatGPT quite frequently, but because of these new contractual obligations that they have?

Interviewee16: Yeah, I've been looking at their strategy — they're all promising some things, and the GPT-5 model was also not a big enough improvement on GPT-4 to opt me out of it. But now it was a tipping point for me.

Interviewer: Do your personal rules for using AI change when you're working maybe on a personal project versus on a paid client project?

Interviewee16: No actually. I'm not trusting AI with my personal information as well. I would think about myself as a client for my own projects and I'm still protecting the client's privacy.

Interviewer: Do you discuss AI use rules or boundaries with colleagues or clients?

Interviewee16: It depends on the AI tool that I'm using at the time. And in general, we discuss the new versions that are coming, the new features that they have. And I would say that we're pretty aligned on the rules and boundaries, so it's not much of a discussion topic — more like new features and which tool is more effective at specific tasks and things like that that we're discussing.

Interviewer: Do you disclose when you deliver final work that AI was used, to your client?

Interviewee16: To the clients — as I said, it's just a professional tool that we use. When I do something in Photoshop, I don't have a disclaimer to my client saying that I did it in Photoshop, right? They don't care which tool was used to generate it as long as it's what they want. But I never hide the fact that I use it either. So in cases where it's relevant to say, of course I say it — I have said to my managers that I use it for routine tasks to speed up, everything that I discussed. But of course I could achieve the same results other ways, it would just take much longer. And there are some cases that there is no real point in highlighting the AI use, especially if it's saving one or two hours. But if there is a case where there was great involvement — maybe generating some photo that I really liked and I used in the final thing — I would highlight that. I remember one or two instances that I said, okay,

this was done by AI. But it's not a disclosure that I need to make, more just an exciting thing to share.

Interviewer: How do you determine if you have enough personal ownership over a piece of work to put your name on it after using AI?

Interviewee16: Again, the way I use AI, I would say I don't have that issue. I can proudly say that it's my work, just assisted by AI. Again, I wouldn't say that my design was made by me assisted by Photoshop four years ago. In the same way, I wouldn't say, oh, this was done by me and my AI tool. So I don't find it uncomfortable to say that it's my work. I'm not sure about the future — maybe the tool will become so good that it's able to claim authorship on some design products — but as of now I wouldn't say it's there yet, and I don't see it happening in the near term future as well.

Interviewer: When delivering a project, how do you decide whether or not to mention the tool's involvement to your client or colleagues? We kind of discussed about it already, maybe add on that.

Interviewee16: Again, if it's a huge contribution that the AI tool made in the project, I would mention it. But it's not a rule that I need to mention it.

Interviewer: If the AI provided the core idea — which sometimes you mentioned that it helps you with the creative block — and then after that you performed all of the refinements, how do you feel, who owns the result at the end?

Interviewee16: Again, I'm the owner. Maybe in the past I would go for a walk and that would unlock my creative process — I wouldn't say that a park is the owner of the results, right? Because it's just something that's tied into my current workflow that is helping to unlock my brain. But again, my brain is doing the work.

Interviewer: Have you ever felt that using AI for a specific task made you feel separated from your craft, or maybe your skills were degrading in a way because you rely on AI now compared to maybe the past where everything was by hand?

Interviewee16: I haven't had that moment. Maybe that moment is yet to come in design, but I haven't had that moment of realization at all, that AI can do my work. Maybe some junior designers have felt that, but after having this many years of experience, I can separate what AI can automate and take away and what is my creative and experiential contribution in the task. And it's never been the case so far that AI's contribution was greater than mine.

Interviewer: As you mentioned juniors, do you feel that the skills they are developing — they are not developing their skills enough because of AI, and will have maybe problems or trouble going forward because they will not be as capable?

Interviewee16: I haven't observed that in design. We don't have junior designers on the team right now. But I have friends who are software engineers and they actually are saying that they have become more lazy lately because instead of writing the actual code they can automate it with AI. And I'm not sure — they're saying actually that if they were really junior they would not be able to study, because it's always just a click of a mouse and keyboard away to not think for ten minutes about something, remembering the specific syntax or something, when you can just ask AI. And in the past maybe they had some platforms they searched for advice from other people on how they did it, but now it's united in one thing, so it needs so much less time and they can just ask it. So it's worse for remembering things. And for myself, I would say if I was studying right now and entering the job market, it would be a bit harder. But again, I think for creative professionals it's a bit of a safe space, because the ability of the human mind to innovate, to connect things in a creative way, I think is still unmatched by the current AI tools, and I'm not sure that this technology is able to replicate it. We'll see, but I'm not seeing it right now.

Interviewer: Thank you so much for your in detail insights. For the last part, we ask our Interviewee16s — you kind of understand what our research topic is about, it's mainly about the decision process behind what tasks to delegate to AI, informal versus formal rules, and authorship regarding AI. Do you feel maybe there is anything that I haven't asked that you maybe deemed important to mention?

Interviewee16: Not really. Actually it was the last thing I said about the unique ability of humans that I think won't be automated away anytime soon. That was something I wanted to add and highlight again.

Interviewer: Thank you so much for taking the time and doing this

Interviewee16: My pleasure. It's been good talking to you. Hope it help.

Interviewer: Thank you so much.